101 Greatest Tour Moments

THE BIG DOGS TOUR · 2002–2026

Written for the countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

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BT's Sweaty Arrival

101

BDT 2002 · Marbella · Featuring BT

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

The Streets of Marbella

In our apartment

Where else could we begin but with an early memory from the Inaugural Tour, BDT 2002. Six of the seven Inaugural Tourists had landed late in the evening in Marbella and, after a trawl around the Old Town to find somewhere still serving Stella Miguels, we located a tiny little bar with a closed door. It looked uninviting but after a few tentative knocks we found ourselves being ushered in. Before you could say "seis cervezas por favor" we were in the midst of the first ever BDT session and part of an extended lock-in. Cue a 5am finish on what we had agreed before departure would be a "quiet night".

BT's flight was arriving the following morning and his fellow Inaugurals had promised we would wait for him in the apartment. We were true to our word, but we were also dead to the world when BT rocked up in Marbella at 11am, without the full address for the apartment and with his suitcase and golf clubs in tow.

BT spent the next couple of hours wandering the streets of Marbella in 30 degree heat repeatedly calling all his fellow Inaugurals' phones in a vain attempt to locate their whereabouts.

Suffice to say that when BT finally managed to wake one of the Inaugurals from their slumbers he was not an amused Dog; he arrived on the apartment doorstep with his arms nearly dropping off from the weight of his clobber and his shirt stuck fast to his torso. Not a happy camper and definitely the first ever Rottweiler shout! Thankfully a couple of beers later he had simmered down and, although we didn't know it at the time, tour life had begun for the Inaugurals.

The Inaugural Tourists with Howard

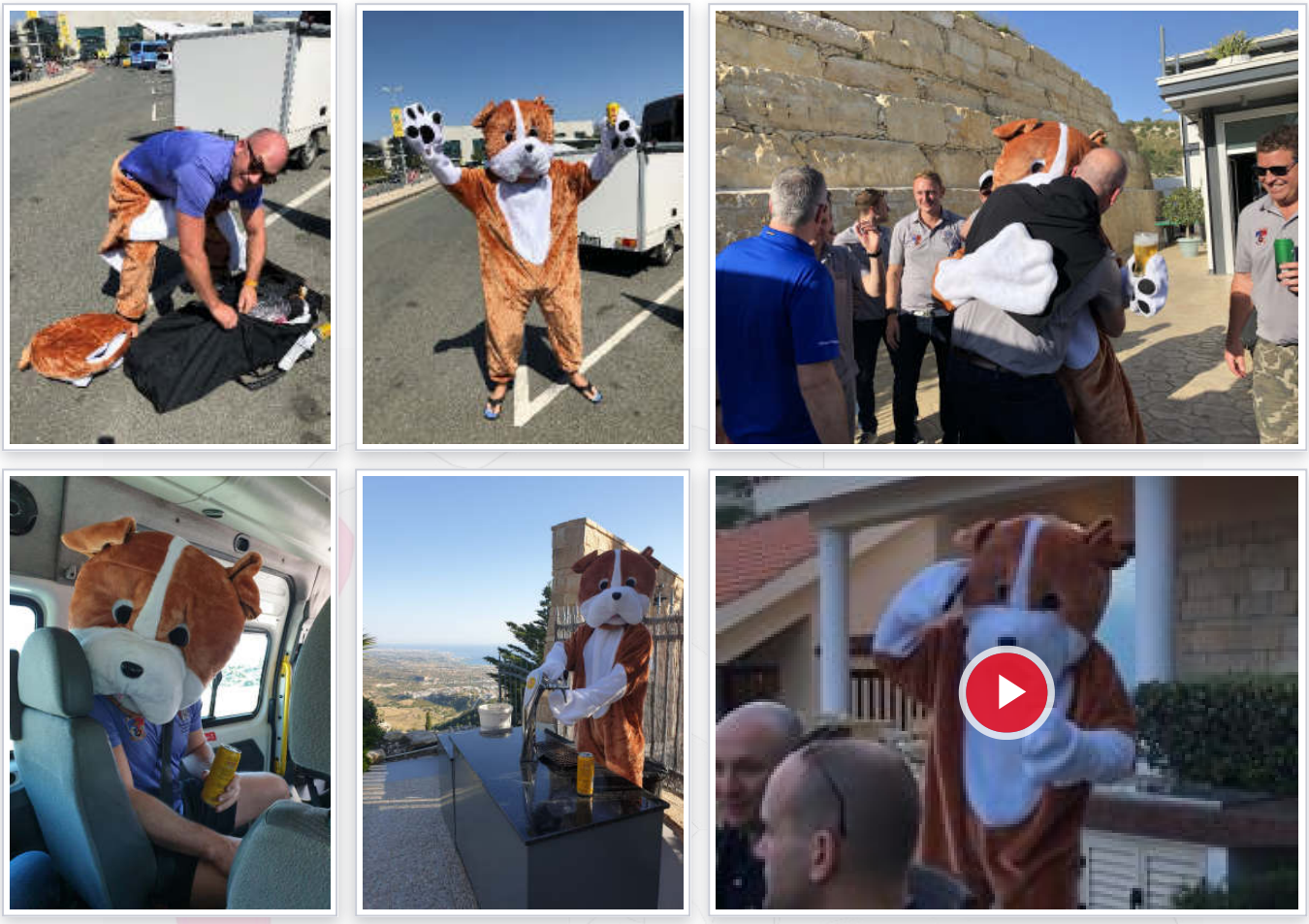
The Inaugurals Out Golfing

Marshy's Arrival in Cyprus

100

BDT 2019 · Cyprus · Featuring Marshy

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale



The Marsh-Dog in Action

▶ **Watch:** Marshy Arrives In Cyprus!

Continuing the theme of memorable arrivals, in 2019 we decided to head to pastures new, with Cyprus the destination of choice. Thanks to Little, we were flying into Larnaca – 90 minutes further away from our villa than our intended airport destination of Paphos - never again has Ciaran been put in charge of flights!

After a hiatus of six tours following his emigration to Oz, we had been delighted to welcome back Marshy to tour on BDT 2016 and he has continued making great efforts to join us each year. His enthusiasm for all things BDT is almost unparalleled and many of the tour's great traditions germinated in Marshy's ever-vivid imagination. In 2019 he was once again making a lengthy journey to join us in Cyprus, also flying into Larnaca and once again he had a little something up his sleeve.

On Day I of the tour, the London group had landed at Larnaca and had decided to enjoy a couple of beers to pass the time whilst we waited for the Marsh Dog. He surprised and amused all of us when he rocked up in 35 degree heat in a full-size woollen dog costume! Possibly the most memorable tour entrance over the 24 years of tour! Despite the searing heat, Marshy proceeded to wear said outfit for the rest of the day, which left us with some all-time great tour photos.

Can anyone better this entrance in Scottsdale....?!

Boavista Golf

99

BDT 2004 · Lagos · Featuring Paddy, Knoxy, Charlie & Langrish

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Next up is a golfing story. The standard of golf on tour has undoubtedly improved over the years; the stats demonstrate this not only with generally lower handicaps all round but with the stableford point scores now much higher year on year than they used to be. There was a time when 95 stableford points over your three rounds would pretty much guarantee you a top 3 finish whereas on BDT 2025 12 Dogs reached 100 points! But back in the early days of tour, some truly shocking golf was on display and so the question that comes to mind is: "What is the worst round of golf ever played on tour?!".

Boavista GC

On an individual basis, there have been three single-figure scores – Ravo's 8-pointer in the infamous "Bite & Swipe" round on BDT 2011 and Robbo's 9-pointer on BDT 2003 among them; but we all know that Hursty's 4-pointer on BDT 2008 represents the worst individual round – so far!

In terms of fourballs, however, there are a few contenders, with that "Bite & Swipe" round on BDT 2011 surely right up there. But (with apologies in advance to my fellow players) this writer's view of the worst fourball round ever played dates back to BDT 2004 and, sadly, was one I participated in. Towards the end of that tour, which back in those days was a seven-day endurance test, the Dogs took on Boavista in Portugal. Prior to the round we had been informed that it was a very challenging track at the best of times; as we arrived with high winds and rainstorms that day, it was playing tough to say the least!

At the clubhouse beforehand most of the lads plumped for buggies but for some unknown reason the final group of Charlie, Langrish, Knoxy and myself decided that we fancied the walk – serious error! It was comfortably the least enjoyable round of golf I have ever played, with 200-yard tee shots required into the wind just to clear 50-foot deep ravines! I recollect that on one hole all four of us were playing five off the tee!

It's fair to say that none of the four of us brought our A-game and it would be no surprise to me if, collectively, we neared 500 shots between us. Maybe only on the Jim McLean course in Florida have more balls been lost during a single round! Holes were regularly won with 7s and halved in 8s and 9s!

We returned to the Boavista clubhouse bedraggled and soaked from the incessant rain, weather-beaten by gale force winds, exhausted from constant ball-hunting without buggies to aid us and generally very grumpy!

Thankfully we are all slightly better golfers these days and, as to whether we should hire buggies, the question is not even asked (so long as they are allowed on the fairways)!

A description of just one hole from that round was provided after tour by Langrish, which gives a feel for the quality of golf on display:

LANGRISH

"I'm not sure which hole we were on but it was the one after the par 3 over the Portuguese Grand Canyon. I hit my tee shot ok but the wind caught it and took it left to the fringe of the rough. Not great, but the way things had been going I was pleased with this result; that is, until I got to the ball.

The ball had rolled on and was nestled in thick rough sitting under some pretty arid scrub bush. "No problem", I thought, I will lay out to the fairway and play my third. Simple really, however, as we all know it does not always go to plan.

I fought my way into the scrub and took up a pretty uncomfortable stance. Ran through a few practice swings, my back swing was approximately 24 inches and my follow through was pretty aggressive due to the springy nature of the bush behind me. Gud.

Here goes...shot one... freshy... Gud! Regroup.

Here goes...shot two... freshy... Gud!! Regroup.

Here goes... Shot three... freshy... Gud!!!

For the record, shot four made contact and scuffed out to the fairway. Shot 5 I hit a good shot, unfortunately too good, the ball flew over the back of the hole OB. Blob. Good times."

Charlie's take on the same round is as follows:

CHARLIE

"The Captains had decided to throw the tour hackers in together for the final pairings...just as well in hindsight if the first tee shots were anything to go by. Visual on first tee - line of gleaming villas to the right, way out of range bar a horrendous slice, open fairway, and Hurricane Derek guiding us on our way.

What followed was the worst collective set of tee shots seen on tour. Langrish first up - launches first shot into villas, ugly, ugly slice. Reload, Sally's it down the fairway.

Next up me - first tee shot into same villa Langrish had just gone into. Second tee shot, even worse slice into their neighbour's garden. Third shot, villas again. Fack it, long round ahead.

Once the Retrievers had calmed down from seeing the Bloodhounds show off their repertoires, the villas to the right promptly found themselves with 4 more little visitors and probably a decent repair bill as well.

I think Paddy and Langrish halved the hole with a pair of 9's. Globetopper and Sultan, a couple of respectable opening blobs.

Impressive start to one bloody tough round, dominated by Hurricane Derek. Bloodhounds get the point needed, somehow."

The Bloodhounds went on to secure the Ryder Cup that year, the very first one ever held. None of us needs any reminder that following 21 further editions the scores are 11-11 going into Scottsdale!

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

After Scottsdale the Retrievers lead the Ryder Cup 12–11.

DT's First Tee Shot on Tour

98

BDT 2007 · Dubai · Featuring DT

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Moving from the distinctly average golfers mentioned in Memory 99 to those who play a different game to the rest of us. One of the most anticipated moments in tour history has to be DT's first ever tee shot on BDT 2007 in Dubai on The Montgomerie Course. Never before had we had a pro in our ranks, so it is fair to say that the Dogs were expecting great things and everyone had assembled on the first tee to see DT in action!

Dubai Dogs

Over to DT to take us through the experience from his perspective:

DT

"Having played golf professionally at the time for over 15 years I thought a boys trip to Dubai golfing would be a breeze!!! Little did I know I was going to attempt to hit my first ever tee shot on Tour not even half cut from the night before but fully blitzed on the 1st tee thanks to the previous night's activities!!

So there I was teeing up 1st with all Dogs' eyes on the Virgin Pro!! Expecting me to spank it 280 straight down the middle!!

What really happened was I took a few practice swings and thought "whose arms are these I have come with today" cause they sure as hell did not feel like mine!! Anyway, a couple more practice swings, bend down peg it up, 2 turns and a swish and we should be away!! NOT!!!

I bent down, nearly fell over pegging it up, stood back and made what can only be described as the biggest slash ever made by a PRO!! And hit the thing some 50 yards straight right into a pond which I don't even think anyone else in golfing history could have reached!! It was probably 250 to this pond but at right angles to where we were supposed to be going!!!

It was quite comfortably the worst shot I have ever hit and it's safe to say I had completely underestimated how heavy The Big Dogs Tour was going to be! Thankfully I soon got the hang of hungover golf though!!"

Quite incredibly, the footage of this moment does exist – enjoy!

2007 Group Shot

Young Puppies

▶ **Watch:** BDT 2007, Dubai, 1st Round, 1st Tee, The Montgomerie

The Buzz Driver

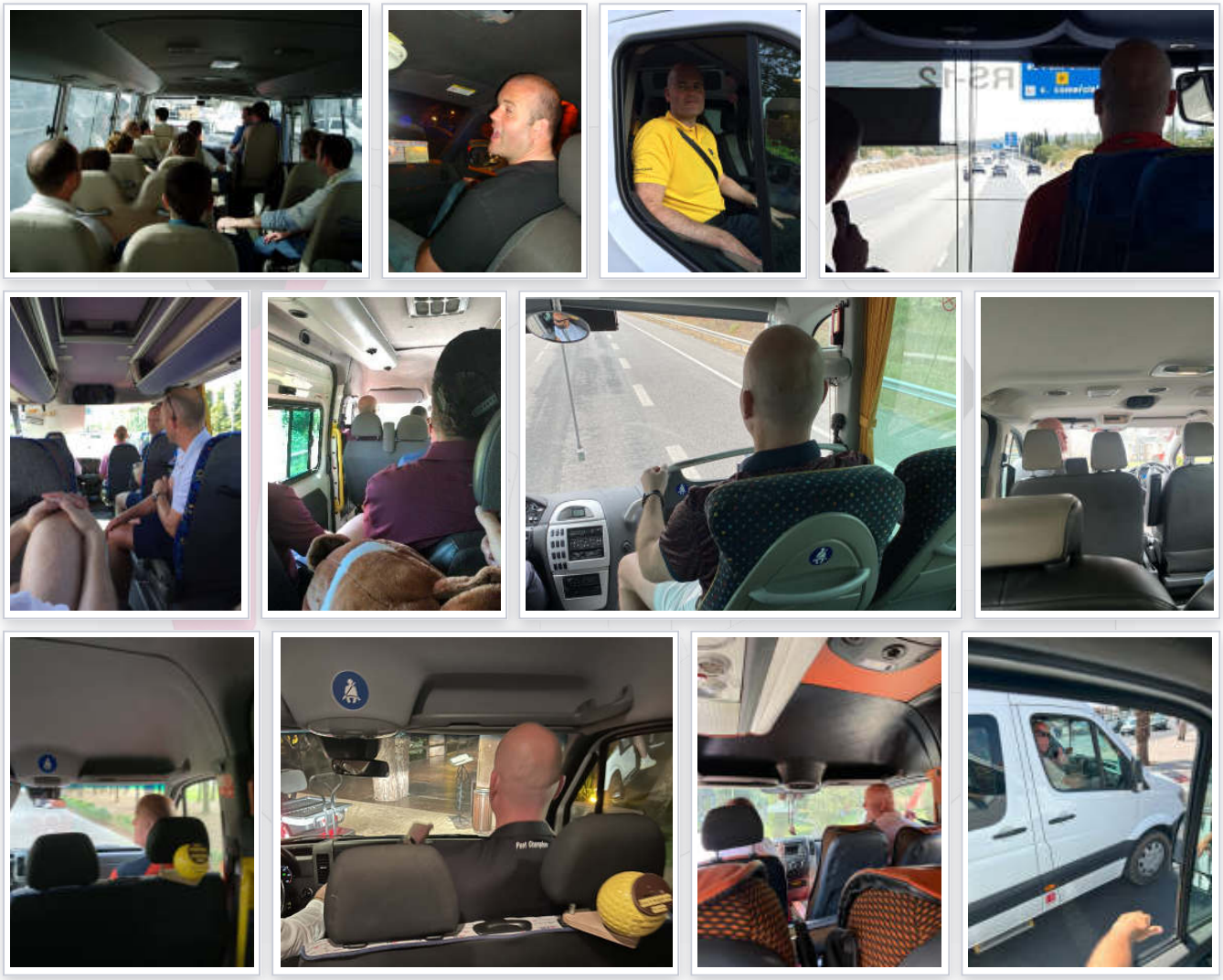
97

BDT 2006 · Mallorca · Featuring Buzz

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Transport is a fundamental part (and necessary evil) of any tour. Over 24 tours, 22 of which have been abroad, we have travelled countless miles and encountered a plethora of issues with flights, hire cars, buses, coaches, cabs, transfers and buggies. From volcanic ash clouds potentially grounding our flights for BDT 2010 to Covid interference on BDT 2020 and BDT 2021.

However, one reassuringly constant presence over the years has been the ever-reliable Buzz Driver!



The Buzz Driver over the years!

Tour summaries record that the term was first coined by one of the Dogs (anyone want to claim it?!) on BDT 2006. Our minibus transfer to the golf course was a tad tight on space meaning that we had to send our biggest Dog to the front passenger seat located, of course, on the right side.

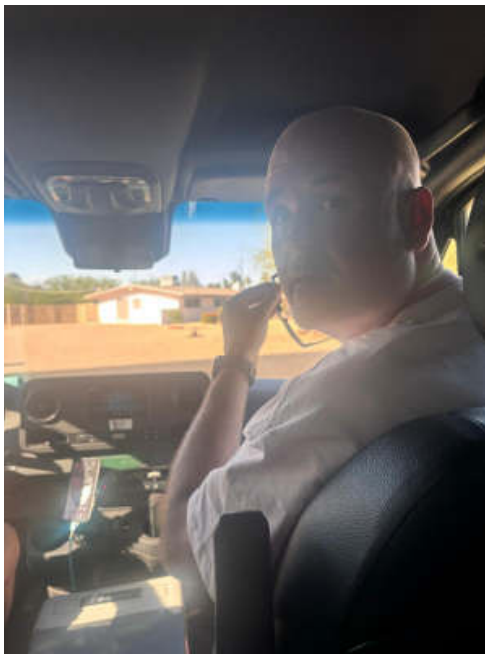
During the journey and much to the amusement of the rest of us said Dog then asked Buzz: “How long till we get there Drives?” and there and then a tour tradition and longstanding gag (that we never tire of!) was born!

Ever since, without fail, we actively insist that the Buzz Driver must take his rightful seat at the front of any coach, minibus or other vehicle we board! It has become something of a superstition and, if we could, we would get the Slow Coach up there in the cockpit of our flights!

Since those early days, Big Buzz has “driven” buzzes all over the globe on our behalf, never letting the side down and tour would simply not be the same without the Big Man at the helm to steady the ship!

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

The trend continued in the USA with the Big Man at the wheel, as ever.



BDT 2026 – The Buzz Driver In Scottsdale

BDT 2026 – The Big Man In The Greyhound

Big Buzz at Grayhawk

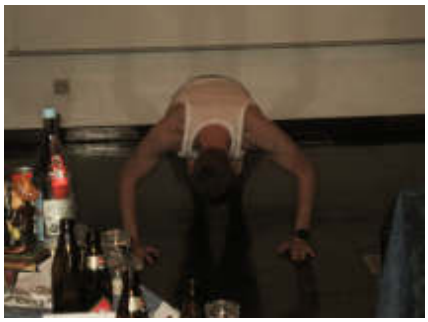
118 118

96

BDT 2009 · Vale do Lobo · Featuring Little & Boysie

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

In 2009 we headed to Vale do Lobo, which we affectionately renamed "Vale do Lobes" in honour of Robbo's sizeable lugs. The OC that year proved to be one of the most aggressive ones; nicknames were very pointed ("Scrooge" was a very harsh one for Boggy and Ash took particular exception to being named "Rent Boy"!) and the drinking fines were administered relentlessly and without sympathy. Oli G and Marshy were both fast asleep after 90 minutes and the Finemaster, fully robed in his Judge outfit, completely lost control of proceedings towards the end of the ceremony amidst unprecedented levels of grumbling and bickering!



Punishment for Little.

Ciaran watched all of this unfold with much amusement, since he had announced that in preparation for the impending London Marathon he would not be drinking for the tour. Back then he was the first Dog to abstain and so he was stone cold sober whilst the rest of us were anything but.

However, that smile was soon to be wiped from his face when he discovered that he would be wearing an outfit for the evening. The 118 118 adverts were all over the telly at the time and, as a tribute to Little's running prowess, Boysie had purchased a white running vest. Brian had employed his previously unheralded sewing skills, cutting out the numbers from some old black socks and stitching them onto the vest. This was presented to Little along with a lovely pair of running shorts and the outfit was almost complete. Robbo added the finishing touch by drawing a moustache on Little, which Little was concerned was more Adolf Hitler than David Bedford!

▶ **Watch:** I don't want to look like Adolf Hitler!

Little tolerated this in decent spirits for the most of the evening and, after some debate / moaning, we were kind enough not to force him to wear it outside of the hotel; he had also been docked three shots off his handicap as his sobriety was deemed an unfair advantage, so he no doubt went to bed that first night believing that his fines for the tour were now out of the way. Error!

The BDT 2009 OC

Heading into the second night out, Little was in the hotel reception looking fresh and ready to hit the bars of Vilamoura, fully equipped with the standard LBS (Little Black Shirt), LB (the always-worn Little Belt) and ready for patter and action. However, the Monkey and his co-conspirators had other ideas and gleefully presented Little with a bright, tight, orange ladies vest-top to wear along with a lovely scouser wig. A nice touch which Little really appreciated.

The photos tell their own story and suffice to say it would be a long time before anyone declared they were doing a dry tour again!

Little sporting his orange number

Rufus Goes AWOL!

95

BDT 2021 · Celtic Manor · Featuring Rufus & Knoxy

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Due to the ongoing Covid restrictions, BDT 2021 to Celtic Manor was the second consecutive UK-based tour, with international travel curtailed. As a consequence, a number of the Dogs were straining at the leash by the time tour arrived, not least the Captains for that tour, Langers and Rufus!

BDT 2021 – The calm before the storm!

At the OC, Langers regaled us with a 45-minute tale of his impromptu meeting with Rufus in Shanghai in the middle of his running a redundancy consultation process, which was simply priceless! He then unveiled a SPICY bottle of Chinese liquor, aptly named “Ming River”, which inevitably led to a rapid deterioration in the sobriety of both captains when they started voluntarily necking shots of it. Unsurprisingly, as the noise levels rose we were turfed out of the OC meeting room by an impatient Celtic Manor staff member. In those times of Covid, the hotel bars had all closed but, fortunately, BT had secured himself an executive suite via some smelly patter and so we all trooped up there to continue proceedings.

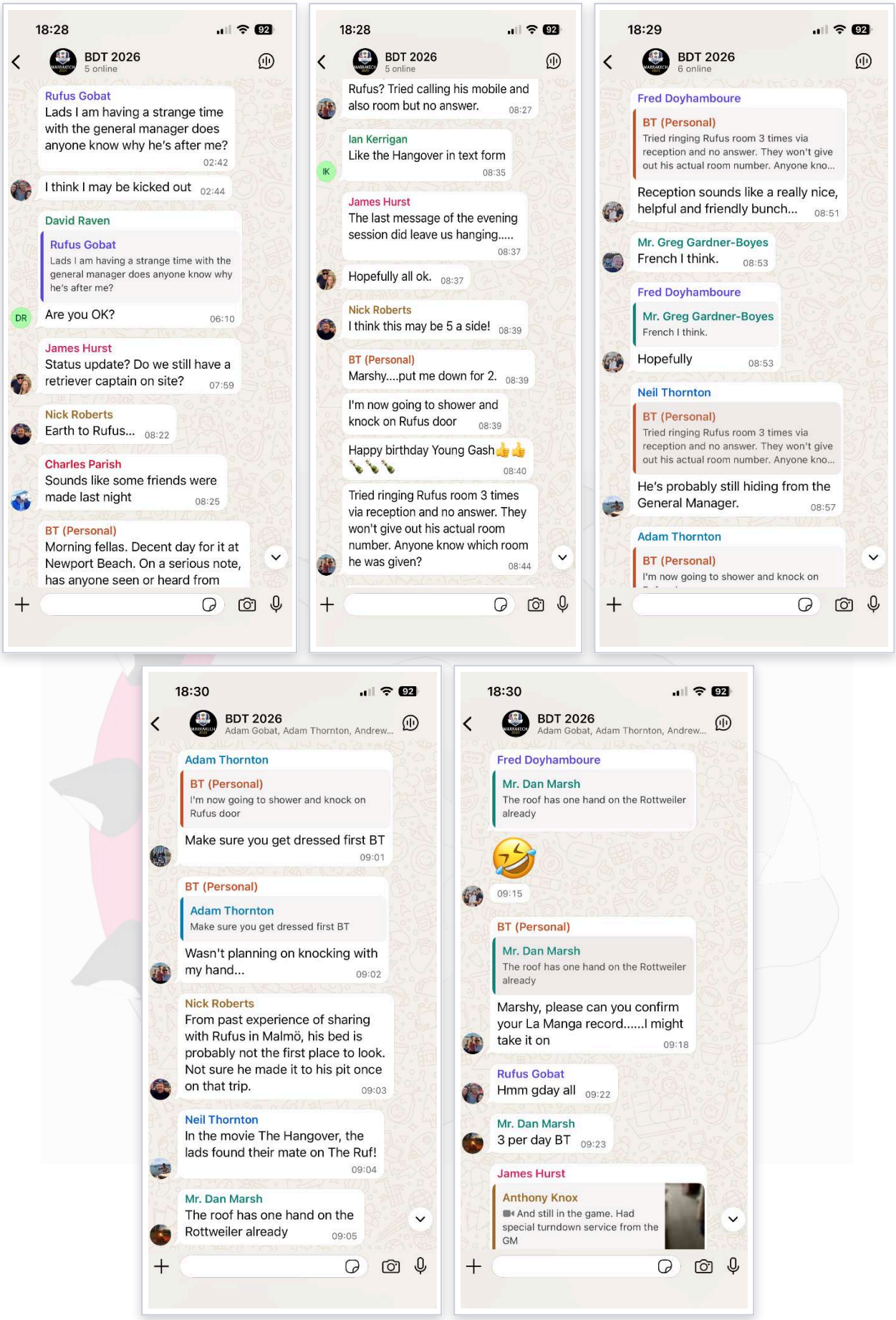
Over the course of the remainder of the evening, we received several further warnings from the Celtic Manor staff about our volume levels, with the Captains by far the worst culprits. Eventually, after trashing BT’s room, we decided to call it a night before we were ejected from the hotel!

A quiet night in

Come the following morning the damage on the trolley outside BT’s suite showed why many, particularly the by-now spewing Langers, were feeling a little tender after the previous night’s antics.

More concerning, however, was the WhatsApp message received from Rufus at 2:42am…

A series of amusing messages followed, including several from non-tourists who were enjoying the tour from afar.



A selection of WhatsApps

To everyone's relief it transpired that the hotel manager had assisted Rufus to his hotel room and next door neighbour Knoxy had the foresight to video the key moment of locating our missing hound!

▶ **Watch:** The Ruf!

Champagne Breakfast for Young Ash's Birthday

The Pillowfight

94

BDT 2017 · Mallorca · Featuring Adam T, Buzz & BT

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

One of the all-time great moments on tour came on BDT 2017, being the climax to a crucial Singles match between Big Buzz and Adam T, that has subsequently become known as "The Pillowfight".

Singles Results

Buzz is delighted to receive the Shitzu!

Played on the 18th hole at Son Gual golf course, not only was this possibly the poorest hole of golf ever played on tour, but it was also critical in terms of both the battle for the Shitzu between the two Dogs in question and, even more importantly, the destiny of the 2017 Big Dogs Tour trophy, as it effectively became the deciding hole for the Ryder Cup contest that year.

I can do no better than to let Adam tell you the story in his own words:

ADAM T

"The day started off the same as any other I've had on tour, with an iron fisted mental focus to avoid being the Shitzu at all costs. I've had some close calls in my previous tours but have thus far been able to avoid this particular 'honour' by the skin of my teeth. Having said that, I think I was Shitzu on day 2 of that year for the first time but that further made me determined to avoid the overall tour award.

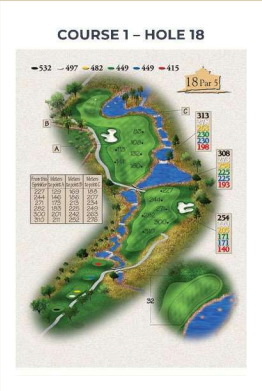
My main 'challenger' for the Shitzu was the Big Man and it just so happened that we'd been drawn together in the Singles and not only that, we were also shooting off first. My playing partner for the Retrievers was BT, so I felt I was in great hands. BT was running away with the Singles title and I knew he'd have his work cut out to caddy me round to a victory, but I also couldn't think of anyone better for the job in the circumstances.

Conversely, Ciaran was partnering Big Green, which made me feel even better, as Ciaran isn't, how can I put it, 'encouraging' and was definitely going to be a negative for the Big Man.

The first nine holes were pretty uneventful. I think Big Green was 1 up. Then disaster struck. BT must have been watching Colin McRae earlier that day, as after teeing off he tried to do a rally turn in our buggy and proceeded to crash into the tee kerb trapping his hand in the steering wheel. He appeared in considerable pain and, selfishly, all I could think about was that my safety blanket was compromised.

Fast forward to the 18th tee. Somehow, we were all square. I'd managed to drain a miraculous 20-foot downhill snake of a putt on the 15th or 16th to keep me in contention and here we were on the 18th for all the marbles. The hole was daunting with a brook going up the left-hand side of the fairway, then going across a few hundred yards up to then hugging the right-hand side of the fairway all the way to the green. Basically, water danger on every shot. Not ideal.

By this point BT was a broken man. Injured hand in ice and a bucket load of Stella Miguels down, I knew I was on my own. To be honest I thought BT was being a bit of a p***y, as it was only a sprained wrist. Later turned out to be a broken hand so "my bad" BT.



The 18th at Son Gual and BT's Broken Hand!

With some water hugging shots, both Big Green and I managed to make it safely to the edge of the green having taken the same number of shots. It would come down to the short game for not only the Shitzu but also the match and (although we didn't know it at the time) the whole Ryder Cup.

Big Green was on the edge of the green, which meant he could putt it whereas I was a little further away and had to chip.

"Just hit the centre of the green and put the pressure on'" was all I was thinking. Tension was high as I swung and managed to put it on the green, albeit 25 feet away, but I thought "I'll take that"; however, it was very much advantage the Big Man. Silence descended as Green rifled his putt all the way through the green to the fringe on the other side. At one point I thought it was going into the water but that infamy fortunately was spared for him.

There was silence for what seemed like an eternity as no one wanted to be first to show any emotion. Eventually Ciaran just simply put his head in his hands to which BT and I just erupted. Big Green trudged solemnly to the other side of the green as it was still his honour! Predictably he overcompensated and just tiddled his putt on the green leaving it a good 20 foot short. Momentum had swung back in my direction. Unfortunately, I didn't seize the moment as I raced my putt about 15 feet by! Nerves were definitely starting to take hold and this wasn't one for the purists!

The Shitzu

We were back level but this time I held a slight advantage. Big Green was next up with his effort. It didn't go anywhere near the hole with the Big Man leaving it probably 10 feet away. I was just thinking to myself "just 2 putt from here and put the pressure on Green" as, if the previous 5 minutes were anything to go by, that would be enough. I managed to putt my next shot to within about 4 feet and then sink the subsequent putt to leave Green with a 10-footer to halve not only the match, but, more importantly, to avoid the Shitzu.

Inevitably the putt was missed, and the match was lost with Big Green having somehow managed to 5-putt from the edge of the green. Cue the customary "a half would have been a fair result", "forget about it Big Man", "happens to the best of us" chat, whereas deep down inside we all knew we'd witnessed the most atrocious ending to a Singles match ever on BDT from both myself and Green and one that decided the fate of the Ryder Cup, with the Retrievers emerging victorious courtesy of my vital extra half point. The Shitzu was avoided for another year but it is getting perilously close! ”

The Rottweiler

93

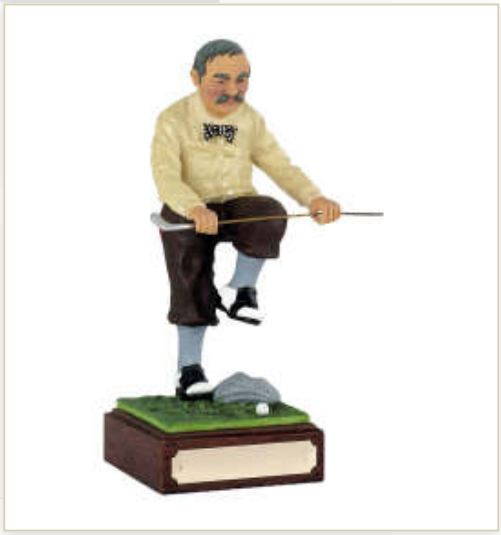
Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Hulmey takes the 2018 Rottweiler

The Rottweiler tends to be one of the most hotly contested trophies on each BDT. By way of reminder, the tour rules provide that the Rottweiler should be handed to the Dog who has:

- shown the feistiest form on tour, including picking fights with randoms or other tourists;
- shown an aggressive refusal to accept fines;
- displayed the worst etiquette or temper tantrums on the golf course or off it; and
- been extremely loud and perhaps inappropriately so.



The Rottweiler

The 24 (actually 25 given the 2024 joint award) tour Rottweilers to date are listed in the table below, with some extremely worthy winners amongst them! Our feistiest hounds leading the pack with multiple awards are Boysie (4), BT (3) and Oli G (3).

If you had to choose an overall winner from the list below, who would it be?! For me it is hard to look past the 2013 entry....!

Who will join the Hall of Fame in 2026....?!

The Rottweiler Hall of Fame

YEAR	WINNER	REASON
2002	BT	"If anyone else mentions f***ing smelly patter again I'm going to take their head clean off their shoulders"
2003	Boysie	Spewing several times on La Manga North Course
2004	Ravo	"You are a Big Dog"
2005	Oli Gregory	Sleeping on pavements and general loudness
2006	Boggy	Relentless bouts of Tourette's whilst golfing
2007	BT	Taking on the biggest guy in Dubai
2008	Picko	Constantly downing vino in one
2009	Oli Gregory	Regular biting at the OC whilst being Retriever Captain
2010	DT	Launching a club 25 yards in Round III
2011	Boysie	Believed to be club throwing but memories have faded!
2012	Ravo	Romanians
2013	Boysie	Starting on Harbo
2014	Oli Gregory	"Seven consecutive minutes biting"
2015	Jules	Throwing his driver up a tree
2016	Lordy	Passing out, hospitalising himself and p!ssing on a coach
2017	Langers	Taking himself to the cleaners, and some, every night
2018	Hulmey	Loudness, over-confidence and club throwing
2019	Robbo	Throwing (and losing!) his wedge after one too many thinned chips
2020	Ash	Angrily discarding his buggy in a bunker
2021	Rufus	Hitting Harbo with his ball, night one antics and two freshies which led to him shouting “I’ve had enough of this f***ing game!”.
2022	Boysie	Longest distance ever achieved for a 7-iron chuck
2023	Hursty	Consistent late night monkey-antics including the "Magic Mike" evening
2024	BT & Boggy	Continued arguing on the crucial final putt on the 18th green Round III and beyond on a point of golfing rules / etiquette
2025	Gav	Snapping his three wood in half
2026	**Ash**	**Enormous and prolonged bite at the OC**

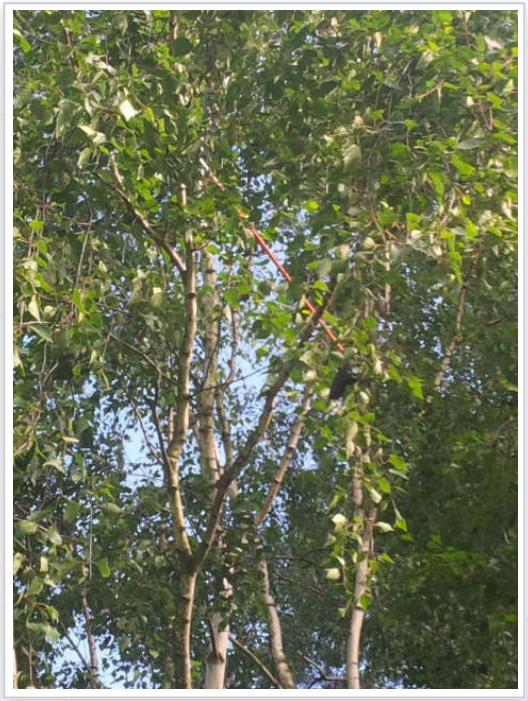
Highlighted row added after BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

A selection of Rowdy Rottweilers

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

Ash took home the 2026 Rottweiler for an enormous and prolonged bite at the OC.

Ash takes home the 2026 Rottweiler



Jules's Driver Chuck in 2015!

Brothers

92

Across the tours · Featuring Hursts, Thorntons, Gobats, Taylors & Parishes

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

BDT 2013 Brothers

Brothers have formed an integral part of the tour's history. It is an unwritten rule of the tour that wherever possible you should play for the opposite team to your brother.

There have only ever been two exceptions; first, when Ollie passed we felt it appropriate that on the very next tour Rufus should inherit his Retriever shirt and second, the Chuckle Brothers teamed up at The Belfry on BDT 2020 with Adam performing Mongrel duties.

The Hursts

Running through the brothers in chronological order, we had the Hursts on the Inaugural tour and they have toured together a remarkable 22 times. They captained against each other on BDT 2022 with Ash proving victorious.

The Taylors

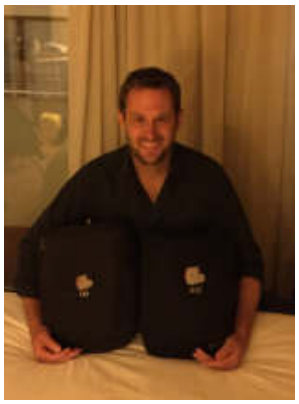
DT joined BT on tour for the first time on BDT 2007 and they have toured together 11 times, captaining against each other on the incomplete tour to Marbella on BDT 2012.

The Parishes

The Parishes toured together for the first time on BDT 2013 and they have enjoyed eight tours together. They captained against each other in Cyprus on BDT 2019 with Charlie coming out on top.

The Thorntons

The Thorntons also toured together for the first time on BDT 2013 and have done four tours together, not yet captaining against one another.



The Gobats

Sadly Ollie never toured with either of his brothers, but Rufus and Adam have since toured together once, on BDT 2023 and again have yet to face off as captains.

We have had four out of the five sets of brothers all touring together on three tours, BDT 2013, BDT 2014 and BDT 2024.

It would be quite something if we could get all five sets of brothers on tour together one day!

BDT 2024 Brothers

BT's Trumpet

91

BDT 2006 · Mallorca · Featuring BT

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

BDT 2006 took us to a bang average 3* hotel for the tour's first visit to Mallorca, up there as a contender for the dingiest digs we have stayed in during 24 years of touring. These were the days when the Dogs hit the town hard of an evening with roomies BT and Robbo straining at the leash to outdo each other in terms of who could be the last one to hit the hay!

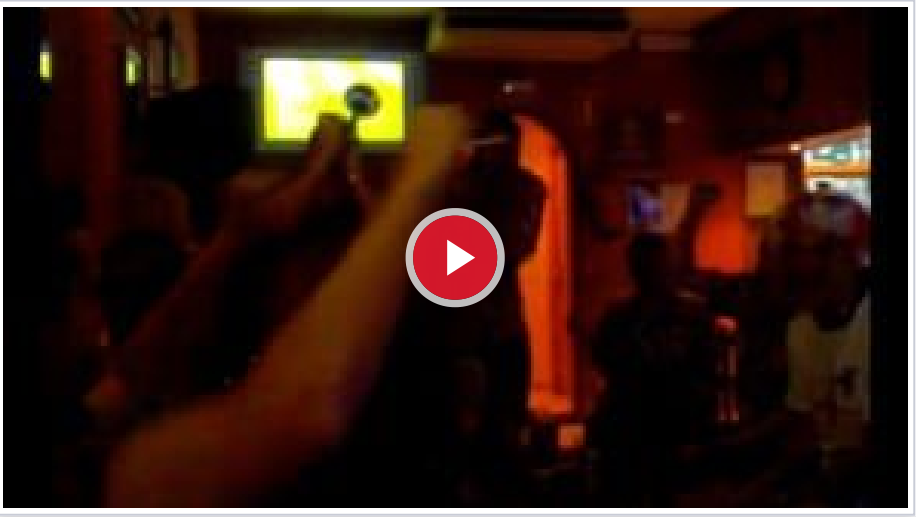
At the Opening Ceremony within the hotel grounds, as the Dogs looked on wearing clothes pegs on their noses as Patter Protectors, Boysie had presented BT with a toy trumpet. This was in recognition of the aftermath of Boysie's wedding where BT had been accused (by Boysie) of having damaged a priceless vintage trumpet which had been hanging on the wall, by recklessly playing (and dropping) it in the early hours of the morning at the wedding venue Eaves Hall, a gag which Boysie continued to worry BT with for weeks, if not months!

The hotel had rooms overlooking the pool area and one by one each morning the Dogs would hit the sun-loungers having first scanned the horizon from our balconies to establish where our fellow hounds might be situated.

After the first night, BT and Robbo were the last to rise from their slumbers having turned in at circa 5am and so BT was scanning the pool area from his balcony to work out where we were gathered. Having spotted the group he decided to announce his presence by trumpeteering at top volume the now-legendary:

> "Buh buh, buh...buh.....buuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuh!"

After a couple of mornings of a generally bemused reaction to this behaviour from the other hotel guests, they gradually warmed to the morning tradition which would then culminate in a huge daily cheer and round of applause as BT parped out his best notes from his balcony perch! A fine way to start the day ahead and one which led to the nowlegendary nickname "The Pies Piper!".



▶ **Watch:** BT's Trumpet!

The BDT 2006 OC

BT, Knoxy & Trumpet

Celebridogs

90

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Over numerous years we have amassed a fantastic collection of Celebridogs – 290 pics and counting! Please see the video at the link for a whizz through the entire collection!

Picking out a few select special entries gives an idea of the quality:

▶ **Watch:** The Celebridog Collection

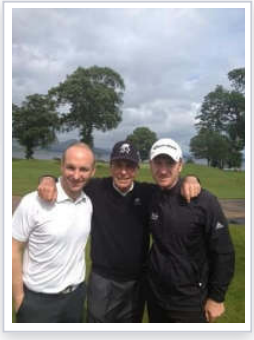
Michael Jordan

The Celebridog Awards

AWARD	CELEBRIDOG
All Time Great	Michael Jordan
Most Presidential	Bill Clinton
Most Prime Ministerial	Boris Johnson
Most Controversial	Oscar Pistorius
Best Sportsman	Daley Thompson
Best Manager	Alex Ferguson / Bobby Robson
Most Streams	Ed Sheeran / Robbie Williams
Best Singer	Tom Jones
Best Actor	Andy Garcia
Best Looking	Liz Hurley
Wealthiest Dog	Richard Branson
Most Royal	Zara Phillips
Legendary Golfer	Tie between Trevino / Player / Watson / Faldo / McIlroy
Toughest	Lennox Lewis / Chris Eubank
Greatest Olympian	Steve Redgrave / Matthew Pinsent
Greatest Batsman	Viv Richards / Joe Root / Steve Waugh
Fastest (Bowler)	Brett Lee / Jeff Thomson / Mark Wood
Fastest (Driver)	Rubens Barrichello / Carlos Sainz
Fastest (Runner)	Usain Bolt (ahead of Bryan Habana / Jason Robinson)
Brothers!	Ryan and Rhodri Giggs!
Tallest	Crouchy
Shortest	BT
Least Well Known	Nikita Zadorov / Jordan Wright / Danny Sebastian

Rory McIlroy

John Daly



Gary Player

We look forward to the tradition continuing and a reminder to get yours in before this year's OC to avoid a fine!

BDT 2008 Preview DVD - Opening Credits

89

BDT 2008 · Lisbon

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

The first ever tour preview DVD was unveiled at the OC of BDT 2008 in Turkey / Lisbon.

The opening credits went down well, with the undoubted highlight being the Monkey's commentary. Peter Alliss would have been proud of his droll tones – my two favourite lines being:

00.40 - "Bit of a snap-hook – somewhere over there", with camera panning left!

00.49 - "That's gone WAY over there" with camera panning sharp right!

Genius. A career in broadcasting awaits if ever the Monkey tires of surveying!

▶ **Watch:** BDT 2008 Preview DVD – Opening Credits

The BDT 2008 OC

The DGC

88

BDT 2008 · Lisbon

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

The Duncan Goodhew Challenge is now a staple of every tour and forms an important part of the Day I proceedings. The DGC concept began on BDT 2008 when we were at a loose end during the day and so, to ensure we were kept occupied, Hursty demanded everyone should be at the hotel indoor swimming pool for 3pm sharp.

▶ **Watch:** The first ever DGC!

The idea was Hursty's brainchild, yet back in those days there were not as many baldies as there now are although one more was back in the mix with BT having finally shaven off his Syrup!

DGC venues have included the hotel pools in Lisbon, Vale do Lobes, Girona and Mallorca. One was held at Nikki Beach in the presence of a WTA tennis star (anyone remember who it was?!) and several other surprised poseurs. The one that drew the most complaints from the participants was the virtual triathlon at the James Bond villas in Cyprus and the only year we haven't held one since 2008 was Celtic Manor 2021 where Covid restrictions prevented us from putting on the show.

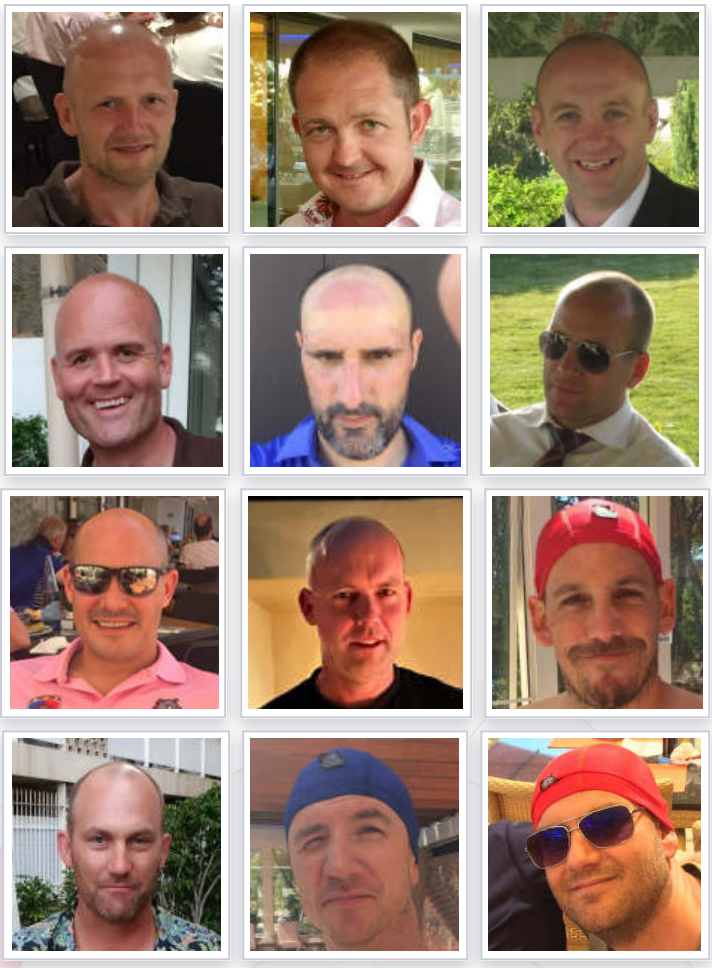
The competitors in that first challenge were merely BT, Langrish and Marshy (amazingly, Buzz did not participate!).

On BDT 2025 we had a few more in the mix, with Adam T, Boysie, Hulmey and Knoxy participating, Knoxy having miraculously evaded selection for many years, as Rufus somehow continues to do so! Other competitors over the years have included Fred, Glenn, Langrish, Marcus and Rick.

This is undoubtedly a competition which will continue to grow in popularity over the coming years and this year we surely look forward to welcoming triathlete Kenners to the fray, who will raise the bar even further! With this in mind there was a debate after last year's hard-fought contest between BT and Buzz as to whether the DGC was deserving of its own award. It remains to be seen whether this will materialise in Scottsdale! For now, take care of those follicles and beware of Inspector Kojak at the OC!

The 2019 DGC

The 2025 DGC



The Baldies!

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

The DGC got its own trophy in Scottsdale – the first winner was Kenners, who joined the brotherhood of the bald.

The 2026 DGC Participants

Drinking Games - Derek Kill

87

BDT 2003 · La Manga · Featuring BT, Robbo & Hursty

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

The 2003 Tourists

Childish? Undoubtedly. But drinking games have always formed a fundamental part of each and every BDT. From the early days of Finger Spoofing in Lagos on BDT 2004, to the Name Game to Thumbmaster, Dancemaster and of course Freezemaster which remains a constant to this day, to the ultimate danger game of Wet Willies and many others!

When considering great tour moments, several drinking games come to mind but one in particular perhaps stands out.

On Day I of BDT 2003 we had gathered around a table for the Name Game. It had already been a long day with airport beers at 6.30am and it would be fair to say that BT had "gone early"!

The topic was famous sportsmen and he was seriously struggling for inspiration; having managed to come up with Allan Donald, BT reclined in his chair to take some much-needed respite, only to have David Duckham thrown right back at him!

Now in serious trouble, BT put his thinking cap back on whilst nursing his lager by his lips (with Hursty chirping away in his ear: "it's drink while you think, BT, not sip while you think!").

Then a look of triumph came over BT's face as he came out with..... "Derek Kill"!

This was too much for Robbo who immediately piled into BT – "Derek Kill?! Who the f*** is Derek Kill, BT?!".

The now immortal slurred response from BT was: "you know, Damon Hill's Dad"!

Genius. BT well and truly on the ropes!

The Vilamoura OC

86

BDT 2005 · Vilamoura · Featuring Marshy

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

The space outside Bar Nautico in The Old Village, Vilamoura, has become part of tour folklore as it witnessed one of, if perhaps not the most rancorous session in tour history. It was the scene of the OC for BDT 2005 and it was not so much the drinking that was memorably punchy (although we definitely gave it a good tilt that day / night) but more so the handicap session that took place that evening.

Bar Nautico

Back in those days, rather than issuing handicaps "Stalin-style" we would venture on tour with no set handicaps and invite each Dog to put forward to the group his own handicap for consideration at the OC. Needless to say, some lads were targeted mercilessly – in part dependent upon which team the Dog in question happened to be on – if he was on the opposition team, basically you went for him, no holds barred!

This inevitably led to a huge amount of unseemly squabbling as some tourists were visibly upset to be dispensed with handicaps a good six shots under their proposals whilst, in their view, others had got away remarkably lightly!

The sense of injustice carried on for some for the rest of the evening, if not the entire tour, and it probably says it all that never since have we had a live handicap-committee session!

One other memory stands out head and shoulders above all others from this evening.

With handicaps duly allocated, three quarters of the way through the subsequent fines session Marshy had been presented with a fine for some misdemeanour or other. Two fingers was the fine.

Marshy picked up the nearest bottle of Mateus and so was born an unforgettable tour moment!

▶ **Watch:** Marsh v Mateus

After the Rosé

The Mongrels

85

Across the tours · Featuring Kezza, Adam T, Gav, Ravo & Tully

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

BDT 2019 – Tully

BDT 2010 – Ravo

BDT 2012 – Gav

BDT 2020 – Adam T

BDT 2022 – Tully

BDT 2023 – Kezza

BDT 2024 – Kezza

Let's be honest: nobody wants to be a Mongrel. Unfortunately, there have been a few select occasions over the years when we have been left with no other choice and, to date, five Dogs have taken on the dreaded mantle on seven occasions between them.

Mongrel-duties are usually assigned on the basis of keeping as few mongrels in the pack as possible, with Virgins being particularly susceptible to assuming mongrel duties during their first few tours.

It is perhaps surprising that we have not required a Mongrel on more than seven occasions over 22 Ryder Cups, but also a testament to the commitment of the Dogs to their team.

How have the Mongrels fared when playing for "the oppo"?! In the build-up to BDT 2025, we had Marshy's analysis of the MINGE (Mongrel Impact on Net Game Effect) factor which concluded that the Bloodhounds have done very well out of Retriever-loans.

In terms of each individual's performance, the results indicate that the Dogs in question have all tried to pull their weight for the oppo (except perhaps for a stellar performance from Adam T for the Bloodhounds in 2020!):

TOUR	MONGREL	POINTS	W-L-H
BDT 2010	Ravo	70 (13th)	2-1-0
BDT 2012	Gav	49 (2 rounds) (8th=)	0-2-0
BDT 2019	Tully	99 (3rd)	2-1-0
BDT 2020	Adam T	67 (14th)	0-3-0
BDT 2022	Tully	105 (5th=)	2-1-0
BDT 2023	Kezza	88 (10th)	0-2-1
BDT 2024	Kezza	85 (21st)	2-1-0

Hopefully we will be able to limit the need for Mongrels in the future but it seems inevitable we have not seen the last of them! Whether anyone actually wants to swap sides is the other interesting question and for a long time there has been suspicion on this front over Ravo, as this video from the 2009 OC demonstrates!

▶ **Watch:** He's A Retriever!

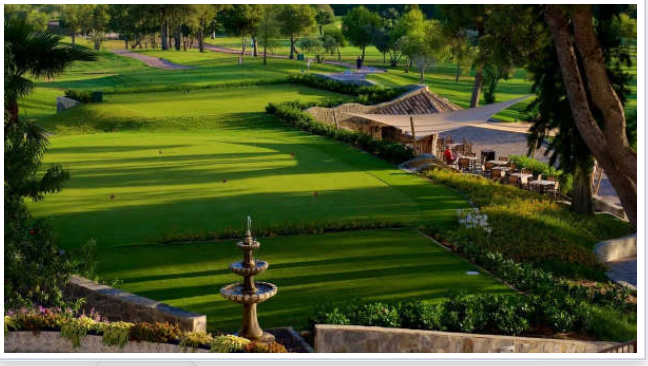
Boysie's Inaugural Tour Win

84

BDT 2002 · Marbella · Featuring Boysie, BT, Robbo & Paddy

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

As we all know, the golf was something of an afterthought on the Inaugural Tour but, that said, we did still have a competition with a trophy at the ready for that year's Champion Golfer.



Atalaya

Going into the final round at Atalaya, as expected, BT was the clear favourite and as we hit the back nine my playing partner Robbo turned to Boysie and me and declared "over my dead body is that f***er winning this!". After establishing with the group ahead how much of a lead BT had, we set to work.

All of a sudden, Boysie's golf hit Kim Jong Il's "38 under" proportions as he finished with an eagle and birdie blitz over the finishing holes to miraculously pip BT at the post!

Gimmes from the fairway were not uncommon – "good for me that Paddy, ok for you?" - "Yep in the form he is in I can't see him missing that one Robbo" etc, as a clearly amused Boysie happily picked up each time and headed to the next tee.

Come the end of the tour, a somewhat surprised BT sportingly congratulated Brian as he handed over the trophy, unaware of quite what had happened during those final holes.

There has always been something of an omerta around that back nine, until Boysie legitimately took home the Green Jacket on BDT 2024 when we felt it was perhaps finally time to spill the beans! As it happened, Boysie ended up winning by such a distance that it may have been his trophy anyway, but if you ask Robbo or me we will always maintain that Brian definitely won that year regardless!

Boysie wins the Inaugural Tour

He Looks Like My Dad!

83

BDT 2022 · Lagos

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

None of us is getting any younger and the 25th anniversary tour certainly brings home the passage of time, which will be a theme of this year's tour. 50th birthdays are now a regular occurrence and, of course, our oldest Dog Rufus is nearer to 60 than 50! Not that we let this stop us touring in exactly the same way we always have done.

However, our ageing has never been brought into sharper focus than it was in a Lagos nightclub on BDT 2022.

Round I Greyhound Ash was standing out in the crowd due to his fluorescent yellow shirt glowing in the neon-lit nightclub. This caused one girl to come over and comment to us about Ash's appearance.

The video speaks for itself!!!!

Greyhound Ash

▶ **Watch:** Dad!

Stay Humble

82

BDT 2025 · Marrakech · Featuring Ravo

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Marrakech Mayhem

Picture the scene: Marrakech 2025, 24 Dogs all absolutely flying in a seriously swanky club. The place was jam-packed but one particular Steve caught our attention as he swanned over, c*ck of the walk, to the VIP area, linen trousers on, surrounded by women.

The VIP area was at eye-level above the dancefloor and so if you turned around and looked up you were basically staring at Steve's knees.

We've all done a bit of podium dancing in our time, particularly Langers, but this dude was taking it to another level entirely, looking out over the dancefloor as though it was his empire, swaying to the tunes and his Billy-Big-B*llocks behaviour was standing out like a sore thumb. He had the swagger (or thought he did), was immaculately presented, guns on show, slicked-back hair, gleaming white teeth – he could have walked straight off the set of Love Island or The Only Way Is Essex.

After watching this performance for a little while, Ravo announced (quite reasonably) that "this guy needs bringing down a peg or two!". A man of action and not just words Ravo decided to prove the point! He reached up, grabbed Steve's linen trousers and dropped them, exposing his silky underwear!

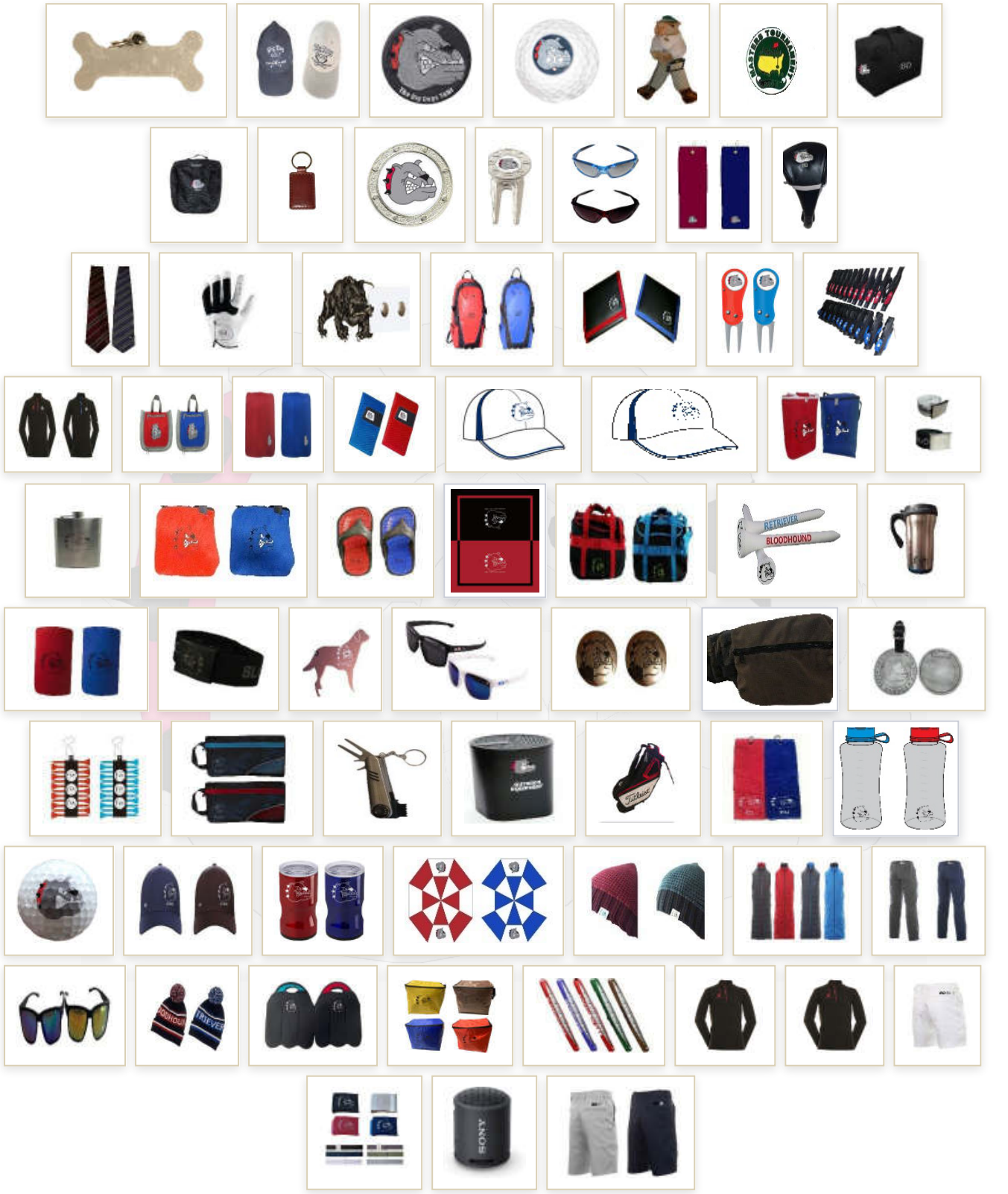
Everyone around, including Steve's mates, p!ssed themselves but Steve was not impressed! He made a colossal fuss and all hell broke loose at this point! Cutting a long story short, Ravo somehow smooth-talked the bouncers into letting him stay in the Club! Steve, however, had come crashing back down to earth – lesson learnt: stay humble!

Stash

81

Across the tours · Featuring Langers, Ravo & Marshy

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale



Stash Board

The table above demonstrates how stash has been an ever-evolving theme of the tour and many of us have a drawer or two at home dedicated purely to the vast collection which has built up over the years.

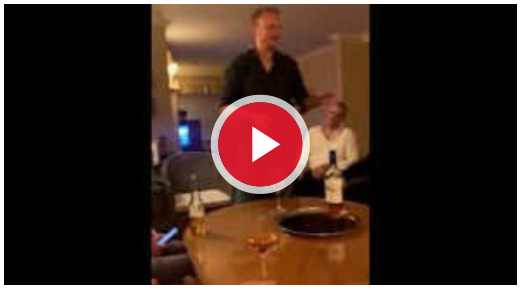
What was the first ever bit of stash? Nothing was handed out on BDT 2002 or BDT 2003, so the earliest stash I can find a record of is...the metal dog bone purchased for the group by Marshy and Ravo! Who still has theirs?!

On BDT 2007, Ravo acquired 16 Jamal the Camels which to this day remain one of the most treasured tour items, with many of the group insisting that Jamal should always attend BDT with them.

The pictures above show all the items of stash running from BDT 2004 through to BDT 2025. It would be fair to say that stash was something of a token effort on some of the earlier tours, gradually improving year on year until Langers re-emerged on tour on BDT 2011 and from that point the quality (or should that be quantity?!) of stash increased substantially!

Langers perhaps hit his peak when 24 Titleist bags arrived from China at his Cheshire abode in 2019 – his missus Pip was absolutely delighted as I'm sure you can imagine! One of those bags is still missing, incidentally, so please 'fess up if you own two of these bags!!

Everyone has their own personal favourite item, from Jamal to the BDT 2008 Shoebags, from the BDT 2014 outer layers to the Ollie caps on BDT 2015 and each tourist's personal preference will be revealed in the pre-tour player previews.



▶ **Watch:** Langers At The BDT 2021 OC!

Langers has continued to be a legend of the stash front and we look forward to the avalanche of stash that will surely arrive for the tour's 25th anniversary!!

We love seeing each year's stash, and we're equally fond of Langers' speech at the OC. A Retriever at heart, Langers normally sets off quickly out of the blocks such that, come the OC, coherence can be something of an issue...just one example of this can be seen from this clip of the BDT 2021 OC at Celtic Manor! Langers, you are a legend.

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

The stash for Scottsdale was a BDT rucksack for each Dog and a Nike Golf t-shirt in three colours.

The 2026 Stash

Dallaglio v Farrell, BDT 2008, Lisbon OC

80

BDT 2008 · Lisbon

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

▶ Watch: Take 1

▶ Watch: Take 2

▶ Watch: Take 3

▶ Watch: Take 4

Those with long memories will recall that at the OC in Dubai I was appointed as the "record-keeper" for the tour. It was this appointment that inspired the first tour website and also the post-tour review DVD of BDT 2007: Dog Wars.

In the build-up to BDT 2008, once he had got beyond his "Turkey/Lisbon" shambles, tour organiser Ash had several ideas up his sleeve to spice up the tour, including the screening at the OC of a pre-tour DVD featuring the Captains.

As we sat down one winter's evening to write the script, the pair of us realised there was potential for some creative fun, with the two captains for the tour being Buzz and Marshy – the Andy Farrell and Lawrence Dallaglio doppelgangers!

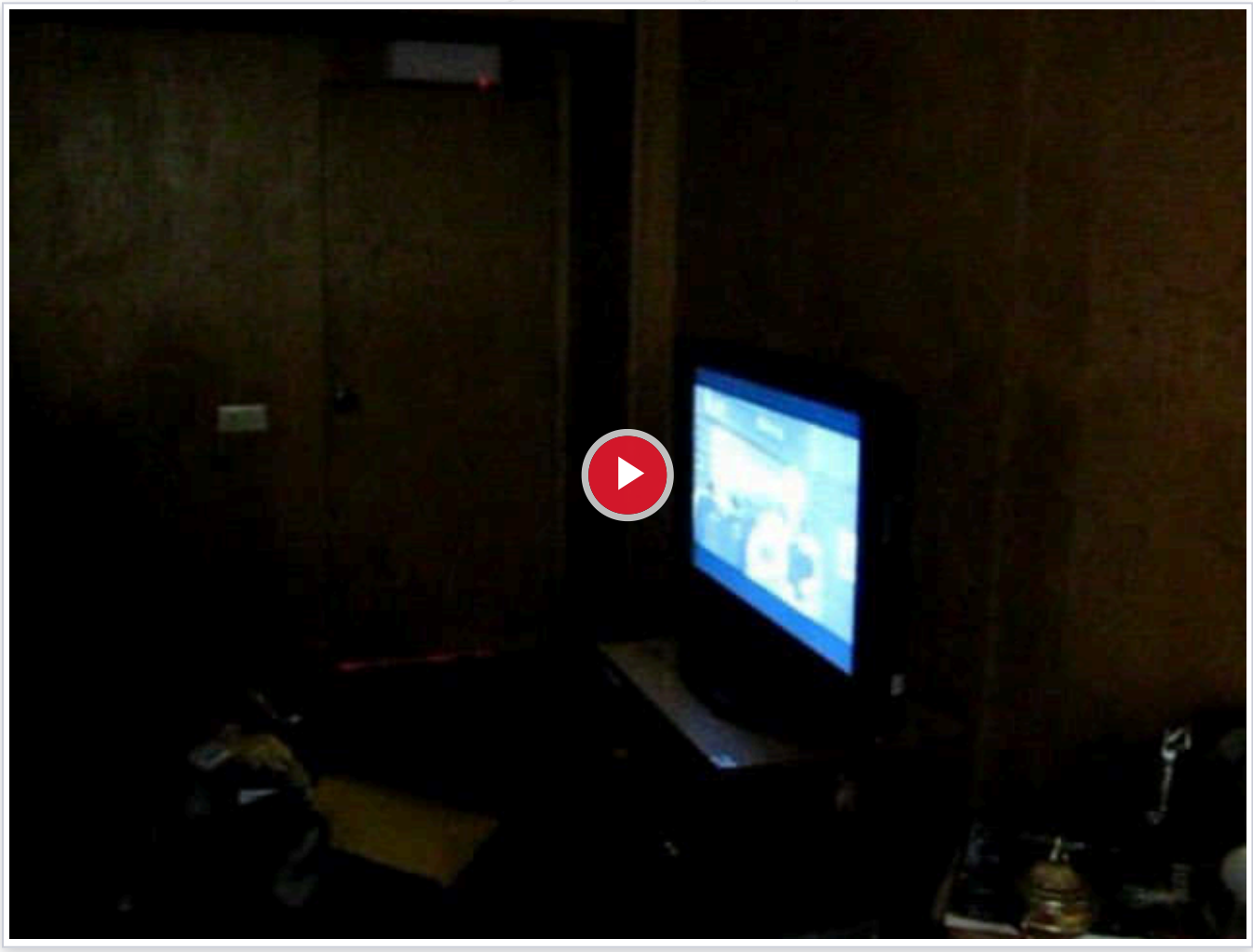
One Wigan Warriors and one Wasps rugby jersey later, O Fortuna blaring out in the background and we had one of the all-time great moments of any BDT build-up!

However, it did take quite a few takes before we got the actual version – check out the never seen before footage above!

For the record, a Buzz-inspired Wigan won that tour but when they recreated their rivalry on BDT 2017, Marshy's Wasps took revenge.

Back to the OC, it's safe to say the final version of Dallaglio v Farrell went down well!!

▶ **Watch:** Buzz v Marshy – The Final Cut



▶ **Watch:** BDT 2008 OC

Dog Spots

79

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Since we started collecting them in the mid-2000s we have amassed so many Dog Spots that we are definitely into the 1000s. They can all be seen on the BDT website / app at the History > Dog Spots page: Dog Spots | Big Dogs Tour and there are some simply incredible spots among them so it is well worth a look. The Buzz category alone has nearly 100!

There are far too many to share in this document so I have taken just a selection, being Player Names and Player Nicknames for each Dog. We are not too far away from having a full house in both categories, missing ones just for those Dogs whose B&W mugshot you can see below, so this is something to work on over the coming months. Thankfully one of our virgins, Steve, already had plenty by his name!

Enjoy and don't forget to send in yours for this year if you haven't already!

Player Names

Adam G

Adam T

Ash

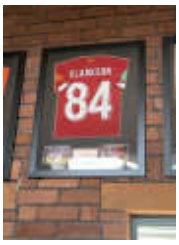
Bean

Boggy

Boysie

BT

Buysai

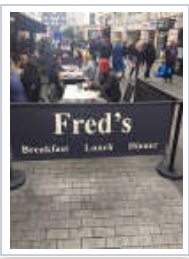


Buzz

Charlie

Coxy

DT



Fred

Gav

Glenn

Harbo

Hulmey

Hursty

Jules

Kenners

Kezza

Knoxy

Langers

Langrish

Little

Lordy

Marcus

Marshy

Oli D

Oli G

Ollie

Paddy

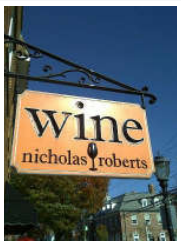
Picko

Purlo

Ravo

Rick

Rob



Robbo

Rufus

Steve

Tom

Tully

Tyzzer

Player Nicknames

Adam G

Adam T

Ash

Bean

Boggy

Boysie

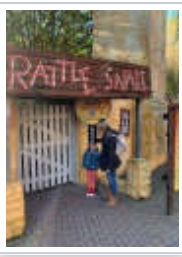
BT

Buysai

Buzz

Charlie

Coxy



DT

Fred

Gav

Glenn

Harbo

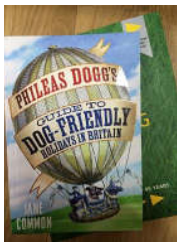
Hulmey

Hursty

Jules

Kenners

Kezza



Knoxy

Langers

Langrish

Little

Lordy

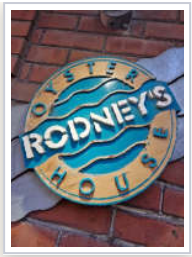
Marcus

Marshy

Oli D

Oli G

Ollie



Paddy

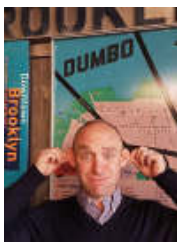
Picko

Purlo

Ravo

Rick

Rob



Robbo

Rufus

Steve

Tom

Tully

Tyzzer

Skoda v Mercedes

78

BDT 2002 · Marbella · Featuring Boysie, Hursty, Robbo, Paddy, BT, Langers & Ash

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

In our next memory, Boysie recalls a day in the life of the Inaugural Tourists from BDT 2002 to Marbella. This was a tour memorable for all sorts of reasons, not least Boysie's own creation of the memorable phrase: "BOYSIE'S UP!" during our beach volleyball sessions on Mistral Beach! Over to Boysie to take us through a standard day on the Inaugural Tour!

Mistral Beach – Scene of the legendary "BOYSIE'S UP"!!!

BOYSIE

"Skoda v Mercedes"

Location: Marbella House and the motorway between Marbella and Malaga
Weather: Blistering
Date: September 2002
Event: The Inaugural Tour

Having spent a very, very heavy night on the tiles this intrepid inaugural Dog (originally tourist) returned to Marbella House which was the accommodation for the duration of our seven day stay.

For a large part of that original tour we brave seven were accompanied by the "dogged" (in the sense of persistent) Rosie Watson and Alex Lloyd. I cannot now recollect either of these individuals with any real clarity such is the startling lack of impact either of them had on my life save for one incident which I shall later recount. These ladies had a greater impact upon some of my fellow inaugurals.

Alex & Rosie

By way of background BT was at the height of his pattering abilities, Robbo was lovelorn and Ash was still in the infancy of his now truly developed and magnificent c*ck blocking technique which I know that all Dogs have come to know and love.

My own arrival at Marbella House on this fateful morning had involved a small spot of breaking and entering as I was keyless. There could have been no question that I had entered the correct villa as BT was crooning along to Elvis' "Suspicious Minds", Langers No Wangers was muttering about having no underwear and Paddy was snoring while lying on a sun lounger located next to the plunge pool.

Monkey Hurst had returned to base and was keen for pranks to be played. It was at this point that he lifted the inert Dineen and sun bed into the plunge pool which could have led, but fortunately did not, to a drowning incident. Thank goodness that young Ash had retained his wits otherwise the Tour Rules would not have been drafted.

These high jinks, and not the 15 vodka lime and lemonades, led me to conclude that it was time for bed. I sauntered jauntily into the master suite which I was sharing with Robbo. The time was approximately 6am. I knew that BT had retired to Colditz having had a row with all and sundry about his antics in the Argentinean restaurant and I was aware that the only missing tourist was my "roomie". Unconcerned for his well-being, I fell asleep.

Some time later I was awoken by the noise of giggling and slurping. Ever curious and alert I opened an eye. The noises were emanating from the bed adjacent to my own. Wondering whether we were being burgled I made the conscious decision not to make any sudden or alarming movements.

To my surprise a woman's voice said "Oooh that tickles" at which a man, who I now know to be Nicholas William Roberts, began to chuckle. It was not a chuckle I recognised from my fellow tourist and a man I had known for 15 years. It was a primeval and beastly noise which bore testimony to the horrors that I feared I would have to endure.

Fellow Dogs; I can shed no light on what precisely Robbo was doing to cause such amusement and for those who witnessed the "lob" incident in Lagos they will be aware that in all likelihood it had nothing to do with his manhood. That thing is incapable of tickles.

Paddy's Pool!

The murmurings and mutterings continued for what seemed like an eternity and although it took a great effort to stifle laughter, particularly at Robbo's pillow talk, I can say with some certainty that the most alarming part of all concerned the manner in which "Big Ears" approached his victim's nipples.

Seemingly tenderness was not a word in Robbo's vocabulary at that time and for those of you who have witnessed the way in which the three-time Tour Champion approaches the consumption of a "Calippo" will no doubt be able to call to mind the precise manner and vigour in which he tackled what appeared, from my vantage point at least, to be an impressively pert pair of teats (or udders if you prefer).

Slowly the daylight grew stronger and mercifully Robbo passed out. Within a few short hours the seven of us had no option but to rouse ourselves and prepare to head to Atalaya, the venue of the second and final round of the Inaugural Tour.

Unfortunately Robbo, the man with the intimate working knowledge of the location of golf courses on the Costa Del Sol, remained overheated after his exertions earlier in the day and had neglected to secure proper directions to the course for the Dogs. Not a problem; the tee time was late in the afternoon and the departure time allowed travelling and warmup time.

Robbo models Rosie!

After one hour and 30 minutes of driving repeatedly along the same stretch of motorway between Marbella and Malaga the inaugural tourists learnt the following:

1. A Skoda Fabia can travel at speeds of up to 200km/h when I am at the wheel (that's what the clock said and I am sticking with it) (see FastestLaps.com);
2. A Mercedes A Class is incapable of maintaining the pace of the Skoda Fabia as evidenced by the call from Monkey Hurst to Robbo pleading that the Skoda slowed down because he could not keep up and he was "frightened" of rolling said Mercedes (Hursty is a mard ar$e) (see FastestLaps.com);
3. That Langers could have done with some wangers given how fast the cars were travelling; and
4. Robbo, nipples and directions do not make happy bedfellows.

Dogs; a snippet of the Inaugural Tour.
Barnabus

Ticket to Ride

77

BDT 2006 · Mallorca · Featuring Purlo

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

BDT 2006 and the venue was Mallorca. It was Hawaiian night and the Dogs had stumbled across a distinctly average karaoke bar but, as always, we made the most of the situation presented to us.

The call was made that every Dog had to bang out a tune in front of his fellow hounds; cue some frantic scrambling through the dog-eared pages of the songbook. It was early into the trip and so Purlo had made his customary electric start out of the blocks and was absolutely flying!

Being a traditionalist, he landed on “Ticket to Ride” as his tune of choice and before long he had us entranced with his utterly ridiculous surfing moves, his gangly frame gyrating everywhere!

The Dogs were already in stitches when, unfortunately, Purlo lost control of his bearings and after one of his bizarre moves he stumbled then plummeted off the stage! To be fair he somehow retained control of the mike and was back in his stride a few notes later!

To this day, anyone who was there that day who hears the opening bars of the Beatles classic is immediately transported back to that moment. Genius.

The Famous BT Headlock

▶ **Watch:** Purlo nails Ticket to Ride!

Little Impersonates Ravo

76

BDT 2010 · Girona · Featuring Little, Ravo, Hursty & Oli G

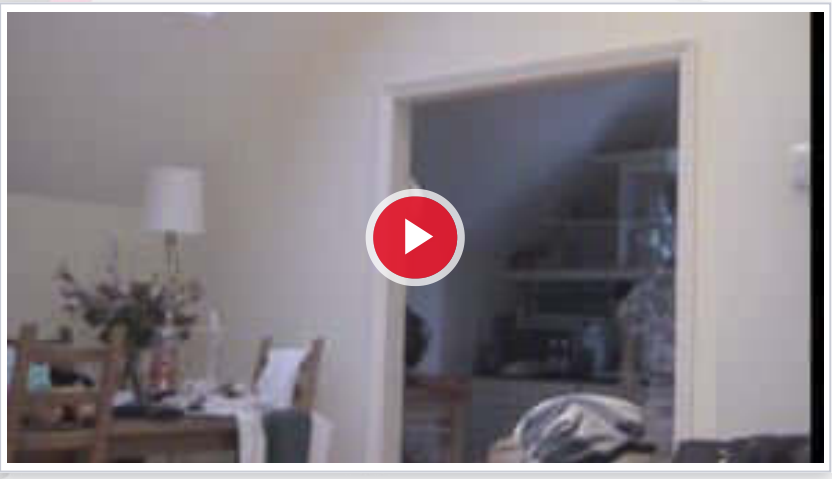
Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

The 2010 Captains' Challenge video was filmed in Ravo's flat in Fulham, with Oli G and Little on captaincy duty. The "X" Factor was big news at the time, with Joe McElderry (who?) seeing off Olly Murs in a finale watched by millions. Consequently, the chosen theme was The "Rex" Factor, which involved the Captains providing impressions of their teammates, which the judges (Ravo and I) had to rate.

With Hursty also in attendance to administer shots, impressions included Little doing a memorable impression of Boggy with his tanning lamp and Oli impersonating Fred as a very loud Gallic golfer.

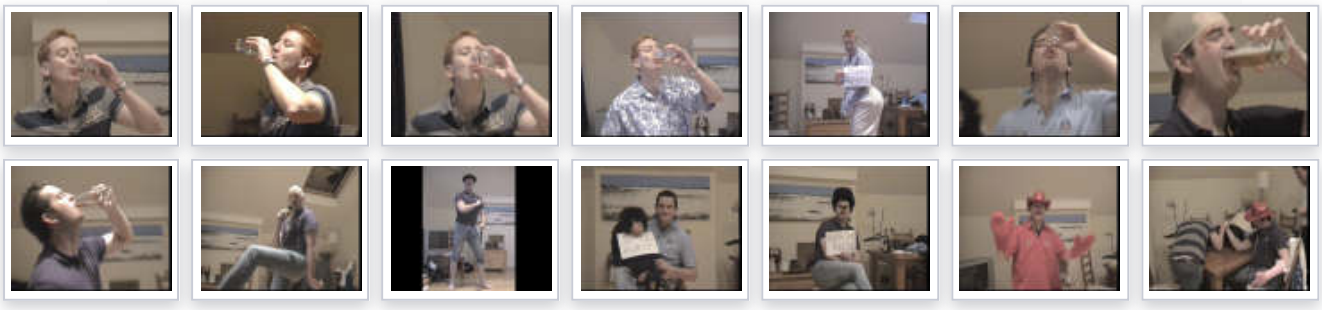
Naturally, Ravo, Hursty and I were interested to see what impressions the Captains had in store for each of us personally and it came to Little's turn to do Ravo. With Little taking an inordinate amount of time to prepare himself for his performance we waited with a sense of intrigue (and in Ravo's case, distinct nervousness).

Finally Little emerged from the kitchen in a pair of Ravo's 42" jeans with, I believe, two pillows shoved down them whilst sporting an oversized Hawaiian. Waddling across the sitting room he proceeded to liberally chuck monopoly money all over the place with a touch of disdain.



▶ **Watch:** Little's impersonation of Ravo!

A quite sensational opening gambit that proved very hard to follow and, with the benefit of hindsight, our ratings were very stingy although Ravo's perhaps understandably so!



BDT 2010 Preview Antics

The Venues

75

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

2014: Villa el Canine, Marbella

2002: Marbella Apartment

2003: La Manga Bungalows

2004: Marina Club, Lagos

2005: The Old Village, Vilamoura

2006: Marina Portals, Mallorca

2007: Novotel, Dubai

2008: Altis Grand Hotel, Lisbon

2009: Le Meridien Dona Filipa, Vale do Lobes

2010: Melia Hotel, PGA Catalunya

2011: Doral Golf Resort, Miami

2012: Villa el Canine, Marbella

2013: Villa el Canine, Marbella

2015: Barseback Golf Resort Bungalows, Malmö

2016: Castillo Hotel Son Vida, Mallorca

2017: Tryp Bellver Hotel, Mallorca

2018: Hotel Primus, Valencia

2019: Bond Villas, Cyprus

2020: The Belfry, Sutton Coldfield

2021: Celtic Manor, Newport

2022: Algarve Villa, Lagos

2023: Gloria Hotel Resort, Antalya

2024: Gloria Hotel Resort, Antalya Tour Accom over the years

2025: Hotel dar Sabra, Marrakech

As the tour has evolved there can be no doubt that the standard of our accommodation has improved significantly over the years. Our first digs were a bang average apartment and some of the other early kennels were Yourgolftravel specials; that's before we talk about the allegedly 5* Altis Grand Hotel in Lisbon!

Things probably first took a significant upturn in 2012 when we stayed in Villa el Canine for the first time and we enjoyed the place so much we had a hat-trick of tours there.

Other standout accommodation is the 15th anniversary tour hotel, Castillo Hotel Son Vida in Mallorca and the BDT 2019 Cyprus "James Bond" villas, whilst last year's villa-hotel in Marrakech has to be right up there with anywhere we have stayed.

It would be interesting to hear everyone's favourite and least favourite digs over the course of 24 tours. For me, Villa el Canine still takes some beating although Hotel dar Sabra runs it close!

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

BDT 2026 was based at the Scottsdale Villas.

One of the Scottsdale villas

Barnabus!

74

BDT 2002 · Marbella · Featuring Boysie, Hursty & Robbo

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

A memory explaining why Boysie responds to the name "Barnabus".... (as well as Brian)!

The scene of Barnabus!

Location: Palms Beach Bar, Marbella Port.

Weather: Stinking Hot

Time: Circa 3pm, Tuesday 3 September 2002, the first full day of the Inaugural Tour

To set the scene, the inaugural tourists had risen from their slumbers at around 2.30pm after what was supposed to have been a "quiet night".

We decided to head into Marbella Old Town to broaden our horizons, get a feel of the place, see the sights, mix with the locals, that sort of thing.

Robbo, our man with the local knowledge, steered a slightly circuitous route, which by pure chance took us past a little beach bar called “Palms”. The phrase "how's about we have a cheeky quiet one here just to settle the nerves" was muttered by The Monkey, I seem to recall.

After our first round of Stella Miguels, and then a second, third and fourth, the stories started coming out as usual. Hursty asked Robbo if he knew anybody in Marbella, to which

Robbo replied: "No, not really". Then the next 2 rounds of Stella Miguels arrived free from people who knew Robbo who happened to be sitting at the bar, to which Hursty remarked: "I think I like this place!". Before we knew it we were in the midst of a Leo Sayer.

Robbo seemed delighted that his numerous lines on BT had not been heard before by Langers No Wangers, and so his full repertoire came out, to the amusement of everyone.

All the while, Boysie had been keeping his own counsel, happily soaking up a few rays and enjoying the banter. The topic of conversation turned to: "What is the worst job you have ever had". I had recently nearly killed a fellow employee when rocketing a bag of shoe uppers down a 40 foot high chute at Newman's Shoe Factory, so I feel fairly certain that I introduced this particular topic.

Cue Boysie:

BOYSIE

"I recall Graham (Boysie's dad) telling me that I needed to toughen up a bit, experience the real world and mix with the working class, before I settled into my prosperous career as a solicitor. Before I knew it, Graham had fixed me up with a position, and I was striding into a local car mechanics with a copy of The Times tucked under my arm and perhaps, one might say, not quite dressed appropriately for the occasion.

I was greeted curtly by three shaven-headed, tattooed chaps, who glanced up from their copies of the Daily Sport and looked me up and down in a way that suggested we were never going to become close pals.

> After a very brief interrogation, I was led by one of the said skinheads into a back office, and handed a mop and bucket: "The garage floor needs a bloody good clean. But you can start with the downstairs toilet."
>
> Now I was not quite sure what I had expected when I pitched up for a role at a car mechanics, but needless to say it wasn't necessarily to be mopping floors, and certainly not cleaning up fresh faeces. However, eager to make a good impression on my new colleagues I headed off, mop and bucket in hand, to the downstairs toilet, which I subsequently found to be a generous description of the place where these chaps tended to p!ss and sh!t without any real concern as to whether they were hitting the pan or not. To add to my joy, as I reached the toilet the door swung open and by far the largest, fattest one of the skinheads came out proudly saying: "foooking hell lad, you might want to give that a minute!"
>
> At this point I was angrily questioning the wisdom of Graham's decision but, reluctantly, I carried on with my cleaning duties and generally tried to keep a low profile. However, by lunchtime on the first day, it became apparent that I had acquired a new name:
>
> Barnabus.
>
> Apparently because I was posh."

At this point Boysie did try to continue with his story, but was unable to do so, as one or two of us were actually crying. The name Barnabus has never been the same since.

Barney Dog Spots

The Tour Favourite

73

Across the tours · Featuring Ash & Boysie

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

A tradition of every tour is that, not long before we depart, we announce the "Tour Favourite" for that tour. This is always a tough task, one that requires detailed analysis of the form of all of the Dogs in order to reach an independent, unbiased conclusion.

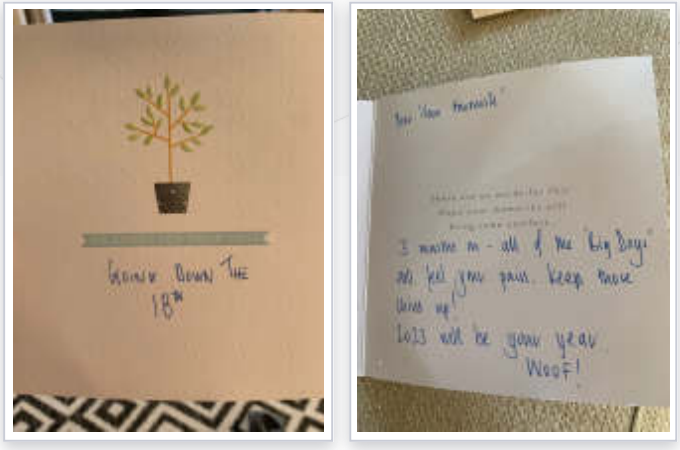
Here is a list of the TFs over the years and we await the 2026 announcement with bated breath!!!

YEAR	TF	YEAR	TF	YEAR	TF	YEAR	TF
2002	Ash	2008	Ash	2014	Ash	2020	Ash
2003	Ash	2009	Ash	2015	Ash	2021	Ash
2004	Ash	2010	Ash	2016	Ash	2022	Ash
2005	Ash	2011	Ash	2017	Ash	2023	Ash
2006	Ash	2012	Ash	2018	Ash	2024	Ash
2007	Ash	2013	Ash	2019	Ash	2025	Ash

Being announced as the TF is a little like winning the Par 3 Comp held on the Wednesday before the Masters kicks off where the Par 3 winner has never gone on to win the Masters itself that year. In a similar vein, the TF has never gone on to win the tour!

Ash has come very close to beating the TF curse, with two second place finishes on BDT 2006 and BDT 2022. The latter loss involved a gut-wrenching experience on the 54th and last hole of the tour, with a hotly debated penalty shot call being made by his brother James meaning that Ash was to lose the tour at the final hurdle by just one point.

After this experience Boysie demonstrated how much sympathy was felt for Ash by all the Dogs by sending the card shown in the images below and we can be sure that all the Dogs are behind Ash once again as he prepares for yet another assault on the Green Jacket!



Boysie's Condolences Card to Ash

The Final Putts

72

BDT 2023 & 2024 · Featuring Gav, Langers, Rufus, Hulmey & Robbo

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

BDT 2024 in Turkey was a fiercely contested tour. On BDT 2022, the Bloodhounds had won back the Ryder Cup and then on BDT 2023 they had retained it after a 12-12 draw so they were looking to hold onto the cup for a third successive tour, whilst the Retrievers were equally keen to win it back!

The 18th at Gloria New Course was a tremendous finishing hole. A Par 5 with water all the way down the left meant that there were plenty of squeaky bums on the tee and no less than three matches had already been decided on the 18th with the water coming into play on a number of occasions!

When the final group reached the tee, the Retrievers needed one point from the two remaining matches which were Hulmey v Rufus and Langers v Gav. Rufus was 1UP on Hulmey but hit the drink three times (!) to lose the hole and secure just half a point. So, quite incredibly, after three rounds of golf and 1,187 holes between that year's 22 golfers, the destiny of the Ryder Cup all came down to the final match, between Langers and Gav.

To amplify the pressure on their shoulders, all the Dogs congregated by the 18th green to watch the denouement.

▶ **Watch:** The Final Putt of BDT 2024!

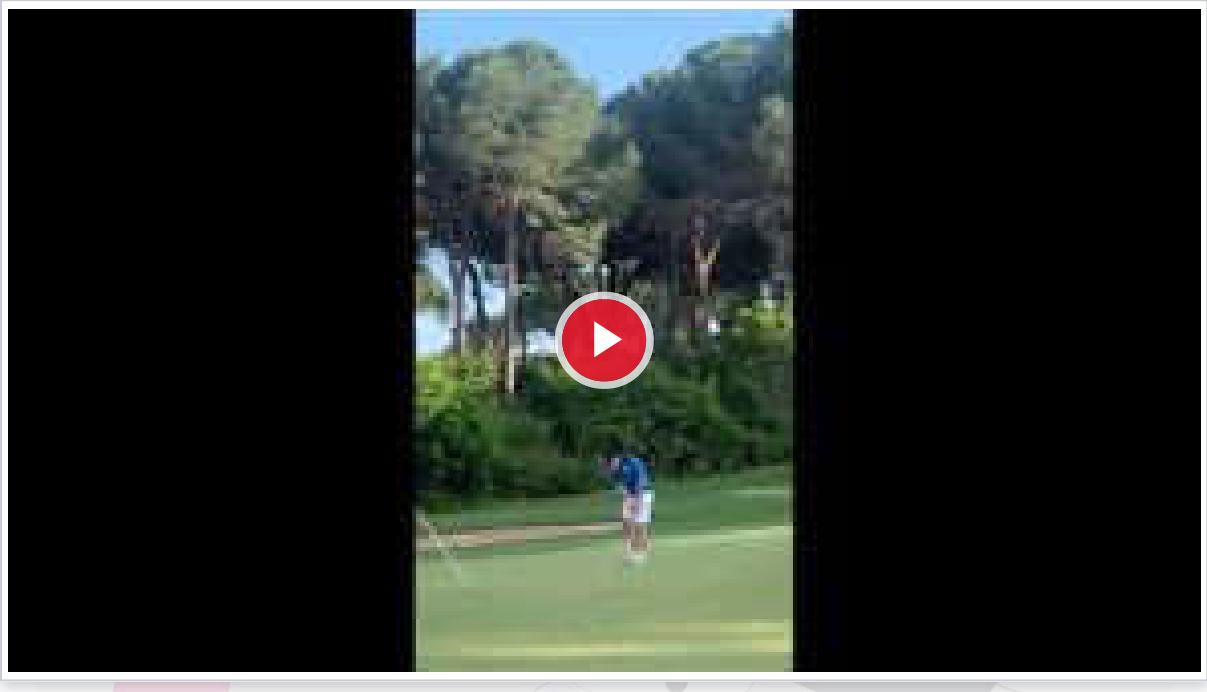
It was neck and neck as they approached the green, although Gav hit a chip around 25 feet past the hole, whereas Langers was a little closer. Gav rolled his putt down the slope but it went a good few feet past! Langers hit a great putt that almost dropped but ended at gimme length! So it all came down to Gav's final putt – talk about pressure!

Sadly for the Retrievers, but to the Bloodhounds' great joy, the putt just drifted right and the Bloodhounds "retained the retain"! The moment was captured on camera for posterity!

Equally incredibly, this was the second consecutive tour on which everything came down to the final putt. On BDT 2023, the final match was Langers vs Robbo, a titanic battle which also happened to be between two of the leading protagonists for the Green Jacket that year.

Being one down on 18, Robbo could not win the match and with the Retrievers needing a whole point to win back the Ryder Cup the most that could be achieved was a half point in order to ensure that the Bloodhounds only retained the trophy that they had won on BDT 2022, rather than winning it.

Again, the key moment was captured for posterity on camera…



▶ **Watch:** The Final Putt of BDT 2023!

The closest five finishes on BDT

#	TOUR	VENUE	SCORE (BH – RT)	RESULT
1=	BDT 2014	Marbella	10 – 10	Drawn – Retrievers retained the cup
1=	BDT 2023	Turkey	12 – 12	Drawn – Bloodhounds retained the cup
1=	BDT 2024	Turkey	11½ – 11½	Drawn – Bloodhounds retained the cup
4	BDT 2026	Scottsdale	11½ – 12½	Retrievers won by 1 point out of 24
5=	BDT 2006	Mallorca	7½ – 8½	Retrievers won by 1 point out of 16
5=	BDT 2010	Girona	8½ – 7½	Bloodhounds won by 1 point out of 16
5=	BDT 2017	Mallorca	7½ – 8½	Retrievers won by 1 point out of 16

From the Master Playbook. Three cups have been drawn; the next closest were won by a single point, so the 1-point wins are ranked by squad size.

Langers No Wangers

71

BDT 2002 & 2011 · Featuring Langers

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

In the very first moment we recalled the time when a rather sweaty BT turned up at our Marbella apartment on the Inaugural Tour. However, when the six inaugurals had landed at the same apartment the previous evening, some other shenanigans had been taking place.

As we dumped our gear in our rooms Robbo, chuckling away to himself, had taken me to one side to show me a pile of Bill Grundies in his suitcase. Nothing unusual there, I thought, except that (a) they weren't his – he had stolen them from Langers's case and (b) he had literally only met Langers for the first time a couple of hours beforehand!

I must admit I did snigger along, particularly the following morning when a confused Langers was telling the other Inaugurals he was "absolutely sure he had packed some undies" as Robbo cracked the now immortal nickname for the first time – "looks like you are Langers no Wangers for this trip then!".

I had assumed that Robbo would come clean at some point that same day but actually he didn't break the news until the final day of the trip, a week later, after Langers had gone commando for several days! Thankfully this did not seem to affect Langers too much although it could have become a serious issue had he been allowed to participate in the pole dancing competition he tried desperately to join during the week! Which in turn led to another nickname of "Pole Dog No Pants".

Langers No Wangers!

Clearly this episode seriously scarred Langers, to the extent that we did not see or hear from him for the next eight tours until he resurfaced in Miami for BDT 2011 (a trip that, coincidentally I'm sure, Robbo was not on!). After this trip, he found himself with yet another nickname, Wonga no Longa, and I will leave you in the company of the great man himself as he explains his rather expensive evening!

LANGERS

"I think it was our second night in Miami and I found myself in another far too cool for school club with only a couple of other dogs, Neil and Oli – we were in the R&B downstairs Club while the other boys let rip upstairs before deciding it was too busy and leaving.

It was my round and I left the other two to go for some drinks. Literally my last memories were talking to a massive 30 stone black guy who invited me over to talk to his entourage – randomly several women all with the same stripy dresses on. I recall them all saying they were in the film industry and had come from some shoot.

After my first round with them it seemed a good idea to put my card behind the bar to repay the hospitality. I would like to thank that group for taking £740 of my money in 24 minutes – in hindsight it wasn't surprising that everyone was on great form and I didn't realise the tab was racking up with my lovely generosity.

The worst bit about this story is not knowing I had spent this much until I got home a few days later and spoke to HSBC to discuss spending irregularities on my card. I lost the other Dogs I was with by the time I'd taken myself down with the Hollywood crew (so that saved me a round!!), went for a wander round the streets of Miami finding a suitable rippers and a one man taxi back to Doral.

A very painful night on the wallet; however, I'd like to think they too recount that story of a p!ssed-up Brit buying everyone drinks to this day...If anyone recalls the name of said club, please advise so I can email them about getting a receipt breakdown..."

Pole Dog No Pants!

Langers contemplates his woes

Spikes!

70

BDT 2002 · Marbella · Featuring Hursty

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

This one is a tour tail courtesy of the Monkey, entitled: "Changing Spikes". It comes from BDT 2002 and is yet another “sweating” incident from that Inaugural Tour. Over to James.

Atalaya – Zero Recollection!

HURSTY

“Well, having racked my brain through all the memoirs of tours gone by I had to settle on a tour tail which has to go down as one of the lowlights of my Big Dogs Tour Career to date.

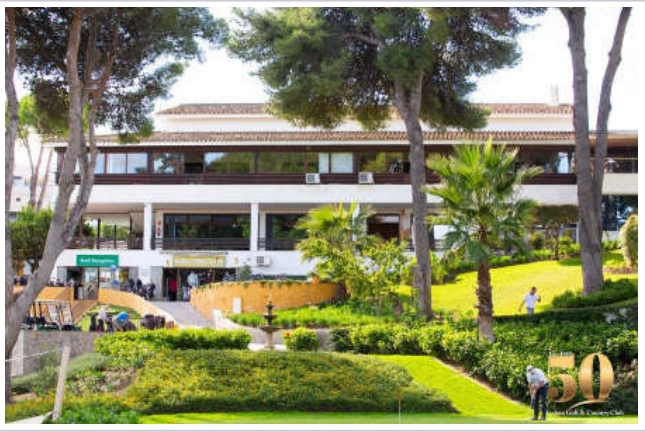
The incident occurred on the penultimate day of the Inaugural Tour following what can only be described as a week-long drinking session with a couple of token rounds of golf chucked in for good measure!

Ravo had recommended the choice of course for our second round having been out there with work a few weeks earlier and had kindly given us some cheeky discount vouchers providing us with half price golf with some buggies. I bet not many of even the Inaugurals can remember the course; well, it was called Atalaya.

Anyway, having got in from Puerto Banus some four hours earlier we embarked upon our journey to the course some 20 minutes away during which I began to feel some demons entering the car who started trying to get into my head. This immediately made me slightly nauseous and it was a welcome relief when we arrived at our destination.

As I was responsible for organising the golf, I entered the pro shop to sign us all in and all was sweet until the Señor proclaimed that we were only allowed the buggies for nine holes. As it was 98 degrees and we had a week's beer sweats to contend with, this was far from ideal.

'No problemo' I said to the Spaniard, we will return them after 9 and walk the rest (turning round to BT and whispering under my breath... 'whatever!').



Atalaya Clubhouse – the Scene of the Sweats!

Worse, however, was soon to follow. As this was many years ago, rubber spikes were not the norm and I happened to be the only dog wearing the old spikes. So as I was clickety clicking away down the footpath, Señor called me back. 'No spikes on the golf course,' he said!! 'B*llocks', I said!

My options were twofold; I either bought a new pair of golf shoes (which having already spunked my month's salary wasn't ideal) or I set about taking my spikes out of my golf shoes with the stud screw lent to me by my new best enemy. I chose the latter which to this day I regret!

It soon became very obvious that my spikes weren't going to come out with ease and whichever bloke screwed them in did a damn good job of it. After 20 minutes and having finally managed to get through my first shoe I thought I was going to faint as sweat poured off every part of my body.

There and then I very nearly retired to the bar and let the guys get on with the round but no I battled on using every last bit of energy I could muster to get the second shoe done. Finally after possibly the worst half an hour of my life I released the last spike and was ready for the first tee, except that I was seeing stars and feeling incredibly sick! Thankfully I had a buggy!

Teeing off with my fellow dogs in the last group, the last place I really felt like being was on the first tee of a golf course in 98 degrees wearing golf shoes which felt like my work shoes!! Needless to say, teeing off down possibly the narrowest fairway ever, I sliced the ball right into the s.hit, nearly slipped on my ass and proceeded to have a 'mare!!

After 15 less than memorable holes, out of the distance came a rather angry looking Señor shouting and screaming expletives about us taking the buggies back after 9!! With little argument from me he red carded us all and promptly threw us off the course. What a relief!

I have to say, it was a tour experience I will never forget!"

An exhausted Monkey!

The Nicknames

69

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Nicknames (all of which can be seen at the link) used to form an integral part of both the OC and our tour shirts, until we decided we had run out of fresh ideas and canned them! The last tour on which the Captains dished out nicknames to their teammates was BDT 2016 when we awarded most Dogs their "best" nickname from previous years.

In the build-up to BDT 2010 Boggy arranged a vote for everyone's favourite three nicknames up to that point and the outcome is shown below, with two clear stand-outs!

1	Jack The Yipper	22
2	BigBumDog Millionaire	20
3	Harlem Globetopper	8
4	Barry Chuckle	7
5	The Pies Piper	5
6	Tonka	5
7	Smelly Patter	4
8	Weapon of Gas Destruction	4
9	Chewhacker	4
10	Double Hit Dumbo	3
11	Phileas Dogg	3
12	Ratemybody.com	3
13	Red Love	3
14	Thunderpants	2
15	Pickofords	2
16	Fresh Ear	2
17	Abacus	2
18	Roland	1
19	Quick Crafty	1
20	Buzz Driver	1

Since that vote there have undeniably been some further absolute belters, however, which should not be forgotten. Two of these emanated from BT's infamous "just a quiet one lads" stag do in Archerfield, with Ravo's "Hong Kong Pooey" and DT's "Bananaman" providing a painful reminder of events for each!

Other stand-outs include Charlie's "Sheik n Back" on BDT 2013, after missing the previous tour, and "Little Red Driving Good" on BDT 2014 a particularly smart one perfect for our cleverest dog.

A handful of the nicknames are now a permanent part of the tour lexicon, such as "Buzz Driver", "Tonka", "Red Love" and "Quick Crafty"!

There have been some which were considered close to the bone, not least two of Hursty's in "Floppy Seconds" and "Giggsy"!

One that always particularly tickles me is Charlie's story on arrival in Malmö for BDT 2015. As is customary, he was wearing the previous year's tour shirt to the airport and had realised as he was passing through Dubai customs that his 2014 nickname "Arabian Sh*tes" was emblazoned on his shirt sleeve! Not ideal and Charles was perhaps fortunate to arrive in Sweden with all limbs intact!

Arabian Sh*tes!

Others were simply inevitable with "Paul Chuckle" a certainty for Adam T when he first joined brother Barry on the tour on BDT 2013 and "Brian" an absolute shoo-in for Boysie on BDT 2016 after Jules's mishap on BDT 2015.

"Heston" was a no-brainer for Rob after this most extraordinary Doggelganger moment in the airport:

Which one is Rob?!

The nicknames have undoubtedly provided much amusement over the years and to this day many of them still raise a smile, but the question is: who has the greatest set of nicknames?!

It's a close-run thing but for me it comes down to three Inaugural Tourists, Ash, BT and Hursty:

TOUR	ASH	BT	HURSTY
BDT 2004	Petrescu	Smelly Patter	Chewbacca
BDT 2005	Roland	Very Smelly Patter (VSP)	Wookie
BDT 2006	Jill	Very Smelly Fatter (VSF)	King Kong
BDT 2007	Jack The Yipper	The Pies Piper	Hair of the Dogs
BDT 2008	Mysingle-friend.yip	BT Baracus	Chewhacker
BDT 2009	Rent Boy	Bourvil	Weapon of Gas Destruction
BDT 2010	Willyouever-bonkher	Steve Bould	Steve Kong
BDT 2011	Judas TIScariot	Straussy	Floppy Seconds
BDT 2012	The Vulture	Snake Hips	Giggsy
BDT 2013	The Letchurer	Siamese Chins	Titch
BDT 2014	MarBite	Maozinha	Jimmy Jam Jams
BDT 2015	Flashley	N/A	N/A

The choice is yours!

Silly Billy

68

BDT 2010 · Girona · Featuring Little, Fred, Hursty & Langrish

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Mexican Bandits!

In Memory 87 we recalled Derek Kill and the various drinking games that have long formed part of the tour's tapestry.

One such game came on night II of BDT 2010 when we went for a Mexican and Langrish came up with what can only be described as a very dangerous game! It was Hawaiian night and this proved to be a memorable evening on the tour as we were presented with sombreros by the waiters as soon as we sat down for dinner along with a constant flow of booze. Before long everyone was absolutely flying with Ash and Gav singled out for star jumps; Gav for being late on tour, but not sure what Ash's latest misdemeanour had been!

▶ **Watch:** Star Jumpers!

Langrish explained his game to the group. It was a simple one whereby each Dog had to take out his mobile phone, unlock it and pass it to the Dog on his left. That Dog would then read out to the group the very last text message which had been sent on that Dog's phone!

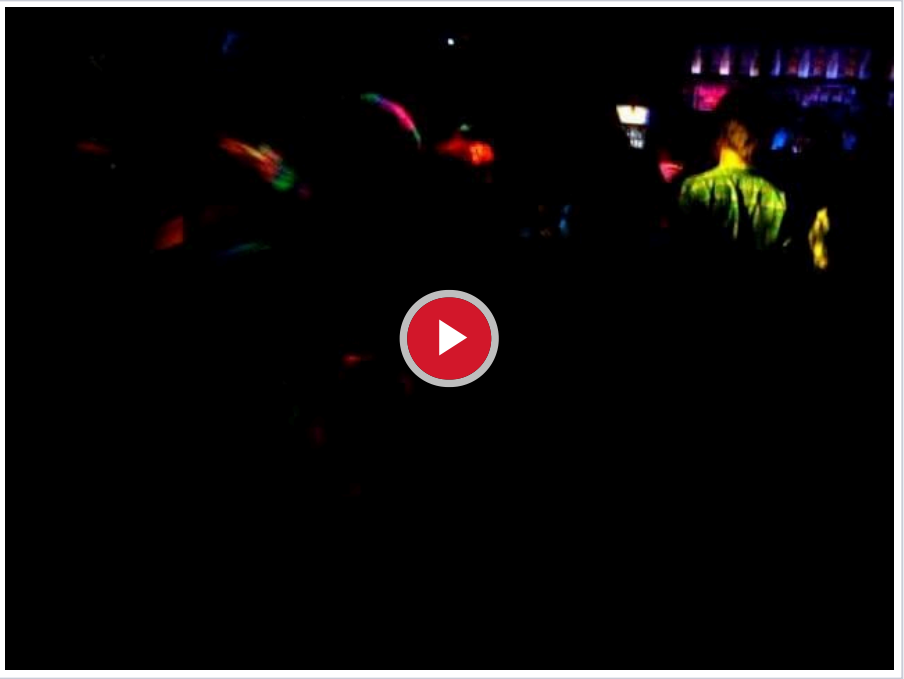
As Finemaster, Hursty had already expressed concerns that too many people were on their phones to their other halves on what, after all, was supposed to be a lads' golf trip, so he absolutely leapt upon the chance to enforce this. Amidst much grumbling, and before we could launch a counter-narrative, the Monkey was demanding that everyone had to unlock their phone and pass it to the person to their left...

The Dogs shifted most uncomfortably in their seats but, after much hectoring, everyone participated extremely reluctantly!

Whether it was due to a very rapid / secret deletion of certain messages by some of the Dogs or otherwise, many of the messages were actually pretty bland, until we got to Little's phone.

Fred was the designated reader and we had an inkling something good was coming as Fred struggled to compose himself; finally he revealed that in his very last message Ciaran had declared himself to be "such a Silly Billy" for losing his car keys! Cue uproarious laughter, especially from Fred who was particularly tickled and spent much of the rest of the tour (and beyond) shouting about "Silly Billies" with his finest Franglais pronunciation.

Another cracker came from BT's phone for his message of "Boooooo" hence the singing of "Boooo.....Silly Billy" later that evening....



▶ **Watch:** Boooo Silly Billy!

Double Hit DT?

67

BDT 2009 · Vale do Lobo · Featuring DT & BT

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

In early 2009 we were a player short for that year's tour and so we were in discussions with Big Danny Lord about making his tour debut. Sadly in the end Danny was unable to commit, but the discussions did yield some previously unseen material that ultimately made its way onto the BDT 2009 Preview DVD.

As we were emailing back and forth, Danny sent me some links to some YouTube footage promising that there was a segment within it that was well worth a watch – and he wasn't wrong!

▶ **Watch:** Double Hit DT? – The Clip

After immediately following the YouTube link I found myself watching a fairly bizarre feature show from the Matchroom Series with Dutch subtitles. It was the aftermath of Big Den's 1985 World Championship title win and a "day in the life" style feature interview was being conducted with Dennis, and he was playing Blackburn GC. Some minutes into the footage, who should appear but none other than our very own DT and BT!

At this point my interest levels rose several notches as I waited with interest to see what would unfold. The whole video is well worth a watch but I have extracted into the shortened version the segment from the BDT 2009 Preview DVD which contains two priceless moments:

- A series of duffed chips from our resident Tour Pro that Robbo (AKA "Double Hit Dumbo", as so memorably labelled by DT) in particular will be interested to scrutinise – did he simply lay a sod over one of them or was it a case of "Double Hit DT"?!
- A number of comments on BT's hair – who could have predicted what would happen in the years that followed!

Should you wish to view the whole of the YouTube footage please follow the links:

Matchroom Series - Snooker with Dennis Taylor - Part 1

Matchroom Series - Snooker with Dennis Taylor - Part 2

Matchroom Series - Snooker with Dennis Taylor - Part 3

Matchroom Series - Snooker with Dennis Taylor - Part 4

The Nike T-Shirt

66

Across the tours · Featuring Ash & Robbo

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

The Iconic Shirt!

We have seen some "interesting" outfits over the years on BDT, but surely no other single item of clothing has received the same levels of attention as Ash's "going out" shirt on the Inaugural Tour.

It was Robbo who first seized on Ash's trendy and subtle choice of gear, asking Ash (as he first appeared in it): "Who made that shirt Ash?!"

From that moment onwards it has become an iconic piece of clothing.

Although (unsurprisingly) the original version has never been seen again since, the theme has cropped up over subsequent tours hence some of the photos below.

Ash's T-Shirts over the years

However, although there have been several attempts to replicate it (and who knows, maybe there will be more in Scottsdale...?!), nothing will ever quite match that original version, as modelled below by Robbo.

In case you missed it, it's Nike!

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

The Dogs paid tribute to Ash's legendary attire by all wearing Nike golf shirts – see the photos below.

A Collection of Nikes

One Long Poo

65

BDT 2010 · Girona

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Another Poo Is Needed Imminently!

It was BDT 2010 and we were making our way to Girona via the usual dual departures of northern and southern flights plus our international jet-setters. The UK flights were landing at roughly the same time, with internationals Charlie and Knoxy not long behind, so the London lot sat down for a couple of beers whilst we awaited the various arrivals. Gav would be turning up late on his first tour, which may be dealt with in another memory...

The Northern Dogs duly landed in Girona and it wasn't long before everyone noticed they were one Dog light! 'Light' is the appropriate word here, as the Dog in question thought he would 'lighten the load' before boarding the plane in Manchester, having decided he had enough time to drop the kids off at the last minute.

This was potentially the single greatest error of judgement in BDT history as inexplicably Boysie missed his flight for what turned out to be the most expensive Douglas Hurd he's ever had! Showing much sympathy with Boysie's plight, the Dogs took a few photos to remind him that he was rapidly falling behind on the beers front, even counting the number for him!

One, two, three and counting....!

There were no other flights available that day and so Boysie eventually joined us the following day shortly before we were about to tee off for Round I, strolling towards us in a pair of deck shoes, paper tucked under his arm, with no clubs, golf shoes or clothes (these had not arrived with him!) yet still somehow grinning!

Boysie Finally Makes It To Girona!

In the aftermath of the tour a summary was circulated highlighting Boysie's tour adventures which, to be fair, he stayed incredibly calm about (although in hindsight it's surprising he ever wanted to tour again!).

Boysie's 2010 tour in bullet form:

- Misses plane to Girona, as he was having a Forrest
- Sees the Easyjet lady close the door to the plane and she won't re-open it to let him on… but remains calm
- Calmness remains for a further two hours, although his bag, which they had to take off the plane, has still not been returned
- Loses rag with said Easyjet lady after two and a half hours, with said bag still to arrive
- Drives home and books onto a flight for the following morning (another £200 or so)
- Arrives at airport in plenty of time the following morning, to ensure lightning does not strike twice
- Arrives in Girona to find that his golf clubs and bag have not
- Gets his ass whooped at golf in Round I, won in Round II, lost in Round III
- Has to go 'commando' on successive days
- Forced to borrow Oli's socks (a sheer act of desperation for anyone!)
- Gets fined for being late on tour
- Two nights of smash and a good craic
- Gets the Poodle prize for only touring for two nights
- Wins the St Bernard Trophy for a pin-seeking iron
- At the end of the tour, finds out his return flight has been cancelled
- Books onto another flight to Luton 11 hours later
- This flight is then delayed
- Arrives at Luton to find the place is like a football match, as every plane is landing there, 30 minute disembarkation and 50 minute wait at passport control
- Three hour drive from Luton to Liverpool
- 45 minute drive from Liverpool back home, arriving circa 6am
- His bag and golf clubs have still not turned up
- Rag lost again!

As an aside, we now have an idea of what Boysie's face would have looked like in Trap 2 at Liverpool airport, thanks to this portrait photo from BDT 2019, which Brian was most resistant to being taken as he was completely desperate for a dump at the time! Check out the now-infamous photo above!

The Paddywhacker

64

BDT 2005 · Vilamoura · Featuring Knoxy & Ash

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Knoxy's Paddywhacker is probably the most famous golf club to have graced the tour. Anyone who has played a round with the big guy will be extremely familiar with it as it is utilised for all shots in all situations, as his caddy in Marrakech found out when Knoxy proceeded to instruct him to pull it out for virtually every shot from 110 to 220!

The Paddywhacker!!

Consequently, one of the great moments of every tour is always our collective anticipation of what is to come on Round III when Knoxy is forced to employ his driver for its annual outing!

In the early days of tour, Knoxy had a temperamental relationship with his golf clubs and it's fair to say he was not a prolific point-scorer. Nowadays, it would not come as a surprise to see Knoxy take down any member of the opposition, but when he drew Ash in the singles on BDT 2005 the Dogs could be forgiven for thinking the result was a foregone conclusion.....WRONG!!!! This was surely the Paddywhacker's finest hour.

The story of how Ash was taken down is best described by the man himself in a story he has penned entitled "Yippity Yip"! Enjoy!

ASH

"As I sit here on a Sunday night with the demons swirling after two heavy sessions, I had a little flash back to my worst day on tour.

Vilamoura 2005. The scene of the Dark Tour. I am captaining a Bloodhounds team whose tails were wagging in some very interesting ways off the course but unfortunately not on it. Despite having all of about three hours sleep a night and suffering demons of an entirely different nature, the Retrievers were somehow managing to play some half decent golf and were 5-3 up going into the final round singles at Vila Sol. It was widely accepted on both sides that I had been a terrible captain and got my pairings all wrong.

Unhappy Ravo Dog!

Ravo in particular was not happy with the situation.

On a personal level, I was nowhere near the hunt for the Green Jacket. The pressure of captaincy had clearly told and I was playing some of the worst golf of my life; most disturbingly of all, a new phenomenon had started to creep into my short game; the chipping yips....

A rather bizarre disease whereby I would get a very severe attack of the demons every time I had a wedge in my hands, which meant that I would either dribble the ball forward and take a large divot that occasionally went further than the ball, or thin the ball from the fringe into a bunker on the other side of the green. No matter how many practice chips went to within 2 feet on the practice green, every chip was suddenly turning into an ordeal, much to the amusement of my playing partners.

As a result I did not feel that I was the man to lead the Bloodhounds out in the final round singles. I therefore put myself out last, by which time it would probably all be over. As it happened, I was in luck. I had been drawn against Knoxy Dog, a game I couldn't possibly lose no matter how many chips I yipped.

Father Abraham!

Or so I thought...

As I stood on the first tee at Vila Sol shortly after seeing BT spank yet another drive 280 yards down the middle, the beer sweats started and the demons began to swirl. Four hours earlier, I had been stripping off to the tune of Father Abraham. Now I needed to somehow find my game head.

I somehow managed to go 2 up but as I headed to the 4th tee, everything suddenly started to go wrong. Very wrong. Having hacked my way down the fairway in similar fashion to Knoxy, I found myself on the green with a two-foot putt for a double bogey. Knoxy had scrambled a triple bogey but had a shot, so my double bogey putt was for a half. Backswing, demons, yip, missed putt. Back to 1 up.

Scene of the Demons!

The 10th or thereabouts was a par five. I had hit a couple of reasonable shots to just short of the pond guarding the green. Knoxy was virtually out of the hole and struggling to make an 8. A pitch over the pond onto the green would leave me the luxury of 3 putts for the hole. Backswing, demons, yip, water. Reload. Backswing, demons, yip, water. Concede hole. All square.

And so it went on until the 17th when I found myself 2 down staring down the barrels of defeat. I hadn't had a par since the 2nd and Knoxy's grin was getting bigger by the minute. BT, who was practically talking Knoxy through every shot, could hardly contain himself. I needed to get up and down to take it down the last.

The Ryder Cup was over but personal pride was still at stake. Could I really lose to Knoxy?

Backswing, double demons, yip, thin, bunker. Game over. It had happened. I had lost to the worst golfer ever to grace the Big Dogs Tour and my Bloodhounds team had been demolished 11-5.

Knoxy enjoyed his beers that night. NOT my finest hour."

Handing over the Ryder Cup

Knoxy Celebrating!

The Courses

63

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

We have played some absolutely tremendous tracks over the course of 24 years on tour. By common consensus the stand-outs seem to be:

- The Emirates (Majlis)
- Al Badia
- PGA Catalunya
- Finca Cortesin
- Alcanada
- Monte Rei
- Fairmont Royal Palm

For consistency over a single tour, Dubai probably wins the overall accolade with the triumvirate of The Montgomerie, The Emirates (Majlis) and Al Badia all proving to be superb tracks.

The stats show the toughest track, with an average stableford score of just 22.5 points per Dog, has been the Jim McLean Signature course on BDT 2011 on which, following a post-round count, 135 balls were lost! Equalling that 22.5 point score is Penha Longa Atlantic but then the Monkey's 4-pointer does skew the overall average somewhat!

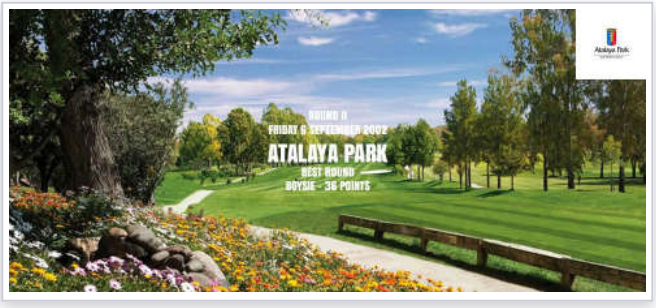
The toughest tour was also Miami where tricky courses combined with Ravo's Hour seem to have taken their toll on the 2011 tourists who averaged 75.94 points over the three rounds. Stats only go back to 2006, however, so it would be interesting to see what our scores were around the likes of Boavista!

The Dogs scored their best ever collective round on BDT 2022 when we played Morgado and averaged 36.25 points. In a further sign of how our golfing standards have improved with age, the best scoring tour was actually last year in Marrakech where the Dogs averaged 98.04 points; there was a time when reaching 100 points would pretty much guarantee you a Green Jacket!

All the tour tracks and best round on each are shown in the table below.

The final question is: "when has there been the greatest gulf in class on a BDT track?". You will find the answer in the video right at the very bottom of the table...the commentary alone is worth a listen!

2002: La Cala



2002: Atalaya Park

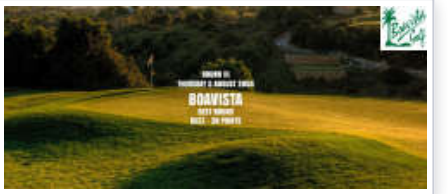
2003: La Manga North

2003: La Manga West

2003: La Manga North

2004: Penina

2004: Palmares

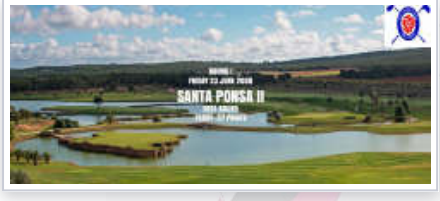


2004: Boavista

2005: Vilamoura Old Course

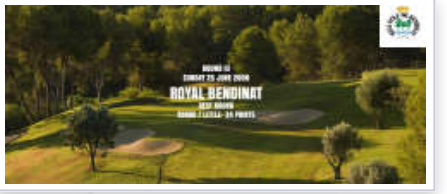
2005: Millennium

2005: Vila Sol

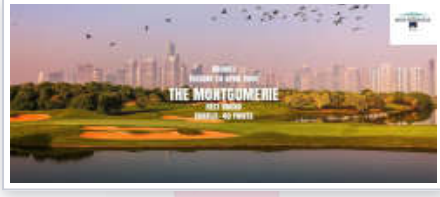


2006: Santa Ponsa II

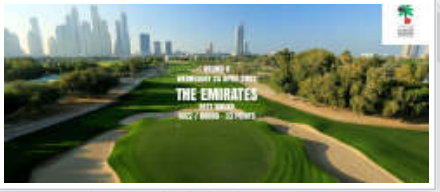
2006: Son Termens



2006: Royal Bendinat



2007: The Montgomerie



2007: The Emirates

2007: Al Badia

2008: Praia D'El Rey

2008: Penha Longa Atlantic

2008: Quinta do Peru

2009: San Lorenzo

2009: Quinta do Lago North

2009: San Lorenzo

2010: PGA Catalunya Tour

2010: PGA Catalunya Stadium

2010: PGA Catalunya Stadium

2011: Jim McLean Signature

2011: Great White

2011: Blue Monster

2012: Aloha

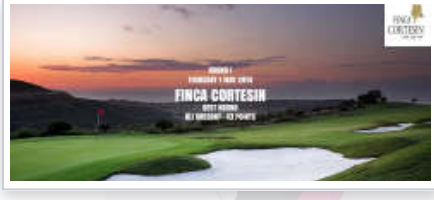
2012: Finca Cortesin

2012: Alferini

2013: Alferini

2013: Los Flamingos

2013: San Roque New



2014: Finca Cortesin

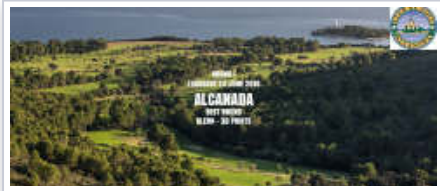
2014: Alferini

2014: Los Flamingos

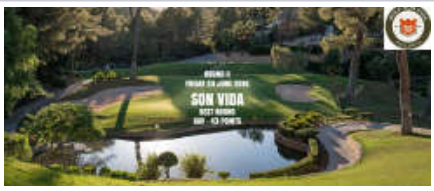
2015: PGA National Lakes

2015: Barseback Masters

2015: Barseback Donald Steel



2016: Alcanada



2016: Son Vida

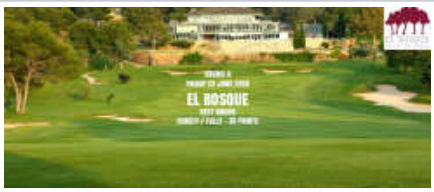
2016: Son Quint

2017: Alcanada

2017: Son Muntaner

2017: Son Gual

2018: El Saler



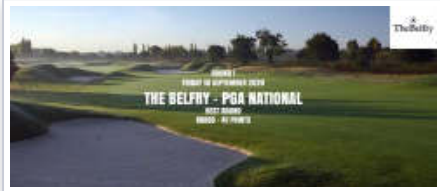
2018: El Bosque

2018: La Galiana

2019: Minthis Hills

2019: Secret Valley

2019: Aphrodite Hills



2020: Belfry PGA National

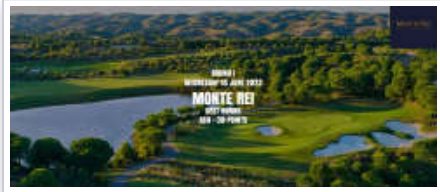
2020: Belfry Brabazon

2020: Belfry Brabazon

2021: Twenty Ten

2021: Roman Road

2021: Twenty Ten



2022: Monte Rei

2022: Morgado

2022: Penina

2023: Gloria Old

2023: Gloria New

2023: Gloria Old

2024: Carya

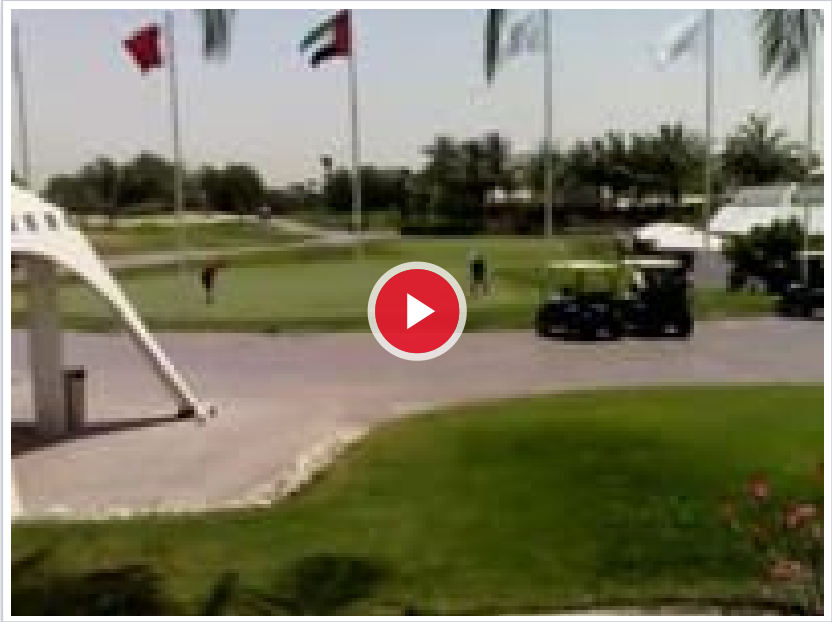
2024: Gloria Old

2024: Gloria New

2025: Assoufid

2025: Ourika

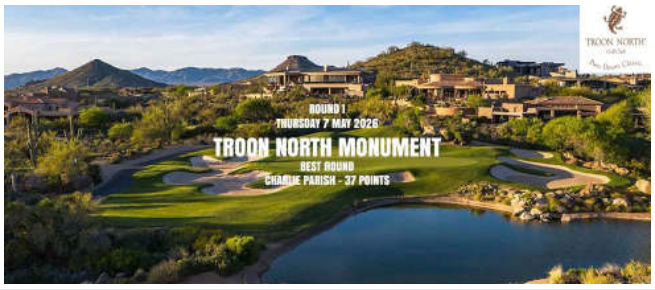
2025: Fairmont Royal Palm



▶ **Watch:** The biggest ever Gulf in Class!

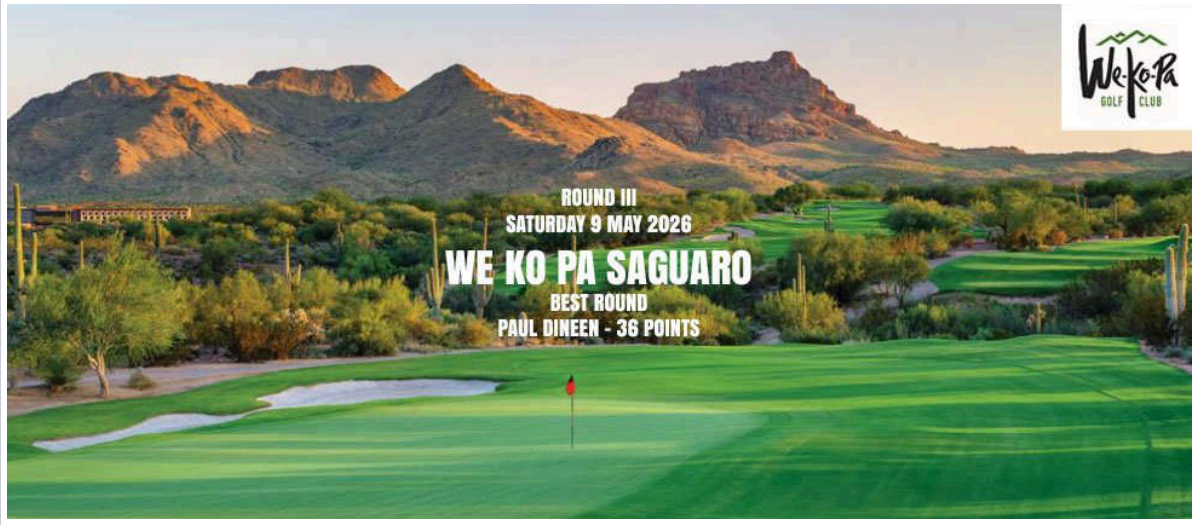
SINCE SCOTTSDALE

Scottsdale's courses were Troon North, Grayhawk and We-Ko-Pa (below). It was a tough week: the Dogs averaged 81.91 points and only one reached 100. Nonetheless, all three tracks would feature highly amongst the best courses we have played.



2026: Troon North

2026: Grayhawk Raptor



2026: We-Ko-Pa Saguaro

Dojo Dog

62

BDT 2007 · Dubai

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Over 24 years of touring there have been occasional scrapes and one such moment came on BDT 2007 in Dubai. DT describes the story from his perspective.

Fortunately a glancing blow!

DT

"Night II in Dubai involved, as always, lots of beer, a night club, 16 dogs and 1 fu***ng massive dog with the biggest guns I have ever seen!!

The dogs were tearing up the dance floor as per usual when a few of the boys spotted this one Big Dog!!!!! In his own little private roped-off VIP kennel. It was when I was pointing out the size of this dog's guns to Little dog (or maybe the size of his bird's guns!!!!!) he got a little angry and proceeded out of his kennel and headed straight for me!

The calm after the storm!

As always, BT dog and my good old bro stepped in as it looked like there could be a dog fight! As he stepped across this dog's path the dog just brushed him off as if he was not there; the brushing off causing BT dog a cut to the side of the napper and serious concussion!!! (Which affected him all night!!! Which is another story!!!)

As you can imagine I was quite pleased when I saw the bouncers (4 of them) trying to stop this massive angry dog getting to me!

I can honestly say I would not fancy all 16 dogs taking this dog down, let alone me on my own. After this dog got taken out the bouncers wanted to speak to BT dog and Little dog; very bravely or with no real choice the boys went outside with the threat of round 2 with massive dog!!!

I only thought it fair that I went outside to back the lads up!!! Thankfully the situation was calmed down and handshakes followed and the exchange of his (the massive dog's!!!) business card. The business card revealed the dog was a martial arts expert, so not only did he have the biggest guns in the world, but he also knew how to use them!!!!! Not a dog to pick a fight with. Thankfully all ended well apart from a small cut on the side of BT dog's head."

Eight Balls

61

BDT 2005 · Vilamoura · Featuring Buzz, Picko, Robbo & Boysie

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

The 2005 Tourists!

In Memory 94 we heard about possibly the worst hole of golf ever played on the tour. However, there is in fact another contender, which came on BDT 2005 and the common denominator is Big Buzz who played in both! Buzz himself takes up the reins telling the story in his own words:

BUZZ

"When my mind wanders back to the 'dark tour' of Vilamoura I immediately think of it being the place where bars didn't shut till 6 - 7 am. This was only ever going to take its toll on the tourists, most notably me being the defending champion and 2005 Shitzu!

Big Buzz on the Tee

Several off course flash-backs spring to mind including Thunderpants wandering back after an evening's activities looking dazed with only his jeans on with white Calvins in hand (still not sure what happened) and the horrified look on the local vet's face when Marshy/Ravo asked what was the best type of beer for a dog and then proceeded to tell her that Big Dogs love beer and whether she had any special dog bowls for a Big Dog to drink it beer out of. (They kept this running for a good 5 to 10 minutes if I recall correctly).

After Night I came the first round on the Old Course and a match between myself and Barnabus v Robbo and Picko. The golf I was producing typified my eventual Shitzu status. I was hitting the ball reasonably solidly but direction was a big issue.

I found myself about half way round struggling to get into double figures and in danger of my lad getting sunstroke! I pitched up on the 7th green (lad still out) to see Barnabus sink the final putt to half the hole. Relief came as the final putt dropped so I could give the old man a bit of respite.

Walking onto the next tee, the sight of a nice wide fairway was most welcome. As I had been catching the ball well I thought "I'll lead off and aim up the left hand side of the fairway and even if I do a 'Fore Right' and slice it should be ok."

Standing on the tee addressing my ball following my 5th practice swing I hovered over my ball for what seemed to be an eternity! Every eventuality went through my mind. Eventually I struck it, the Pro V1 took off like an exocet missile up the left hand side of the fairway although a little low. It passed the ladies tee which was about 20 yards ahead.

The relief was short lived when my ball struck what can only be described as the most sturdy twig I have ever come across. Needless to say my ball ricocheted 50 yards back towards me just behind the ladies' tee. This, to say the least, amused my team mate and fellow competitors. It must have been several minutes before Barnabus could compose himself to play his shot.

Whilst I would not wish my team mate any ill fortune, when he proceeded to nob his ball about 10 yards I did have a little giggle to myself. I also recall some remark from Dumbo about both 'Bloodhounds' having to get their wieners out and if I wasn't careful mine would match the colour of my top!

What was a giggle soon turned into a laughter when Fore Right topped his to about 15 yards and unabated right laughter when Dumbo stuffed his to about 10 yards.

Picture this, all four players from a four ball with c*cks out walking down the fairway. When Red Love, Chaaaaaaaarrrrrllles, Pubehead and Quick Crafty were walking up the 7th they were looking for 4 balls and found 8! Most amusing.”

Après Golf

Smelly Sinatra's

60

BDT 2003 · La Manga

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

During the Villa el Canine days of the trilogy of Marbella trips, Sinatra's Bar in Puerto Banus was a staple starting point for many a BDT night out, if for no other reasons than its convenient location and the ability to watch the posers going past in their souped-up motors.

Sinatra's Bar, Banus

Sinatra's was small and always jam-packed so, more often than not, we would congregate on the pavement outside and enjoy a couple of Stella Miguels; however, on this particular chilly evening in early May on BDT 2012 we were all packed inside the bar like sardines with all the bifold glass doors closed up.

Sipping and chatting away we noticed that people started pushing against us and jostling quite hard to get towards the bifold doors. Space was tight so we were a little baffled if not affronted by this sudden rudeness but before we knew it the staff were rushing to the bifold doors to concertina them open as quickly as possible, ushering everyone outside with some urgency. What on earth was going on, we wondered – there must be a fire somewhere, we thought, but there was no alarm nor any flames or smoke anywhere.

However, we began to notice that increasingly people were holding their noses or desperately covering them with their clothes, with disgusted looks on their faces. Then it hit us – the smell, that is.

The toilet at Sinatra's was unusually located to the front left part of the bar and it transpired that someone had gone in and utterly demolished the pan! The resultant smell was astonishingly shocking and, chuckling away to ourselves we joined the throngs on the street waiting for it to dissipate, Ravo was amongst us looking extremely sheepish, before he reluctantly confessed to doing the deed!!

Ravo on BDT 2012

Starter's Hut

59

BDT 2004 · Lagos · Featuring Knoxy

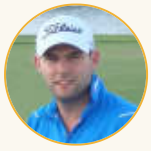
Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Penina

For Round I of BDT 2004 we visited legendary Portuguese course, Penina. A Henry Cotton course built in 1966 it is considered the most historic course in the south of Portugal and paved the way for numerous other courses in The Algarve, so the Dogs had assembled on the first tee looking forward to doing it justice!

Knoxy was in the first group out and what followed next is one of the most fondly remembered moments of tour history. Over to Knoxy to talk you through his experience!

Knoxy with his Doggles



KNOXY

"As some of you may know my Big Dog is rather lazy and generally only gets out of his kennel once a year (ie on the first hole of the third round of BDT). So you can appreciate the Big Dog is a little excited when he does get out and is surrounded by 15 other shiny big dogs all straining at the leash for yet another round of golf.

Stepping up to the tee on BDT should be something to savour. The course is beautiful, the weather is beautiful and the round is about to start. Unfortunately I would be lying if I told you what the first hole looked like on any of the 1st holes I have had the privilege of playing during my BDT career to date! As I can usually focus no further than the end of my Big Dog at this point on tour.

Stepping up to the tee on this occasion was no different. However, with a new Big Dog in hand sold to me on the premise of "you can't miss the sweet spot on this baby"....I had a little Barry Chuckle to myself at the point of sale...I had cause for HOPE Johanna!

Backswing went as usual, as smooth as an Afghan motorway. At the top of the swing, contrary to what I learned from the advice on the BDT website, of all the things I should have been thinking about, I was thinking "please go straight and at least 100 yards". Unfortunately neither of these happy thoughts came off!

> At point of contact I heard 3 noises, one of which I would like to say was me hitting the ball, but to this day I can't be certain. My ball toed from the dog head (don't think the sweet spot reached round that far) shot off at a 50 degree angle to me on the tee, hit the tee box marker reversing its trajectory back past me, clipped the small wall on the right of the tee box and bounced up over the official starter, hitting the starter's hut on its way down; some 30 yards behind me.
>
> Thankfully the starter was eyes down looking at his tee times, so just heard a noise and saw a ball resting next to his hut. I can only imagine he gave the fourball coming into the 18th a right b*llocking when they walked by.
>
> With many to choose from, this one still stands out as a true one hit blunder!"

Superb stuff from Knoxy and when we revisited Penina on BDT 2022 he was delighted to revisit the scene of the crime!

The legendary starter's hut at Penina!

Towels

58

Across the tours · Featuring BT, Robbo, Charlie & Ash

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

BDT Towels Over The Years

In some ways this may seem an odd topic to bring up and it does not relate to the towels-based stash that has been handed out in years gone by (four different tour towels have been handed out, as above, for those interested!), but instead to certain "towel incidents" over the years, and one in particular that deserves special attention!

The first known issue occurred after our stay in Villa el Canine in 2014. The villa owners approached us for 144 euros due to 14 soiled towels! God knows what had been going on but some photos were sent as evidence!

Strange!

The very next year on BDT 2015, towels proved to be a contentious issue once again, this time in our shared chalets in Malmö. The conversation from one of the chalets had the rest of us cracking up, which was kicked off by the line:

> "Who keeps leaving skid marks on the towels?!"

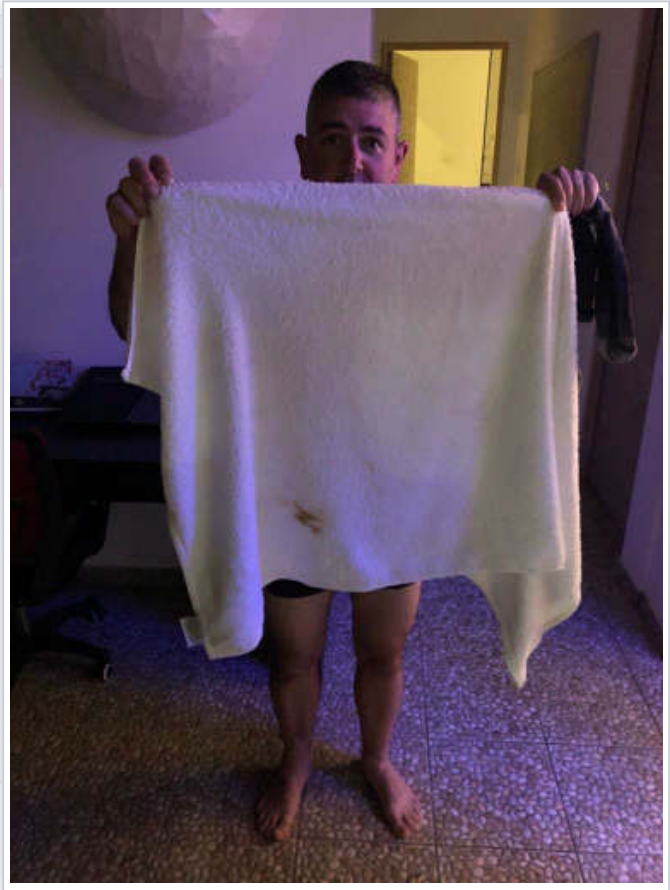
Robbo was particularly tickled by the fact this question was even being asked!

Come the end of the Malmö tour, it had been established who the culprit was and Charlie listed his tour lowlights as:

- "Wiping my face with Ash's skiddy towel on day 1.
- Wiping my face with Ash's skiddy towel on day 2. Lesson learnt."

Charlie forgives Ash

Yet surely the most extraordinary of all towel incidents belongs to BT, who was sharing a villa room with Robbo on BDT 2019. Words are simply unnecessary as Robbo's face says it all!



Absolutely disgraceful form from BT!

Plenty of Neidle

57

BDT 2023 · Turkey · Featuring Ash

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Dan Neidle has gone from someone we had never heard of to a sworn enemy of the tour for taking on one of our own! This episode has provided us with both amusement and concern over the past few years and it would be remiss not to comment on the latest developments.

Voldemort!

By way of brief background, back in 2022 Mr Neidle had published claims that Nadhim Zahawi, formerly Chancellor of the Exchequer, had lied about his tax affairs. Ash was instructed by Zahawi as his defence counsel and wrote to Mr Neidle in strong terms asking him to retract those claims.

In response Mr Neidle alleged that Ash had behaved improperly by sending him a libel threat and saying he had to keep it confidential. He also published the correspondence on Twitter / X and, inevitably, this led to Ash receiving an unwelcome barrage of abuse from online keyboard warriors!

Clearly this was a high-profile matter that was still something of a breaking story when we landed in Turkey for BDT 2023 and, in the usual way, the Dogs showed much support and sympathy.

OC Gifts for Ash!

At the OC Boysie unveiled a "Plenty of Neidle" t-shirt for Ash commemorating (in Boysie's words) "having his arse handed to him publicly by Dan Neidle"!

Langers produced a drinks cooler printed with "Sideshow Bob" which had been one of several unflattering online nicknames for Ash!

In December 2024 things became more serious for Ash when the Solicitors Disciplinary Tribunal fined him and ruled that he had acted improperly.

Ash appealed against this ruling and we were delighted to learn quite recently that his appeal was successful!

Let us hope that this is the end of the matter, but whether the Dogs will go easier on Ash this year and not "Neidle" him as much remains to be seen!

Caption Comps

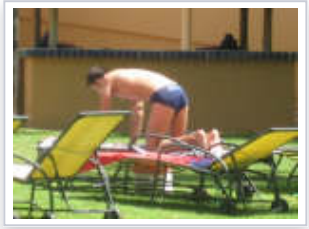
56

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Those of you who remember the "first" and more basic BDT website will recall that occasionally we would run a caption competition based upon a suitable photo selected for the purpose.

One such was this beauty of Boggy sporting speedos taken by Ash on, I believe, a two man romantic trip to South Africa. Three entries were as follows, with Ravo's voted as the winner for BDT 2008:



Speedos!

Hursty: "Come on Neil, one just one more set of 20"

Ash: "Ash, is my ass looking red. I don't want to lose my tanning competition with Georgie" (real life quote)

Ravo: "Ash, come back, stop cheating. It's your turn to give it to me now!"

▶ Watch: Extraordinary Scenes!

Even more popular, however, was this photo circulated after one of the Monkey's European escapades. I have still never heard the true story behind this one and I am sure you will agree it is baffling on many levels!

It inspired a number of entries to the caption comp for that year which were shown on screen at the BDT 2009 OC via this video!

We have no record of the winning entry for this one (it's likely everyone was speechless) so perhaps you could vote your own now – or maybe there is further inspiration for some new entries for either of these photos or some other new photos?

Finally, more recently during Covid we had a comp based on the following photo from Lisbon 2008 which produced the following entries:

Wind Bar Scene!

Oli D: "Have you farted?"

Paddy: "I think you'll win tour this year"

Boggy: "I think the lad behind us has just seen Ravo come out of the toilet"

Boggy: "BT's just told this lad one of his gags"

Ash: "I really hope I'm paired against you"

Robbo: "Have you seen BT's syrup?"

A Virgin's View

55

BDT 2016 · Mallorca · Featuring Lordy

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

BDT 2016, AKA "The Brexit Tour", was held in Mallorca and we had four virgins on board, in Rick, Marcus, Glenn and Lordy. In the story that follows, "a Virgin's View", Lordy provides an epic recollection of his first (and, to date, only) BDT.

LORDY

"The year was 2016 and there was a lot of political uncertainty at home as we boarded the flight for what was my first foray into the world of the legendary Big Dogs Tour.

Lord-y

Lord-Cameron

My 'lookalikey' David Cameron had left Theresa May and Blighty up the proverbial Sh*t Creek as we were heading on our way to Mallorca. For a brief moment in time the tour had a temporary name of the BBDT, The Big Brexit Dogs Tour.

I have trawled through my phone to see some of the early messages after being added to the WhatsApp group. Messages 3, 4 and 5 from Boysie read as follows:

1.	THE WHOLE THING WAS A JOHNSON PLOT
2.	The peasants are revolting
3.	Stick your London house prices up your arses!

Anyway, despite the uncertainty and the economy going into freefall, the BDT proved that it would not be influenced by these mere minor issues given the well-oiled machine that it is. Apart from the obligatory Wetherspoons brekkie, comprising several pints of San Miguel to get us into the Spanish mood, my first memory of the trip on Spanish soil was the copious slabs of San Miguel premium strength tinnies purchased at the airport. These 5.6% beauties (not the normal 5% ones) ensured that we had a pain free bus journey to the hotel. And what a hotel, far too good for any golf trip let alone the BDT!

Being one of four tour virgins I narrowly missed out on the Duncan Goodhew event. Perhaps the judging panel went easy on my Zinedine Zidane bald spot being a newcomer; Michael Phelps I am not, so was glad to avoid that one!

Obviously being in the group of tour virgins there was the obligatory challenge.

A few San Miguels

The Virgins are put through their paces

Onto Day II at Alcanada for the first round of golf, after which there followed a lovely BBQ on the terrace washed down with several glasses of the amber and pink nectars. The downing of a glass of rose was required and orders were given to strut a few moves in front of our fellow diners in our Hawaiian attire. Some dad dancing moves ensued which I now seem to recall that I continued later that evening with some of the more mature female diners!

Virgin Dancing

If I'm being honest this is pretty much about the most detail from the trip that I can remember. The rest became a bit of a blur from that night onwards!

Night 3 I got a bit too excited and, in the words of John 'Pot as many balls as you can' Virgo, I did this on the drink front and ended up with a short stay in hospital after doing a Triple Salchow with pike on the pavement.

The 2016 Virgins

Lordy's Triple Salchow

I have to doff my cap to fellow tour virgin Marcus Haigh who unselfishly travelled with me in the ambulance. After I'd finished my quick turbo nap I did a runner from the hospital leaving Haigh in the waiting room, having no recollection he was there! As with all trips, attention to detail like the name of the hotel was lacking but somehow I got back to the palatial establishment with two big eggs on my already sizeable noggin and just managed to tee it up a few hours later, somehow managing to take Little to the 18th before disappointingly losing. In truth I don't recall much of this round except for numerous short putts!

Having not been on any of the previous tours it's always difficult to judge the booziness and how it compares with other BDTs. However, looking through some of the old messages from BDT 2016 it had some of the vital ingredients of various Dogs missing in action, numerous items of lost property & faculties, quality & smelly banter, two DNFs from Purlo & Knoxy and a great guest appearance from BT! What more can you ask of the BDT?!"

Swimming

54

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

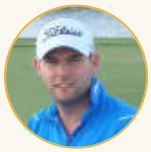
The La Manga Pool

In Memory 88 we recalled the genesis of the Duncan Goodhew Challenge but, aside from this great event, swimming has been a constant theme of the tour.

Starting with BDT 2003, the pool at La Manga provided much entertainment including daily royal rumbles with one Dog on top of another's shoulders scrapping with another – which was discontinued when Marshy discovered Robbo's lad resting on his shoulder!

Dogs In The Pool

In Lagos on BDT 2004, many of the lads decided to swim across the Marina at 2am whilst three sheets to the wind – seemed like a good idea at the time! Knoxy explains in more detail (and guess who provoked the swim...!):



KNOXY

"A group of wild hounds were on their way back to their kennels after an A-Typical night on the beers in Lagos! One rather loud dog (Ravo) started to bark up about the fact that the Bloodhounds were the only real Big Dogs! With a pack of Retrievers present this barking escalated to some good old "paw beating chest" banter. Ultimately leading to one dog making a reeediculous shout of, 'if you are such a Big Dog why don't you swim that?!'.

Now I am not sure many breeds of dawg are natural swimmers and I am sure that after a night at the beer bowl their hairy paws are even less well equipped to deal with watter! However, courage is stronger than sense with this pack and no sooner had Ravo Dog stripped down to his M+S best, the rest of the pack had done enough paw beating to ensure that no self-respecting mutt could be left not taking on the challenge!

"That" was the seemingly innocent looking estuary leading from the harbour to the ocean, and next stop the Americas!

The Scene of the Lagos Swim!

Not content with completing the task a decision was also made that the only stroke that could be employed was dawgy paddel. Some of you may remember this being sufficient to propel your puppy-like bodies; however with us being fully fledged Big Dogs also carrying a barrel full of beer in the gut, it was soon apparent that the preferred stroke was no longer up to the job.

The 40m (each way) stretch of watter was made more complicated to navigate when taking into effect the small issue of the tidal effect of the Atlantic Ocean, a pack of chuckling dawgs and the consumption of some of Portugal's best faecal watter!

On the return leg Knoxy dawg and BBT had to slow down whilst others in the pack arranged their exit on the one ladder out of the Ocean! Suddenly the current started to pick up and both dawgs began drifting down stream! After breaking dawgy paddle we finally got our paws back on dry ground and after accounting for all the dawgs we made our way back to the kennels, very pleased with our exploits.

Next day in town we recounted this story to a local who informed us that two people had drowned doing the same thing! But they weren't BIG DOGS!!! For those dawgs that had forgotten about our late-night excursion I hope this jogged a memory or two! As a Dog that often has a problem carrying the watter I won't be repeating the exercise! Good craic though!”

On the Dark Tour to Vilamoura on BDT 2005, several of us found ourselves in the fountain in the middle of the square towards the end of an evening, whether voluntarily or (in the case of Robbo!) not.

▶ **Watch:** Robbo Takes A Dip (as does Ravo – trust me!)

▶ **Watch:** Into The Vilamoura Fountain!

In Miami on BDT 2011, Coxy went for a little ‘unplanned’ dip in the pool at the Clevelander en route to the bar and had to be fished out with a rubber ring (video footage would be priceless)!

Coxy At The Clevelander!

Miami also saw Ravo taking a dip at The Great White Course! One Craaaaaaaaaaaazy Mutherf*cker!

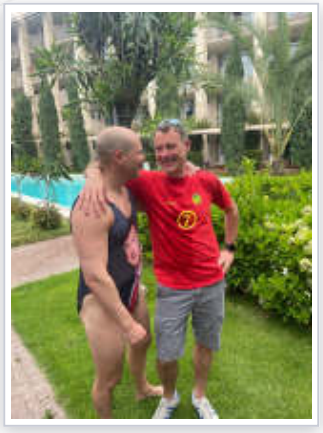
▶ **Watch:** Ravo Takes A Mid-Round Dip!

El Bosque GC in Valencia on BDT 2018 witnessed the fourball of (yet again) Ravo, Boysie, BT & Rufus refreshing themselves right in front of us on the 8th hole!

The 8th at El Bosque

Team Dip At El Bosque!

Continuing the swimming theme leads us to the greatest show of disrespect in tour history when Hulmey unveiled his swimming cossie on BDT 2023. Subsequent showings also came on BDT 2024 and 2025, when opposition skipper Gav also fell victim to Hulmey's inventiveness!!



Hulmey's Cossies!

Finally, back to La Manga and BDT 2003 where Boggy found himself swimming on the La Manga North Course, playing in a fourball with Ash, Picko and.....Ravo! Over to Boggy to explain himself (and guess who was the main enforcer...!).

BOGGY

"I'd had a steady start to the final day and think I was 1 over through 5. I started thinking that I may well be able to play my way into contention for the Green Jacket, but quickly came to realise that this would most certainly not be the case if Ravo had anything to do with it!

It was on the 6th tee that the lady selling demon repellent, as Robbo so eloquently puts it, showed up. I was reluctant, to say the least, because beer on a golf course seems to attract the demons to me, in the same way that an Eastern European's perfume attracts Ash! It didn't take much for the ever-persuasive Ravo to convince us that a beer a hole was now par for the course and we should leave our empty tins on each tee, in different shapes, for the fourball behind to admire our drinking prowess!

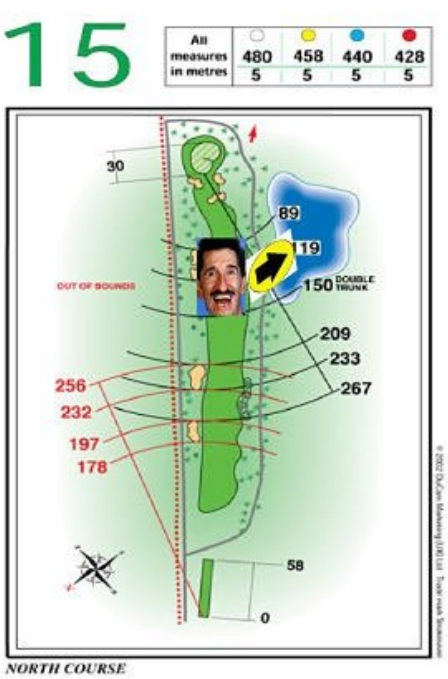
In the searing heat, the beer was quickly going to our heads and it was around the 10th hole that Ravo came up with the great/ridicadog idea of a long drive competition after he spotted a long par 5 fairway, just adjacent to the hole we were playing. The loser of the long drive competition had to jump in the pond just next to said fairway. Feeling merry, we all agreed, thinking Ravo would forget by the time we got there as he was still trying to learn the lyrics to 'Your Song' and saying 'Schmoker' every other word!

The hole in question comes around (the 15th) and we're all getting pretty schmokered by this point, so needless to say, stood on the tee, we'd all forgotten.

I drive off first, straight, but it came down with snow on! The other 3 then spanked theirs past mine with no problems whatsoever. Slowly realising our surroundings, as a fairway we'd seen before but couldn't quite place, Ravo pipes up, "Boggy, I think this is the long drive hole. In the pond you go!"

With Ravo's arm around my shoulder trying to convince me that this was a good thing to do, as I was one of the Virgins on Tour, I was surprised with the relative ease I succumbed to the peer pressure, as I found myself sprinting stark b*llock naked, across the fairway and proceeded to dive straight into the pond (a pond which I found out later contained a number of snakes - GOOD!).

La Manga North Course's 15th Hole



Barry's Swim!

As I was getting used to skinny dipping on this tour by now, I flapped around for a while before I realised I couldn't get out, partly due to the fact that the sides of the pond had that black plastic, slippy stuff on the bottom and partly due to the fact that my coordination might not have been 100% there, after the 8 beers I'd just snotted. Ravo had to fish me out with his Big Dog! I then blobbed the last 3 holes!

It's a good job no-one else was around, apart from the Dogs, because we could quite possibly have been thrown out of the resort or, someone might've thought they'd seen some new species of animal that had 3 legs and tried to report his finding. ☺

Not My Finest Hour!"

Boggy in La Manga

The Green Jacket

53

BDT 2003 · La Manga

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

The Green Jacket is a cherished item of the tour and one that we all aspire to wear. It originated on BDT 2003 when Robbo brought it to La Manga, having nicked it from his old man Barry's wardrobe!

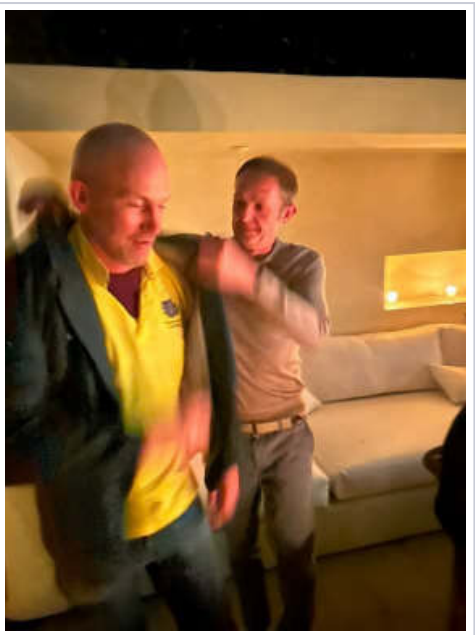
The Green Jacket

It's not clear whether Barry has ever noticed its disappearance and when we decided to have it embroidered with the Big Dogs logo it was settled that Barry was definitely not getting it back anyway!!

In those early days it became traditional for the tour champ to dive in a swimming pool wearing the jacket, before we realised that (like the inner lining of Partridge's swimming trunks) it may perish if we continued to treat it with such disrespect.

Talking of disrespect, after his victory on BDT 2004, Big Buzz decided to take it to the tailor's and have it resized so as to fit him! Extraordinary form given no-one else is remotely close to the size of the Big Man!

We still compete for the very same jacket to this day and it is an item which has now been worn by 18 different Dogs, per the Rogues' Gallery (of many of the winners) below!



The Rogues' Gallery!

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

Paddy won the Green Jacket in Scottsdale – his record fourth.

Paddy takes the Green Jacket in Scottsdale

Fitness

52

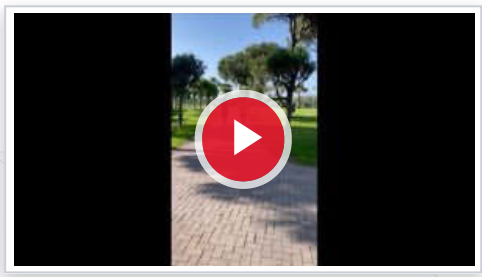
Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Until recent tours the prospects of the Dogs taking on the gym or a run of a morning would have been slim to non-existent and any exercise would have been limited to the DGC or press-up or star-jump fines imposed by The Monkey.

However, in recent years footage has emerged that perhaps we are maturing somewhat…take, for example, BT and Boysie showing extraordinary form in Lagos or Boggy and Boysie running in Turkey, Ash participating in Aqua Aerobics or the Monkey running laps of the grounds to the Marrakech villa.

▶ **Watch:** BT & Boysie In The Gym In Lagos!



▶ **Watch:** Boggy & Boysie Running In Turkey!

▶ **Watch:** Extraordinary Scenes Indeed!

With our two Virgins being an Ironman in Kenners and someone still playing rugby approaching his 50th year in Steve we can only expect the bar to be raised even higher in Scottsdale and, if Kenners has his way, we will be up bulling our boots at 6am every day in readiness for an hour long HIIT session pre-brekkie!

We should be mindful of injuries, however. Inevitably over 24 years of touring we have seen the golfing side of things interrupted by unexpected breakdowns. Although Ravo and BT soldiered on despite being lamped by Large Dawgs on BDT 2004 and 2007 respectively, others have not been as fortunate.

We had DT damaging his knee ligaments playing footy not long before BDT 2009, which led to us creating some inventive rules to allow him to participate in chipping and putting on every hole.

Langers suffered a severe bout of “food poisoning” before Round I in Malmö on BDT 2015 which ruled him out of that day’s golf and Purlo suffered similar symptoms before Round III in Mallorca on BDT 2016.

Lordy found himself in hospital on the same trip after his head collided with a pavement, although he discharged himself and still played a full part in that year’s golf!

Crutching It Up!

Langers Suffering!

Lordy Stacks It!

BT broke his hand in a buggy drink-driving incident during Round III of BDT 2017 yet still somehow managed to play his way around the back nine to cling on to his lead to take home the Green Jacket that year!

Not long before BDT 2024 to Turkey, Robbo was ruled out following a rather nasty industrial injury at work days before the tour (remarkably Robbo was still adamant the day before the tour that he was going to come and play until he most reluctantly admitted defeat!). Not the only time Robbo would miss a tour due to injury, as we will recall in another memory.

Buzz had also ruled himself out of BDT 2024 after stacking it off his bike not long beforehand (rumour has it the asphalt is still bruised!) although the Big Man still toured with us on the non-golfing front.

BT's Broken Hand!

Not One For The Squeamish!

With 52 days until we board our flights all the Dogs should wrap themselves in cotton wool and fingers crossed we will have a fully fit and firing squad for Scottsdale....

The Cheat Trophy

51

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Like many other BDT traditions, the Cheat Trophy actually began its life at the Lisbon OC on BDT 2008, with retrospective entries handed out based upon tour records....!

The Ashley Hurst Moving Your Ball In The Rough Award

The Replacement "Fowl Play" Award

It's up there with the Poodle and Shitzu as the trophy that most Dogs wish to avoid and, by way of reminder, the Tour rules provide as follows on cheating:

- any Dog found in breach of the R&A Rules by the Committee during any round of golf on a BDT will forfeit the match that that Dog was contesting when found cheating (regardless of whether such match is a Singles or Fourballs contest);
- the Dog nominated by the majority of the Dogs or otherwise selected by the Committee as the Dog displaying any dubious/immoral/sly/cheating-like behaviour on or off the golf course (whether amusing or not) during a BDT shall be presented with the Cheat Trophy at the Closing Ceremony; and
- in the event that the Dogs find themselves unable to nominate a suitable Dog for the Cheat Trophy, the Dogs shall be entitled to presume that Ashley Hurst has cheated during one or more of his rounds of golf and to present the Cheat Trophy to Ashley Hurst.

We hold a record of all the previous winners and photos of some of the winners, as below. Perhaps the most heinous of all the Cheating crimes was the mysterious loss of the original (and extremely large and heavy) "Ashley Hurst Moving Your Ball In The Rough Award" – whilst in the possession of Ash himself!

Having made several declarations over the years about not wanting to "bring that effing Cheat trophy back with me again on tour next year" it did not reappear on BDT 2017 and hasn't been seen since! Will it ever be seen again? Only Ash knows the answer....

The Cheat Hall of Shame

YEAR	WINNER	REASON
2002	Ash	Tour rules applied
2003	Ash	Tour rules applied
2004	Boggy	Holing out, losing the hole, then finding his other ball and getting up and down to win the hole
2005	Ash	Tour rules applied
2006	Ash	Over-usage of the missed putt and drag back
2007	Ash	Tour rules applied
2008	Ash	Dodgy drop off a path and equally dodgy application of line between two white stakes
2009	Buzz	Walking from a right angle to Robbo too eagerly to get behind Robbo's putt

YEAR	WINNER	REASON
2010	Ravo	Attempting to declare a hole as that day's NTP after he stiffed it to three feet
2011	Knoxy	Moving an enormous boulder out of the way to play his second shot
2012	DT	Consistent cheating during the Captains' pre-tour video and got rumbled
2013	BT	Tried to fix the draw for the rooms in Villa el Canine
2014	Oli Gregory	Dubious drop near red stakes
2015	Ash	Tour rules applied
2016	Ash	Tour rules applied
2017	Ash	Deliberately losing The Ashley Hurst Moving Your Ball In The Rough Award
2018	Ravo	Taking a dump in another Dog's (Fred's) room
2019	Ash	Teeing off a good foot in front of the markers
2020	Hursty	Taking drops!
2021	Ash	Tour rules applied
2022	Gav	Consistently putting out of turn
2023	Ash	Cheating Dan Neidle
2024	Ash	Tour rules applied
2025	Knoxy	Suspicious ball finding with Marrakech caddie
2026	**Knoxy**	**Spiking his Singles opponent DT's drink leading DT to lose his wedge and putter on the next hole and taking consistently generous drops**

Highlighted row added after BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

CHEATS OVER THE YEARS!

BDT 2011 – Knoxy

BDT 2013 – BT

BDT 2017 – Ash

BDT 2018 – Ravo

BDT 2019 – Ash

BDT 2020 – Hursty

BDT 2021 – Ash

BDT 2023 – Ash

BDT 2024 – Ash

BDT 2025 – Knoxy

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

Knoxy successfully retained the Cheat prize in 2026, becoming only the second Dog (after Ash - multiple times) to retain the Cheat.

Knoxy retains the Cheat prize in Scottsdale

Tour Tunes

50

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

▶ **Watch:** Wake Me Up Vibes!

Tunes are an integral part of BDT life, keeping wind in our sails and adding to the tour's vibe in a crucial and sometimes subtle way, as demonstrated by this short video from BDT 2023 taken before that day's play.

Each Dog has his own theme song and the table of personal tracks is below, with some memorable ones amongst them! We will be making an effort in Scottsdale to keep the tunes pumping and the tunes selected for our most recent additions will be announced in due course....

Each Dog's Theme Tune!

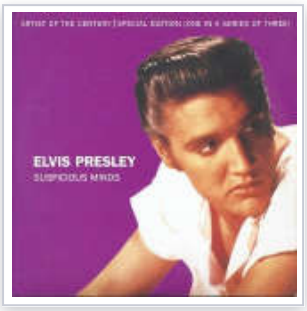
DOG	TUNE
Adam G	Soca Train
Adam T	Macho Man
Ash	(I Can't Get No) Satisfaction
Bean	We Will Rock You
Boggy	Chucklevision
Boysie	Gonna Fly Now (Rocky Theme Tune)
BT	Suspicious Minds
Buysai	To be confirmed shortly...!
Buzz	Mr Big Stuff
Charlie	Sultans Of Swing
Coxy	The Brittas Empire Theme

DOG	TUNE
DT	Snooker Loopy
Fred	La Marseillaise
Gav	Good Feeling
Glenn	Heartbeat Theme
Harbo	Neighbours
Hulmey	Wannabe
Hursty	Hey Hey He's A Monkey
Jules	The Pink Panther
Kenners	To be confirmed shortly...!
Knoxy	Foxy Lady
Kezza	A New Flame
Langers	You Can Leave Your Hat On
Langrish	Maybe Tomorrow (The Littlest Hobo)
Little	Red Red Wine
Lordy	Show Me Love
Marcus	Kumbaya
Marshy	Down Under
Oli D	Mrs Robinson
Oli G	It's Oh So Quiet (Ssh Ssh)
Ollie	Redemption Song
Paddy	Only Fools And Horses Theme
Picko	The One And Only
Purlo	Ticket To Ride
Ravo	Your Song
Rick	Tainted Love
Rob	Kung Fu Fighting
Robbo	I'm The Leader Of The Gang (I Am!)
Rufus	Coming In From The Cold
Steve	To be confirmed shortly...!
Tom	I Fought The Law
Tully	Life Is A Rollercoaster
Tyzzer	I Just Can't Help Believing

There have also been some songs that are completely synonymous with a particular tour often by virtue of someone adapting a well-known tune. For a time Boggy was a master wordsmith with his versions of “The Bloodhounds Came Out Two By Two” for BDT 2008, “Is This The Way To San Lorenzo” for BDT 2010, or “Ocean Drive” for BDT 2011. Other tour tracks have come along maybe because they were that year’s smash song, or by being the subject of a memorable Karaoke performance or moment on that tour, or by featuring on a preview DVD.

Here's a selection of tunes from each year's tour and you can add to this the likes of "Who Let The Dogs Out" and the Monkees' "I'm A Retriever".

Some Classic Tour Tunes!



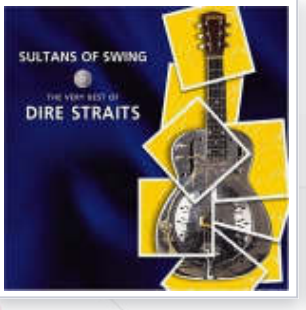
2002: Suspicious Minds

2003: Your Song

2004: Sloop John B

2005: Red Red Wine

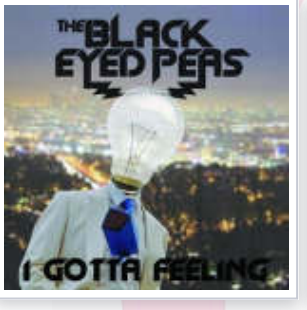
2006: Ticket To Ride



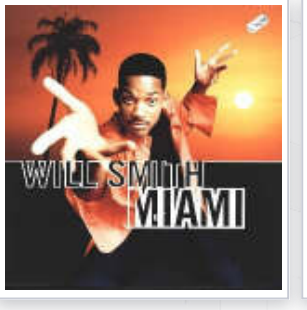
2007: Sultans Of Swing

2008: Whiskey In The Jar

2009: Red Light Spells Danger



2010: I Gotta Feeling



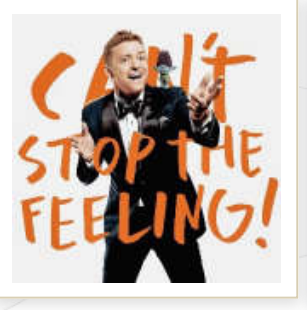
2011: Miami

2012: Break It Down Again

2013: Good Feeling

2014: Wake Me Up

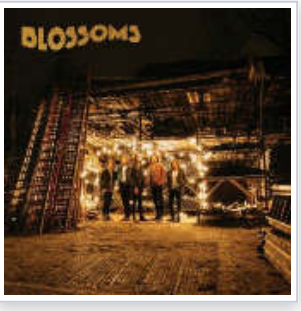
2015: Uptown Funk



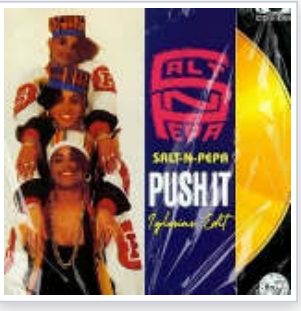
2016: Can't Stop The Feeling

2017: 24K Magic

2018: Feel It Still

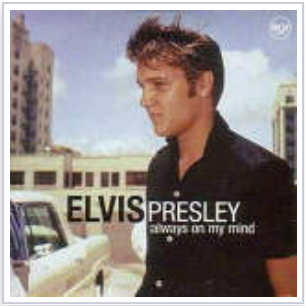


2019: Texia



2020: Push It!

2021: Dakota



2022: Always On My Mind

2023: Freed From Desire

2024: My Head & My Heart

2025: This Is The Life

▶ **Watch:** Lively!

What is the greatest tour tune of all time? For me it comes down to a song which, as soon as you hear the opening bars, makes you think of tour – and in my view that comes down to a choice between Your Song, Suspicious Minds and Red Light Spells Danger, but there are many other brilliant tour songs and undoubtedly everyone will have their own favourite.

As we head to the US of A thoughts turn to the tour song for Scottsdale. Initial thinking is that for a trip to the States it simply has to be something lively by none other than The Boss, with “Darlington County” a current favourite but any thoughts on this front are welcome.

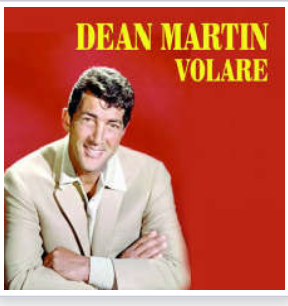
What is for sure is that we are all looking forward to the Buzz Driver taking us to the courses!

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

Buysai’s, Kenners’ and Steve’s songs were announced on tour as Lose Control, Bat Out Of Hell and Volare respectively, whilst the tour tune was “Edge of Seventeen” by Stevie Nicks.

Buysai – Lose Control

Kenners – Bat Out Of Hell



Steve – Volare

BDT 2026 – Edge of Seventeen

Biting

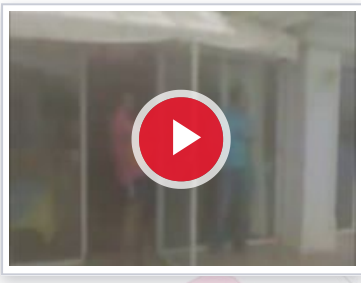
49

BDT 2009/2013 · Featuring Ash, Boggy, Charlie, Paddy & Harbo

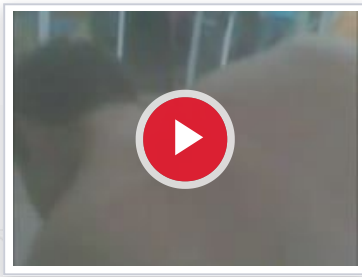
Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Ah, biting! In the build up to every tour the pre-tour banter generally involves the two teams laying bait in an attempt to extract the biggest "bite" from the other.

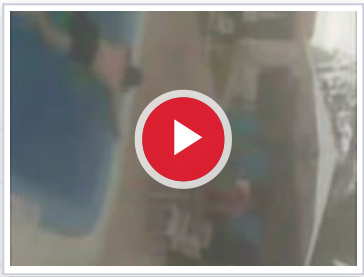
Baiting emails were undoubtedly at their peak in the 2000s and, on BDT 2009, culminated in Ash and Boggy having to do a race before the DGC on inflatable crocodiles by way of punishment for their incessant biting!



▶ **Watch:** The Crocodile Race – Part 1



▶ **Watch:** The Bite-Off!



▶ **Watch:** The Crocodile Race – Part 2

There is, of course, some debate over what actually constitutes a bite, as demonstrated by this email chain from April 2013 in the build-up to BDT 2013. By way of background Fred had had to withdraw from the tour which led to the introduction of a last-minute virgin in Rob:

PADDY

"Evening Dogs - New Tourist

Unfortunately, due to an unavoidable clash of dates, Fred has had to pull out of tour. This is obviously a blow for Fred and he will be sadly missed on tour, on and off the course.

This means that we are welcoming on tour yet another sibling, Mr Roooooooobert Parish, brother of Chaaaaaaaarles! Rob will replace Fred on the Retriever team and (after a handicap dispute the like of which has not been seen since the 2005 Vilamoura tour!) will be playing off 20.

Four sets of brothers, all on opposite teams, should make for a very spicy tour this year....

This also means that for the first time since the 2003 La Manga tour we have three Virgins to pick on. Virgins: beware the Opening Ceremony.

Fred was the appointed captain for the Retriever side so at this late stage the Committee has decided that I should replace Fred as Retriever captain facing off against Langers no Wangers for the Bloodhounds."

Cue an immediate "bite" from Ash:

ASH

"Just to be clear on the 'handicap dispute', it can be summarised as follows:

- Rob claimed 19.

- The Retriever members of the Committee claimed 22 (for no reason other than Rob is a virgin and that's what the Retrievers do).

- Retrievers eventually came down to 20.

- Bloodhounds claimed 19 (because that's what Rob claimed).

- It went to the vote and guess what? The Retrievers won 4-3.

Would anyone like a breakdown of the votes?

Very much looking forward to seeing whether Rob can play off 20 after the fines he is going to receive at the OC.

Welcome to the BDT Rob!"

Followed by Marshy:

MARSHY

"That is a very clear and well-structured bite."

Then Hursty:

HURSTY

"Buzz

Us Retrievers have been deliberating about which Bloodhound we would most like to play against on Day 1.

Unanimously you get the vote, not because you take your time around the golf course but more that you are a true gentleman and have got progressively worse as a golfer since you joined the BDT back in 2004.

Langers needs to give serious thought as to your partner...."

Ash (biting again):

ASH

"BITE: This is the most pathetic attempt at pre-tour banter I have seen in 12 years on the BDT. Fortunately for us, this year's tour is in Europe, not the US, and so Buzz is highly unlikely to have any distractions from producing some very solid golf.

It's a tough call which of your 3 virgins we would most like to be paired with but we're more bothered about how they're going to cope with the OC than the first tee. Having said that, I'm quite keen to avoid a 6 hour round with Thornton Junior.

Suggest we pair Buzz and Adam together. They can always meet us in Sinatras later."

HURSTY

"Gents

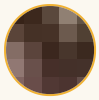
As tour organiser, can I draw your attention to the dress code for Night 1.

Brown shoes, Jeans, white belt, white shirt and tour ties. Jackets for past champions of course.

I am securing evening activities."

BT

"Just normal dress for you then monkey! Let's hope we are going somewhere we don't get seen with that dress code!!!
NEVER BEEN!!"


HURSTY

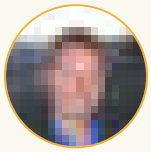
"Here he is!!
THE Rattlesnake!"

DT

"Don't worry about me Monkey I am here. Not sure where you have been the last 15 years though with that choice of dress for night 1. Where the hell we going dressed like that!

And don't you boys be worrying about Big Buzz, think you will find from the history books we have a winning record!!"

But putting debates about what is and is not a bite to one side, the question that comes to mind is what is the biggest bite in tour history? There are many contenders and everyone will have their own view, but my own personal favourite came on BDT 2013, from Charles (apologies in advance Charlie!).


PADDY

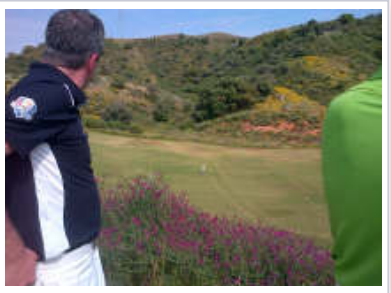
We were staying at Villa el Canine and it was Day II, Round I. Still feeling relatively sprightly, with Gemma's full English breakfast having soaked up some of the previous evening's liquid, the Dogs made the short walk to Alferini for the first day's golf. The first match out was between Ash and Charlie for the Bloodhounds and Harbo and Paddy for the Retrievers. Ash and Charlie were cruising at 2 UP through 14, with Charlie proving an especially tough opponent playing off 27 and throwing in a number of regulation birdies and pars for net eagles.

Feeling a little exasperated, particularly with Harbo playing off just 4, the Retrievers felt a change in tactics was required, and so made the decision to be a little less friendly and chatty with the opposition, invoking the Allan Border Ashes of 1989 mentality.

As luck would have it, an opportunity to unsettle the oppo presented itself on the very next hole. We were on the 15th green where Charlie, once again lying 20 feet from the pin for 2, net 0, for some strange reason put his marker down in front of his ball, rather than behind it. The Retriever pair said nothing but exchanged knowing glances.

Sure enough, when Charlie came to put his ball down, in front of his marker, the two Retrievers were virtually fighting between themselves to get the accusation out first. Charlie did not take it well. In fact he took it like a lump of sh*t in the face.

After a heated discussion which lasted a good minute, involving much righteous indignation from Charlie, he moved his ball back a little to satisfy the Retrievers ("Are you ok with that boys? Are you sure?!") and stood over his putt, with his head on the point of falling off his shoulders it was shaking that much.


Charlie's Next Tee Shot!

Inevitably the downhill 20-footer rolled a good 35 feet past the hole and, with the Retrievers desperately trying not to snigger and Ash simultaneously trying to reattach Charlie's head, Charlie gave his next putt all of two seconds attention and it barely made it half way back to the hole. A four putt later and the Retrievers were back in the game.

With steam still coming out of his ears, Charlie's next tee shot was extraordinary – a fast, angry enormous snap-hook further left than it was in front of us – check out the photo - and all of a sudden the match was all square! The Retrievers went on to secure a comfortable victory which was in no small part down to this rather sizeable bite!

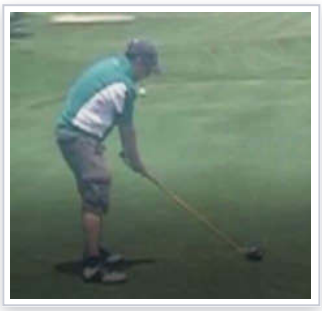
Picko

48

BDT 2020 · The Belfry · Featuring Picko

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Picko left us on 19 April 2020, passing away with pancreatitis which led to multi-organ failure. He left behind his mum Glenis, sister Julie and, most tragically, his daughter Ava.



The Picko Set-Up!

It was such sad news and he went well before his time should have been up.

Although he hadn't toured since BDT 2008, up to that point he had been a regular tourist who attended every tour between BDT 2003 and BDT 2008. We had a lot of fun with Picko back in those days and he is remembered fondly by all those who toured with him.

A couple of my own favourite memories of Picko on tour came on the consecutive tours of BDT 2007 and 2008.

After BDT 2007 had finished we were flying back to London from Dubai. The Dogs had checked in relatively late on, meaning that we were all sitting solo and scattered over all parts of the BA plane. As each Dog took his seat, there was great nervousness about who they might be seated next to given there lay ahead an eight-hour flight accompanied by the Dreaded Demons.

Some of the Dogs dotted around the back of the plane were a little bemused as they noticed that the shoulders of those Dogs towards the front had started shaking uncontrollably; it soon became clear why.

A chap was heading down the plane who at a conservative estimate would have weighed in at 25 stone, with a few pounds just about to be added by the 14" pizza he was balancing in one hand!

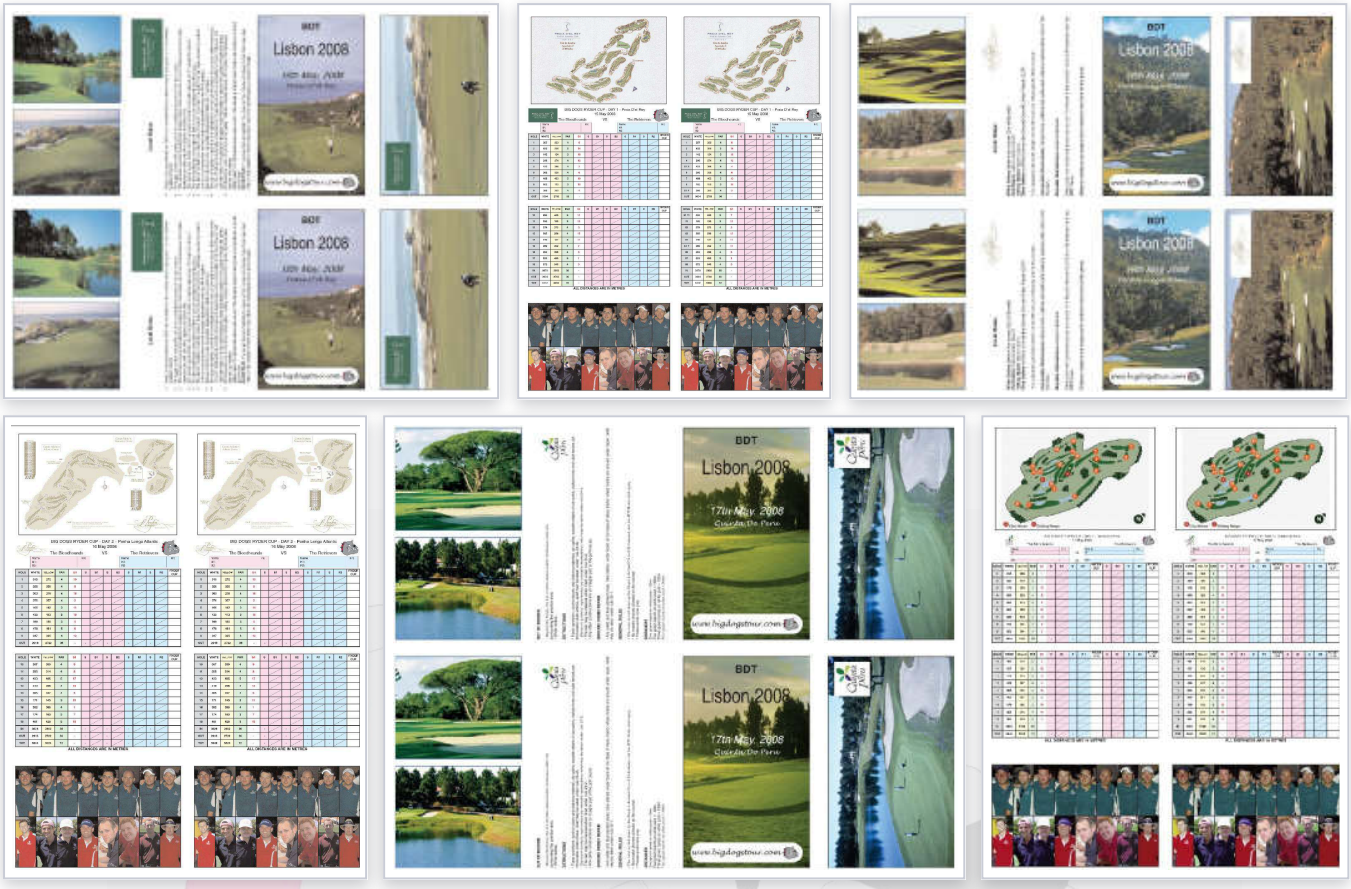
As he passed each row of seats containing a Dog, that Dog would turn around with a mixture of massive relief and utter joy to watch the scene unfold – it was like witnessing the biggest unplanned game of spoof ever held on tour.

And then it happened, he arrived at his seat, right next to a delighted-looking Picko – cue much laughter and zero sympathy from the rest of the Dogs!

Pickofords!

At the 2008 OC came one of my favourite nicknames, that of "Pickofords" following a memorable story of a house move assisted by Pickfords going badly wrong with suitcases bouncing all over the M62 and clothes flying around everywhere!

In his professional life Picko ran a printing business and he and I spent some considerable time creating scorecards and other stationery for the group and some of his products from his final tour can be seen in the photos below.



Picko's Scorecards

When trawling back through the tour archives for stories of Picko I stumbled across this amusing encounter he had with Big Buzz. This came the day after Picko had seriously struggled with a game of "Famous Johns" during which he was unable to name any and suffered the consequences!

BUZZ

"It was the 'Dark Tour' of Vilamoura 2005, playing the final day at Vila Sol. I was up against Picko Dog.

I'd been struggling all tour, having had the worst round of Round I and only marginally avoiding being Shitzu on Round II. We get to the 6th, and I'm one down. It's a 525 yard par 5 with water about 300-ish yards away.

The advice of the stroke saver was:

"Ensure the tee shot is as close to the lake as possible, making it possible for high handicap players to cross the lake and low handicap players to make the green".

Deciding not to risk it, I determined to ignore this advice and took out my 3 wood for safety and did just that, or so I thought!

I proceeded to smoke it straight down the middle. As the ball approached the fairway it decided to connect with the only rock-solid piece of fairway in the Algarve and kicked forward about 50 yards and straight into the water! To say I was unimpressed was an understatement.

> Recomposed after a 300 + yard walk I decided to take a drop in front of the lake and proceeded to top it straight in the lake again...and again. The best part of 10 quid's worth of Pro V1 gone in 3 shots!
>
> I was thinking about picking up, when Picko stuffed his OB, then playing 6. Game on, I thought, 3 iron onto the green and I'm back in it!! Decent strike but a slice OB! The rest of the hole is a bit of a blur but I ended up losing the hole to Picko's net 11 (eleven)! Then the match and needless to say I was the 2005 Shitzu. Good!"

As an aside, Langrish (who was playing in the same group as Picko and Buzz) described a typical experience on the tee watching this match:

>
> LANGRISH
>
> "8 practice swings by Buzz, 1 min over the ball, back swing, Picko's mobile goes off, stop back swing, 8 practice swings, 1 min over the ball, back swing, follow through, ball circa 2 feet to the left of original lie!"

Tour golf at its finest.

A prolific slicer of the golf ball, some will also remember Picko's ridiculously risky chipping action. He would hit a full swing flop shot for every chip!

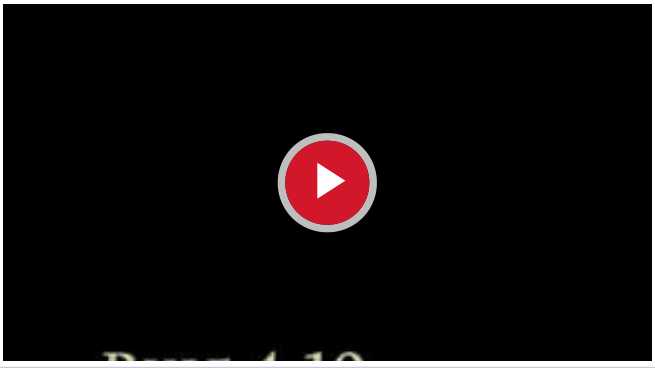
A Retriever at heart he played 15 Ryder Cup matches and his W-L-H record was ultimately a winning one of 8-7-0.

It feels appropriate to finish with some photos of Picko in action and also a couple of short videos of him chuckling away during the making of the BDT 2009 Preview DVD.

We will remember him on tour and may he Rest In Peace.

RIP Picko

▶ **Watch:** Picko Demonstrates The Left Hand Rule!



▶ **Watch:** Picko (And Ravo) With No Practice Swing!

Rocking Retrievers

47

BDT 2025 · Marrakech

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

▶ **Watch:** Rocking Retrievers!

There are some videos that do not require much explanation as they simply make you chuckle and this one definitely falls into that category although, granted, the Bloodhounds may not find it quite as amusing as the Retrievers!

The video shows how much the Ryder Cup has come to mean to both teams; the Retriever team had just regained it after three long years without it.

There had been three extremely close finishes the previous three years with the Bloodhounds taking the honours by the narrowest of margins on each occasion and celebrating on the 18th green each time, so there was definitely much pent-up excitement released in this moment.

No doubt the Bloodhounds will be plotting their revenge and planning their own celebrations in Scottsdale!

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

The Retrievers made it two in a row in Scottsdale, winning 12.5–11.5.

Retrievers Celebrating!

Bars

46

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

BDT 2015 – PS Bar & Grill (Copenhagen)

Over the years there have been some truly memorable nights out, not to mention all-day venues(!) where we have put the golf to one side and created some memories. Even on the enforced UK tours we made our own entertainment.

See below for a venue from each tour which the Dogs have made their own and the photos may (or may not!) trigger some memories. Are there any memorable venues missing?! And what is the greatest tour bar or club over 24 years?!

BDT 2002 – Palm's

BDT 2003 – Piano Bar

BDT 2004 – Inside Out

BDT 2005 – Figo's

BDT 2006 – The Irish Rover

BDT 2007 – Bar 360

BDT 2008 – Wind Bar (Bar Hawaii)

BDT 2009 – Biddy Jane's

BDT 2010 – Zoo Bar

BDT 2011 – Set

BDT 2012 – Pangea

BDT 2013 – Aqwa Mist

BDT 2014 – Pangea

BDT 2016 – Alcanada Terrace

BDT 2017 – Key West

BDT 2018 – L'Umbracle

BDT 2019 – Rainbow Club

BDT 2020 – Brabazon Bar

BDT 2021 – Merlin's Bar

BDT 2022 – Three Monkeys

BDT 2023 – Insomnia

BDT 2024 – #Lightshow Gloria

BDT 2025 – Palais Jad Mahal

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

We hit some good venues in Scottsdale but Rusty Spur Saloon will be the one that goes down as the most memorable.

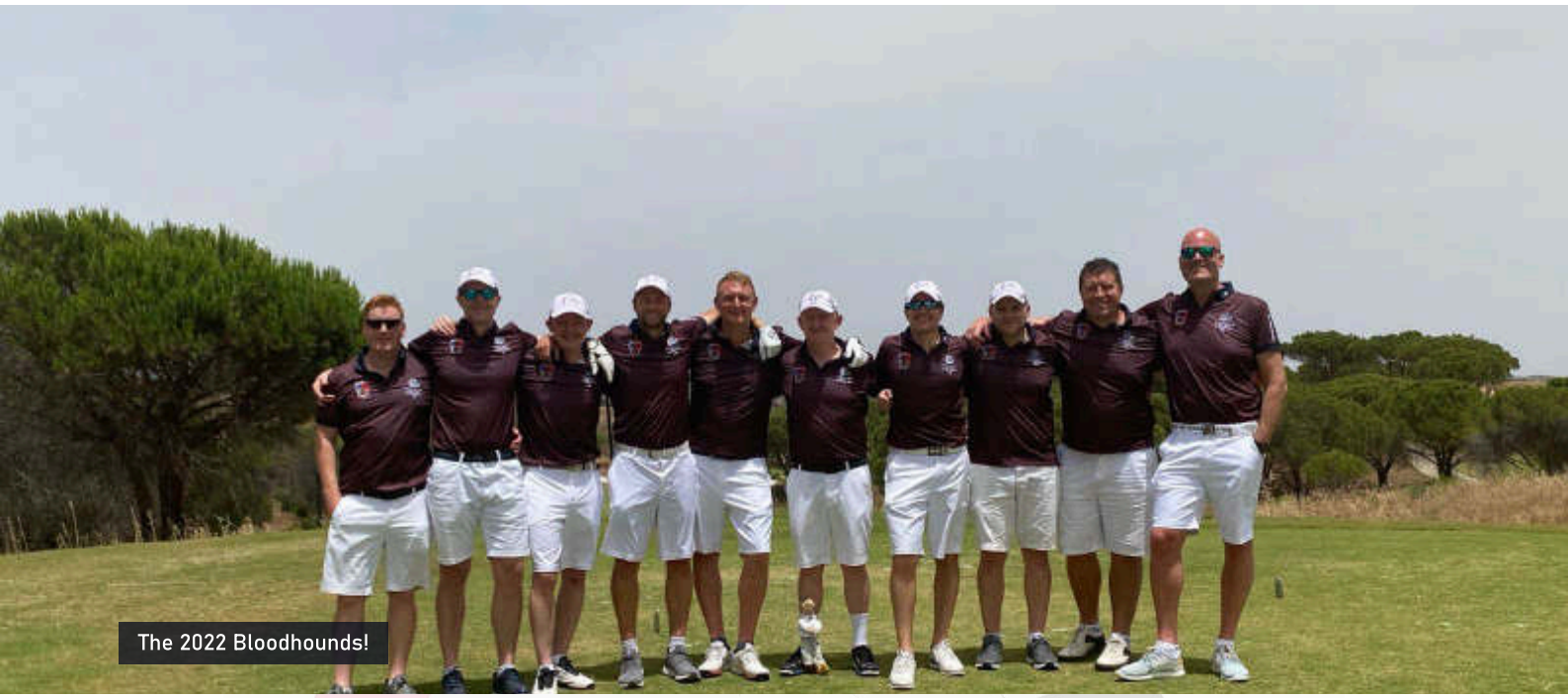
Rusty Spur Saloon

The Bunker Shot

45

BDT 2022 · Lagos · Featuring Langers & Harbo

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale



The 2022 Bloodhounds!

The Bloodhounds arrived in Lagos for BDT 2022 bruised and battered after two consecutive defeats on the twin UK tours of The Belfry and Celtic Manor the previous two years and were truly determined to take back the Ryder Cup.

A humdinger of a tour ensued and it all came down to the final match on the course, a Singles match between Langers and Harbo, who were all square coming down the last. A win for the Retrievers and they would retain the Ryder Cup; a half or a win for the Bloodhounds and they would wrest it back into their control. It couldn't be much tighter.

With the rest of the tourists congregated behind the 18th green we watched them come up to the green. With Harbo having somewhat surprisingly duffed his second into the brook crossing the 18th fairway, Langers had the upper hand. But hope remained for the Retrievers as he had put himself into the greenside bunker.

All eyes were fixed on Langers as he clambered into the bunker. Cue one of the finest shots under pressure that you will ever see.

▶ **Watch:** Langers produces the goods!

A Victorious Langers

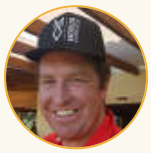
You Are A Big Dog

44

BDT 2004 · Lagos · Featuring Ravo & Marshy

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Another moment where one of the Dogs got himself into a bit of a pickle came on BDT 2004 to Lagos. Ravo tells the story in his own words!



RAVO

"Place: Lagos, Portugal

Time: approx 4.30 am

Situation: in the doorway of a random club in Lagos

Conditions: dark

A tour memory that will last with me forever was the breakdown in communication between myself and a BIG dog on the second night of BDT 2004.

Escape Nightclub

Ravo's reward for his compliment!

A select few of the BDTourists were leaving the club at the end of an enjoyable evening, the remainder of the BDTourists who shall remain nameless were long gone (predominantly Retrievers), tucked up in bed and dreaming of the Ryder Cup and the day's golf ahead.

Stood in the doorway of the club, I looked around to check that, as agreed, the entire party was there to ensure we all travelled home together, safely. All bar one tourist was out of the club. The one remaining, who shall remain nameless, was trying to CHEAT the agreed plan, not because he wanted to drink (acceptable), but because he wanted to practice his Eastern European chat on some unsuspecting 'dog eared' bird (unacceptable).

After informing the practising linguist of his tardiness and general cheating, unbecoming of the superior breed of Bloodhound, I complimented the doorman by suggesting that he was a "Big Dog".

For some quite unknown reason the doorman took offence at this compliment - he was spooked - and proceeded to kick the hole off me! In one hazy memory as I was lying flat out on the floor I recall thinking "gosh, it's taking the fellow dogs a long time to pile in" and then at the point the doorman kindly removed his fist from my head and foot from my ribs, I hot-footed it out of there.

On the way home, the true spirit of the BDT came out. Daniel (it must have been early on tour for him to be out so late) Marshy (a Retriever) helped me (a Bloodhound) by splashing the blood off my face with the estuary water. Between the laughs (him) and tears (me), we managed to find our way home.

It goes without saying that the remainder of the tour was an absolute cracking success, despite the shiner in front of a client the next day and the apology to the Big Dog!"

Monkey Magic

43

Across the tours · Featuring Hursty & BT

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Owing to his hirsute appearance, Hursty has been known as "The Monkey" for as long as anyone can remember and this has led to many nicknames on this theme including "Chewbacca", "Chewhacker", "Hair Of The Dogs", "Wookie", "King Kong" and "Steve Kong" (although from James's perspective these were probably preferable to "Giggsy" and "Floppy Seconds"!).

Hey Hey He's A Monkey!

Back in the mid-2000s the Dog Spot phenomenon began and we have amassed an incredible collection which we add to continuously. However, one tourist in particular has lost sight of the fact that they are called DOG Spots, not Monkey / Gorilla / Ape / Chimpanzee / Orangutan Spots!

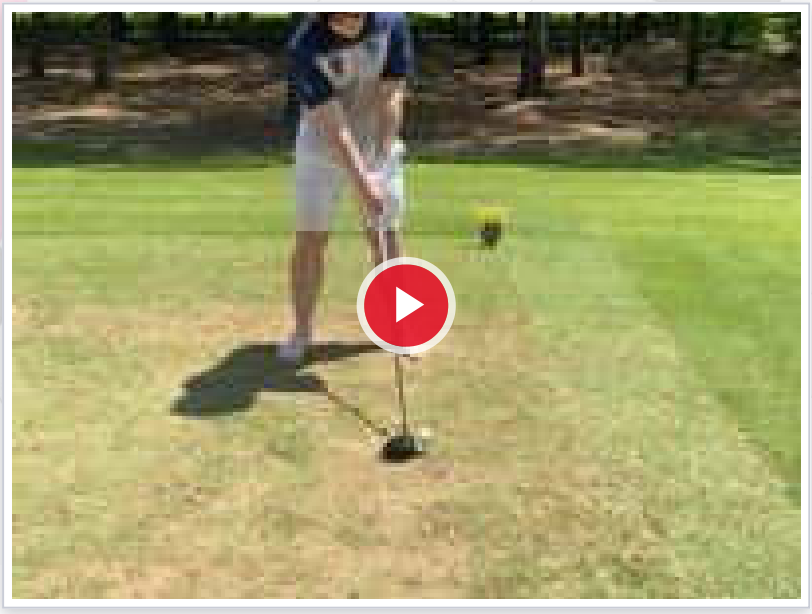
When BT heads abroad we find our WhatsApp virtually spammed with one Monkey Spot after another to the point where we have amassed a collection nearly as large as the Dog Spot collection itself! This can be seen in the video below.

▶ **Watch:** The Monkey Spots!

On BDT 2024, the Dogs felt that enough was enough and BT was taken to task at the OC for his inappropriate behaviour. He was presented with a Monkey Mask and although Ravo's initial suggestion for his Retriever opponent was that he had to wear it for all three rounds of golf on tour we settled on BT having to drive off in Round III, with no practice swing, barefoot and having donned said mask.

BT at the BDT 2024 OC

On Saturday 11 May 2024 we assembled on the first tee for this unforgettable moment but to everyone's utter dismay BT spanked one down the middle! Incredible scenes. What is worse is that BT does not seem to have heeded our warning and continues to bombard us with Monkey spots to this day!



▶ **Watch:** BT's Monkey Drive!

Rocky Balboysie

42

BDT 2013 · Marbella · Featuring Boysie & Harbo

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Boysie & Harbo on the night in question!

Although on occasion there may have been the odd cross word or difference of opinion, particularly during some of the Monkey's fines sessions, on the whole the Dogs have stayed remarkably civilised in their dealings with one another, with one quite spectacular exception...

It was BDT 2013 and we were revisiting our old favourite haunts on the backstreets of Banus. It would be fair to say that we were all reasonably well-oiled, with Boysie proving to be a wonderful Kittymaster as always in sorting us out with numerous rounds.

However, on this particular evening his patience was wearing a little thin with the constant queuing at packed bars on our behalf and, when Harbo (then a tour Virgin) made the innocent but foolish mistake of asking Brian where the kitty was / how much was in the kitty, Boysie "had a moment"!

Thankfully the scrape was all over in a matter of seconds and the boys were cuddling one another not long afterwards.

Here's the story from Harbo's perspective.

HARBO

"It was the first night of BDT 2013 and we had found our way into Puerto Banus following the OC. Being a Virgin I was trying to be on my best behaviour and not draw any attention to myself to avoid any further fines...

Anyway we were in a random bar and I thought what better way to help with 1st impressions and to keep the fellow dogs I was with happy than to buy them a round of drinks. As I got to the bar and was ready to order I saw Boysie stood nearby with a wad of cash in his hand and heard someone mention the word 'kitty'.

At this point I thought, ah the kitty, I should really be using money from that to buy drinks rather than my own cash. So I calmly asked Boysie if that was the kitty he had on him and if there was any chance of some cash for the round I was in the process of buying...it appears my timing was exceptionally poor...!

Cue the Rocky Theme Tune...

Well Boysie tried to launch himself at me...there was venom in his eyes and steam coming out of his ears...after being restrained once he tried again but failed for the second time to get anywhere near me!! I stood back and just thought: these dogs are quite aggressive!!

The following morning every half hour from fairly early there was a knock on the bedroom door...eventually I got out of bed and answered it to see a very upset Boysie who could not believe his actions the previous evening. He came in and sat down on the bed, head in hands, apologising about his previous night's antics.

> I kept informing him he had no need to apologise as I had forgotten about it straightaway and just said I thought it was all part of my initiation as a Virgin!
>
> We were inevitably paired in the same group for the final day's golf but I was pleased he had no more Boysie Balboa moments on the course and by the end of the trip we were like best mates!"

Needless to say, we could not leave matters there and decided to confront the issue head on over the next two tours. On BDT 2014, it was announced that Boysie's signature tour song would be the Rocky Theme Tune and he was introduced to this at the 2014 OC as per this video!

▶ **Watch:** Boysie Rocks to Rocky!

We took matters a step further on BDT 2015 to Malmö, for which the Committee decided to appoint as the two captains….none other than Boysie and Harbo! At this point, Langers was called upon to get to work on some boxing stash for the OC!

The Langers Stash and the Malmö OC!

We invited the Captains to spar for us and it does have to be said that Boysie's moves were more impressive than Harbo's! A very brief snippet can be seen in the video below! Although Boysie won the sparring battle Harbo went on to win the war, skippering the Retrievers to victory.

We await the next instalment of this fearsome rivalry with much anticipation!

▶ **Watch:** Sparring Partners!

Hawaiian Night

41

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

One of the great tour traditions is Hawaiian night.

The earliest tour for which we can find photographic evidence is BDT 2005 but we believe the tradition first began in La Manga on BDT 2003.

It has continued for the majority of our tours since and what is for sure is it produces great pics and has been a form-inspiring factor resulting in some of the all-time great tournights. Here's a sample of some Hawaiian Phodography to jog the memory!!

BDT 2005: Vilamoura

BDT 2006: Mallorca

BDT 2008: Lisbon

BDT 2009: Vale do Lobes

BDT 2010: Girona

BDT 2012: Marbella

BDT 2013: Marbella

BDT 2014: Marbella

BDT 2015: Malmö

BDT 2016: Mallorca

BDT 2017: Mallorca

BDT 2022: Lagos

BDT 2023: Turkey

BDT 2024: Turkey

BDT 2025: Marrakech

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

The Hawaiians were brought out on Day I of BDT 2026.

The 2026 Hawaiian Night

Cameron

40

BDT 2003 · La Manga · Featuring Picko, Charlie & Hursty

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

The next memory comes from BDT 2003 in La Manga. To this day, if the name “Cameron” is mentioned it will immediately bring a wry smile to the face of all those tourists who witnessed this moment.

The Famous Cameron!

It’s also a lovely moment as this story was written by Picko – may he Rest In Peace – and so it is particularly poignant to hear it from his perspective.

PICKO

“As I write this we are about to embark on the 7th BDT and this will be my 6th. I have been thinking long and hard about my favourite tour tail. However, it seems that I know either how the tail starts or how it ends but very rarely both. This seems to be a common theme for each and every year.

As I have been sitting here thinking there are many, many stories that spring to mind. For example Chaaaarles not being able to comprehend the concept of a minimum bet in the Casino in La Manga 2003, myself and Robbo being repeatedly kicked by the security guard in Vilamoura 2005 for sleeping on the floor outside our apartment, BT's balcony trumpeting in Mallorca 2006 or even Ravo's request for his 'tree' iron after lodging his ball 4 foot up one in La Manga.

The tail that first came to mind however was from my very first round of golf on tour, La Manga 2003. We were playing the North Course, I had just met quite a few of the Dogs and it was even before the days of the team competition, every Dog for himself. Even though I did not know some of the dogs, Ravo, being the kind gent he is, had introduced himself to me the day before by pushing me into the pool along with my mobile phone and wallet. A good start I thought.

Back in 2003 I believe there were only 11 puppies on tour and we required A N Other to stand in to make it 12 for three fourballs.

As it turned out Hursty's boss, Cameron, happened to be on site and was more than happy to make up the numbers. He was holidaying with his wife and children but was given a pass out for the day to take part in a semi-serious round of golf. We all made our way up to the first tee to be greeted by Cameron who was accompanied by said wife and children who had come to cheer him on and all looked to be full of pride.

La Manga North – Hole 1

For those of you who have not played the North Course, or for those who can't remember, let me remind you of the first hole. It is approximately 350 yards and very straight. The tee bed we were using was about 25 yards back from a small brook and the ladies tee at that time was on the other side of the brook (although this has now changed).

The first 4 ball out included Hursty and Cameron. As the family looked on in loving adoration of their father's ability to play in a contest of sporting excellence with 11 finely tuned athletes, those children could not have been any prouder than at that moment.

> Three Dogs teed off with mixed but adequate drives. Next up 'the Boss', big dog in hand ready to show his family and the world that he was a golfer of considerable ability. His practice swing looked solid, he addressed the ball and bang, a drive that surpassed anything Red Love could dream of at 6 yards.
>
> As we all know, there is a penalty for not reaching the ladies tee and, as Cameron's follow through was coming to an end, all eyes were on Hursty. With a shake of the head he whispered 'NO', which all dawgs respected even if there were a few giggles.
>
> Hursty's boss was by this point a little worked up as he felt that he had let himself and his family down who were watching in horror. Without thinking, he marched over to his ball and attempted to play his second, off the deck, with his driver. Big mistake. The club came back, he topped it and it shot into the brook a further 20 yards in front of the first tee. A deadly silence fell, all the Dogs concerned not knowing what to do as it may affect Hursty's career path.
>
> Then, approximately 2 seconds later the silence was broken by Chaaaaaaaaarles who simply declared:
>
> 'He's definitely getting his c*ck out now!'.
>
> Seven days later I returned home a broken man but having had a thoroughly enjoyable experience!”

Remarkably back in 2023 I was at a house party when none other than Cameron should approach me asking if I was on that Big Dogs Tour! He remembered the incident well!!!

Cameron in 2023!

The Greyhound & Shitzu

39

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

The Greyhound and Shitzu Jerseys have become an essential part of the BDT uniform. They were first introduced at the OC on BDT 2006 (when the Shitzu trophy was also first introduced, with previous winners up to that point all inscribed upon it) and have been virtual ever-presents since then.

Greyhound & Shitzu Logos

The only exceptions seem to have been the tours to Dubai and Miami where certain tourists campaigned hard against their presence in case they might hamper their evening activities!

We debate this point virtually every year but to confirm that they are to be worn by the following Dogs:

- Those with the highest and lowest scores after Round I.
- Those with the highest and lowest scores for Round II only (ie not cumulative).
- Those with the highest and lowest cumulative scores after all three Rounds.

Only rarely has the same Dog worn one or other shirt all three nights of any tour. Gav did have to wear the Shitzu all three nights of BDT 2010 and Buzz bore the same misfortune on BDT 2013.

On BDT 2009 Coxy had the unusual honour of wearing the Shitzu after Round I and the Greyhound after Round II – still the only Dog to wear both Jerseys during a single tour.

Certain Dogs have suffered from the "Curse of the Green Jacket" with Paddy (BDT 2003 & 2004), Buzz (BDT 2004 & 2005) and Boggy (BDT 2013 & 2014) all winning the tour only to take the Shitzu the following year. Other winners of first and last place are Robbo, Hursty, Rufus, Gav and Ravo.

The Jerseys always bring some colour and spice to our evenings out and do tend to draw attention to the wearer... looking at the photos it has become clear that an essential photo for any BDT is the combined Shitzu / Greyhound photo as the colours bounce off each other quite spectacularly and produce wonderful snaps! Enjoy the photos below and we look forward to adding to the roster in Scottsdale!

GREYHOUNDS AND SHITZUS DOWN THE YEARS!

2006: Round II

2008: Round I

2008: Round II

2008: Round II

2009: Round I

2009: Round I

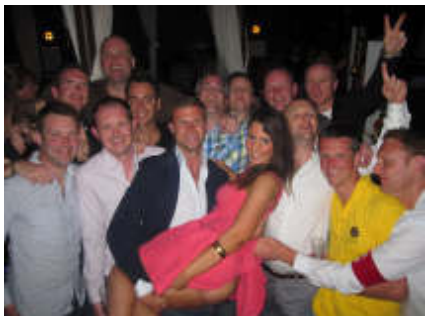
2009: Round II

2010: Round I

2010: Round I

2010: Round II

2010: Round II



2013: Round I

2013: Round I

2013: Round II

2014: Round I

2015: Round I

2015: Round II

2015: Round II

2015: Round III

2016: Round I

2016: Round II

2016: Round II

2017: Round I

2017: Round I

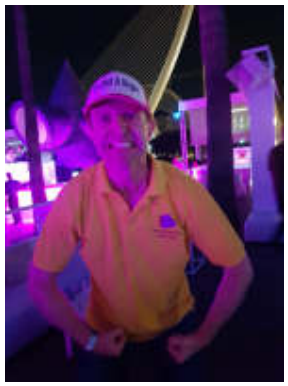
2017: Round II

2017: Round II

2017: Round III

2017: Round III

2018: Round I



2018: Round I

2018: Round II

2018: Round III

2019: Round I

2019: Round II

2019: Round III

2019: Round III

2020: Round I

2020: Round I

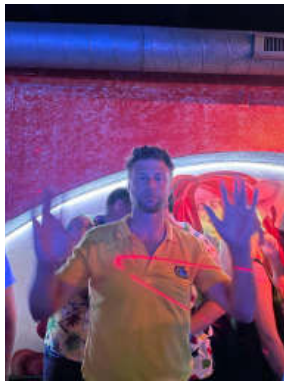
2020: Round II

2021: Round I

2021: Round II

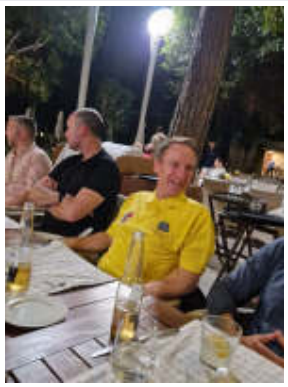
2022: Round I

2022: Round I



2022: Round II

2022: Round III



2023: Round I

2023: Round II

2023: Round III

2023: Round III

2024: Round I

2024: Round I

2024: Round II

2024: Round II

2025: Round I

2025: Round II

2025: Round III

2025: Round III

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

The Greyhound/Shitzu tradition continued in Scottsdale.

2026: Round I

2026: Round II

BT Pushes It

38

BDT 2020 · The Belfry · Featuring BT

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Against our wishes, in September 2020 we found ourselves in Sutton Coldfield for BDT 2020, instead of our planned trip to Lagos, due to the dreaded Covid. Flights were cancelled and with the rules constantly changing it was a time of great uncertainty.

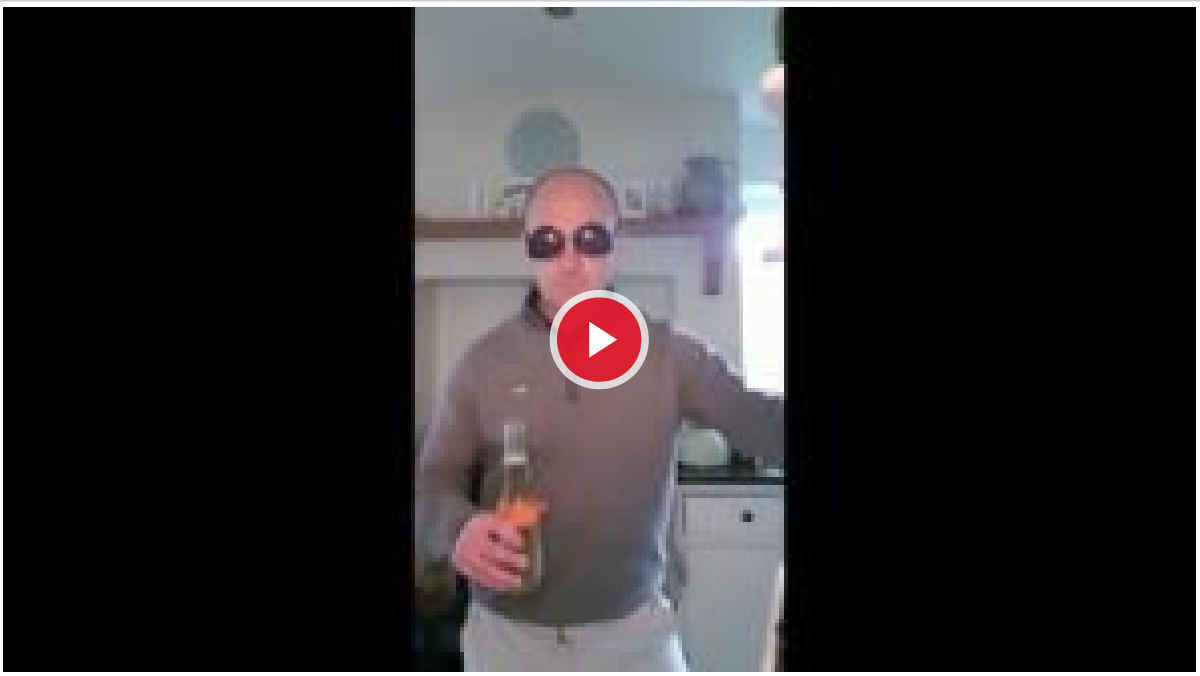
Miraculously, however, we did manage to conduct a full BDT 2020 notwithstanding all the obstacles thrown in our way.

With everyone largely stuck at home for the summer, pre-tour banter had been severely limited, but there was one phenomenon that had not escaped anyone's attention – BT's "fitness" regime which comprised a curious mixture of worthy exercising coupled with the aggressive snotting of fridge beers in one on a virtually daily basis! WhatsApp and Instagram took an absolute hammering with uploads from BT's phone!

▶ **Watch:** OC Reaction as BT Pushes It!

I didn't feel that BT's activities could pass unmentioned at the OC so, with the help of Salt 'n' Pepa, a video was unveiled at the OC which summarised over a couple of minutes BT's quite extraordinary Covid form. It still rears its head every now and again but always raises a smile and certainly was enjoyed at the OC!

Moreover, BT was clearly motivated and inspired by the video as he went on to secure the Goblat trophy by an overwhelming majority for his tremendous form at The Belfry!



▶ **Watch:** The Push It Video

The Poodle

37

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

BDT 2018 – Little

Early Version

Brief Version

The Poodle We Know And Love

The Poodle is up there with the Cheat and Shitzu as the trophy no self-respecting Dog wants to take home. First introduced in 2008, the trophy itself has led a complex life and due to a couple of breakages over the years has evolved into the version we know and seek to avoid today.

The tour rules prescribe that it is awarded to the Dog who has:

- shown the poorest form on tour;
- failed to produce the Big Dog driver or employ a full swing or otherwise drive the ball very far off the tee;
- decided not to participate in the whole of a tour;
- headed to bed earlier than the rest of the Dogs;

- badly represented the BDT spirit during a BDT; and/or
- generally displayed quiet behaviour.

The 24 tour Poodles to date are listed below and it is immediately clear that Little will take some catching, with five Poodles to his name. Marshy is next in line, with four, albeit you won't ever see Marshy on a Poodle trophy photo as he is always well and truly tucked up in bed with severe jet-lag by the time of the Closing Ceremony. Boysie has secured himself three and Robbo and Gav both have two apiece.

Here's hoping this will be a hard one to dish out in Scottsdale and that everyone's form is through the roof!

The Poodles

YEAR	WINNER	REASON
2002	Robbo	Wearing Rosie Watson's pyjamas
2003	Picko	First to bed every night
2004	BT / Little / Boysie	Leaving half way through tour and not competing in the Ryder Cup
2005	Little	Half swing and early to bed
2006	Little	Half swing
2007	Little	Several early nights
2008	Ravo	Early to bed missing the entirety of the Wind Bar night
2009	Marshy	Falling asleep and going to bed during the OC
2010	Boysie	Turning up a day late due to one long poo
2011	Tyzzer	Early to bed every night
2012	Fred	Early to bed every night
2013	Rob	Incredibly early to bed after several enforced wines down in one
2014	Oli Gregory	Early to bed frequently
2015	Langers	Kipping on PGA National's front lawn, spewing in a cab and missing Round I
2016	Purlo	Early to bed and missing Round III
2017	Boysie	Early to bed several nights
2018	Little	In bed before 7.30pm on night one
2019	Marshy	Dramatic dip in energy in the latter half of tour having exploded out of the blocks
2020	Robbo	Missing night one and two other early nights
2021	Gav	Taking the golf far too seriously in declining any on-course drinks
2022	Marshy	Misjudging jet-lag resulting in too much kip
2023	Marshy	Yet again misjudging jet-lag
2024	Gav	Changed plans to fly home a night early
2025	Buysai	Bryson DeSchambles incident
2026	Rufus	Went very early on Day I and again after Round II such that he did not make it out for dinner

Highlighted row added after BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

A SELECTION OF POODLES!

BDT 2008 – Ravo

BDT 2011 – Tyzzer

BDT 2017 – Boysie

BDT 2019 – Knoxy

BDT 2020 – Robbo

BDT 2021 – Gav

BDT 2025 – Buysai

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

Rufus was the unexpected recipient in Scottsdale.

Rufus takes home the Poodle

Freshies

36

BDT 2016 / 2021 · Featuring Ravo, Rufus & Langrish

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

As the standard of golf on tour has gradually improved, the freshie to shot ratio has reduced substantially. If we are all honest with ourselves, most of us tourists have suffered the ultimate golfing embarrassment at some stage, but we have now reached the position where they are something of a rarity.

However, memories fade! In the tour records not only do we have references to numerous freshies over the course of 24 tours, but we also know for certain that we have definitely witnessed at least three first tee freshies – and these are not just any old freshies!

The first came from Ravo and was perhaps the most memorable of all as it came as the very first shot of BDT 2012 with a full gallery viewing! Perhaps those pesky Romanians (or was it Albanians?) were playing on Ravo's mind! Tragically, the moment was not recorded, but if there is ever a moment when we wish the camera had been rolling this was surely it!

Fortunately, two other first tee freshies have been captured on film and we will never grow tired of viewing these two beauties, both of which were unveiled in front of an audience, with Rufus's having the privilege of being the very first shot of BDT 2021!

With apologies in advance to Rufus and Langrish, please enjoy!

THE FRESH-AIRS

▶ **Watch:** BDT 2016 – Langrish First Tee, Son Quint

▶ **Watch:** BDT 2021 – Rufus First Tee, 2010 Course

The Xolo

35

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Predictably enough, the Xolo Bandit is awarded to the Dog who:

- scores the most impressive number of stableford points relative to his handicap; and/or
- by the consensus of a majority of the Dogs has played the best golf relative to his ability; and/or
- simply deserves to be known as a bandit for his performance on tour.

The Xolo Bandit

The Xolo is short for the Xoloitzcuintle breed of dog, otherwise known as the "Mexican Hairless", a suitable choice for the Mexican golfer trophy awarded to the tour bandit each year.

The 24 Bandits to date are listed below. Serial winners include Coxy, Robbo and myself with three each, whilst Boysie, Charlie, Knoxy and Oli Gregory all have two! Oli D was an inevitable winner for his 112 point tally on his first ever tour on BDT 2015, still the joint tour record to this day.

The obvious question is: of the entries below who has been the most deserving bandit in 24 years of touring?!

The Bandits

YEAR	WINNER	REASON
2002	Boysie	Eagle, birdie, eagle finish off 28 to pip BT to the Green Jacket
2003	Paddy	48 point round
2004	Buzz	Winning the tour comfortably off 20
2005	Oli Gregory	Playing off 20 despite undoubted golfing prowess
2006	Robbo	Winning by 8 shots playing off 18
2007	Charlie	Spanking drives down the middle off 27 and a 40 point first round
2008	Oli Gregory	Finishing second playing off 19
2009	Coxy	Winning his debut tour off a clearly ridiculous 26
2010	Paddy	Winning the tour off 27
2011	Coxy	Second place off a still ridiculous 23
2012	Coxy	Third in the standings off 21
2013	Charlie	Second place playing off 27
2014	Knoxy	Second place including 41 point round off an astonishing 37
2015	Oli D	Joint highest ever 3 round total of 112, playing off 9 docked to 6 after Round I
2016	Glenn	Joint highest scorer on debut, playing off a dubious 11
2017	BT	Led the charge to change tour rules, recalibrated everyone's handicaps and then won the tour
2018	Rufus	Won the tour off a lady's handicap of 32

YEAR	WINNER	REASON
2019	Tully	For finishing 2nd, 2nd, 3rd on his first three tours playing off 20
2020	Robbo	Winning the tour playing sober off 18 and an opening round 41 pointer
2021	Knoxy	Second place off 32
2022	Rob	Bombing it miles down the middle for 105 points off 17
2023	Robbo	Second place and 102 points off 18
2024	Boysie	Hitting 112 points to secure the Green Jacket playing off 24
2025	Paddy	Second place playing off 13
2026	Oli G	Second place on his return to tour off a consistently high unofficial handicap of 16

Highlighted row added after BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Enjoy a rogues gallery of some BDT Bandits over the years!

THE XOLOS

BDT 2008 – Oli G

BDT 2011 – Coxy

BDT 2013 – Charlie

BDT 2017 – BT

BDT 2018 – Rufus

BDT 2019 – Tully

BDT 2020 – Robbo

BDT 2021 – Knoxy

BDT 2023 – Robbo

BDT 2024 – Boysie

BDT 2025 – Paddy

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

Oli G won his third Xolo.

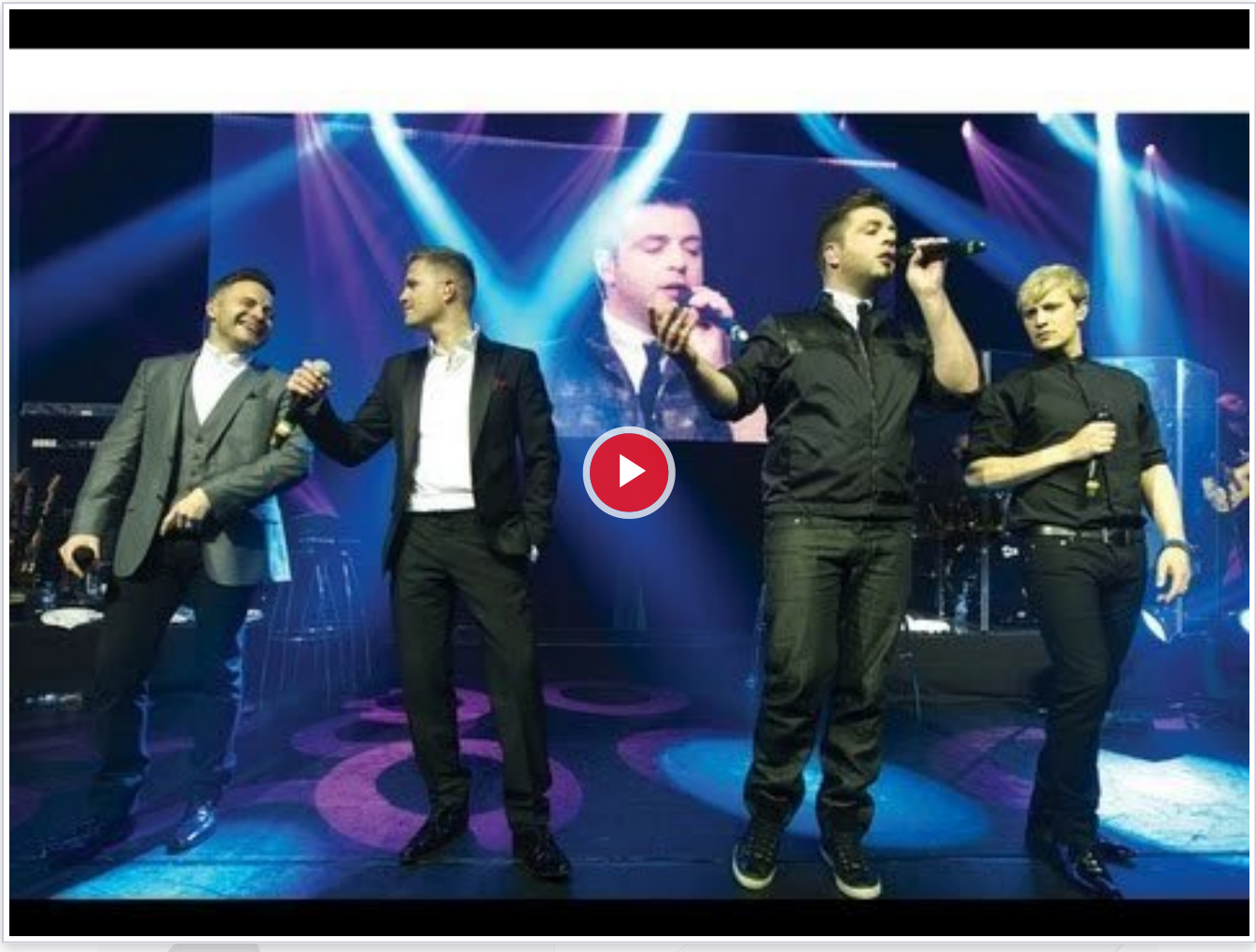
Oli G victorious in Scottsdale

DT's Charity Evening

34

BDT 2012 · Marbella · Featuring DT & Coxy

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale



▶ **Watch:** The Fashion Kicks Event

For BDT 2012 Villa el Canine was the setting for the tour's second visit to Marbella. However, unbeknownst to the London boys, the Northern contingent were encountering some severe difficulties and came dangerously close to missing their flight!

DT had (bravely, or perhaps foolishly) agreed to attend the "Fashion Kicks" charity event at Lancashire County Cricket Club, where the host was Shay Given and some of DT's other celebrity pals were in attendance.

The Rattlesnake ended up going full tilt at this event such that he turned in around 5am completely smashed and certainly not in a fit state for his scheduled 4am minibus pick-up by Coxy. After almost an hour of first of all trying to find DT, then rouse DT, then move DT into the minibus, then keep DT standing up straight through airport customs, incredibly he did make it on to his flight.

Upon his arrival at Malaga the London boys noted that DT was still completely smashed, so Lord only knows what state he had been in four hours earlier! The northern contingent, and Coxy in particular, deserved a medal for ensuring DT was with us and it is safe to say they were all ready for a beer! DT's own account of this episode is below and is well worth a read!!!

DT

"There's many an hour that we would all like to erase from the memory bank, but it has to be said mine was "not my finest 12 hours"!!!

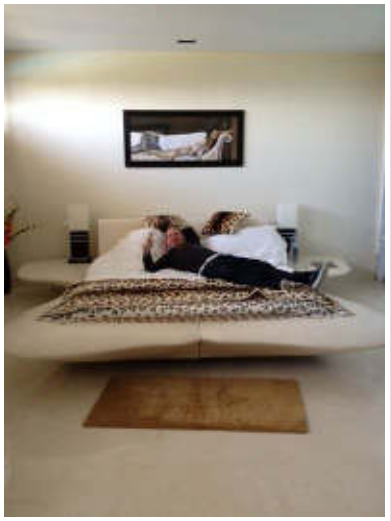
The year was Marbella 2012, our 1st year at the amazing "kennel" we went on to have for the next couple of years. I was proud to be travelling to this particular Big Dogs Tour as Captain of the Mighty Bloodhounds. My mistake however was to attend a good friend's Charity Ball the night before our early departure (c6am Flight) to Spain.

Fully aware that it was an early start I had already arranged with the one and only Coxy to kindly collect me from my hotel in Manchester which was near to Lancashire County Cricket Club, where the Charity event was being held. Coxy said he would collect me from the hotel at c4am so we could get to Liverpool Airport in good time to meet the Northern lads of which most were my team. I thought "perfect"! Attend the event and show my support to my good friend, leave the event at midnight, head back to the hotel and have a couple of hours sleep in preparation for Coxy picking me up at 4am. WRONG!!!!!!!

After a hectic day coaching and rushing round getting my stuff packed for the Big Dogs trip, I headed to the hotel to get checked in and ready for a great, but what I had planned to be a quiet, night at the Event. Needless to say the night didn't go as quietly as I had planned, in fact it couldn't have been further from quiet!!

After every great event comes an even better after party to which I went and consumed even more red wine and basically any alcohol I could get down my neck! My biggest regret of that night was to completely lose track of time!

The after party was in full flow, the banter was flying and the drinks out of control at this point, I was dancing away on the dance floor with the rest of the after party when all of a sudden I am face to face with COXY!!!


DT finally arises from his slumbers!

"Where the f*** have you been! I have been to your hotel you weren't there! I have been calling you and you haven't answered your phone (no service!). I have been stood outside for half hour asking security if I can come in and get my friend! (They told me NO, there's no one in there they have all gone home!) (we hadn't it was just select few who were still there) now get a f***ing move on we are going to miss this flight".

At that point I think F*** - Big Dogs trip!! I'd better get myself sorted!!

Coxy was doing his best to get me out of the place and back to the hotel for me to get changed and pick up my case and clubs for the Big Dogs trip! I could barely stand up at this point and Coxy was going mad at me (with every good reason!). We finally got into a cab (not the original one we had by the way as this had to leave for another job!) and head for Liverpool airport!

Next thing I know Coxy was shouting "DT wake up we are here!" (no response from me). "DT wake the f*** up we are here and we have to rush to get this flight or we will miss it!!!" (one eye open I say ok mate!) (I think) open the door (or maybe he opened it) I fell flat on my face out of the cab, scrabbling to my feet, with the help of Coxy dragging me by one arm, I grabbed my case and clubs (or maybe Coxy got these for me??).

We started walking into the main terminal, me still not aware what day it is let alone where the foooook I was flying to! The Northern lads at this point were waiting for us, amongst them several of my team members who were awaiting the arrival of their Team Captain for the week; they take one look at me and say "you're taking the p!ss aren't you?! You're not that drunk!!" Coxy replies "he f***ing is! Now we better checked in for this flight!".

I think I am right in saying that Buzz (I think it was) had to hold me upright as I checked in for the flight! Thankfully they let me on and, albeit after a terrible journey during the entirety of which I had my head down on the table, we arrived in Malaga Airport.

Still totally wrecked I tried to sample some beers with the lads at the airport before the transfer to the Kennel. On arrival to the Kennel I was still totally fecked and had to spend the first afternoon of tour welded to the bed in my room. It was c4pm when I thought "right you better get your sh*t together here as you are the Captain of this team and have a speech to make at the OC!".

Thankfully I did pull myself round just in time for the OC and to get myself totally blitzed again that night (although I didn't need much to top up!!!!).

That, guys, to date, is my "Not My Finest Hour"."

DT was soon back to normal!

Tour Shirts

33

Across the tours · Featuring Hursty

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

There have been 44 Tour Shirts over 22 years of the Ryder Cup (in fact 45 including the "special" orange number for BDT 2004's short tourists) and they are always awaited with some curiosity and, perhaps, apprehension. Most years, Hursty and I have selected them and the Captains hand them out to their respective team-mates each year – with each Dog's number of caps a status symbol of tour ranking in terms of importance.

It's difficult to say why there is apprehension around the unveiling of the shirts but it seems to be that the Bloodhounds have a degree of mistrust of the Retrievers' selections. This first really started on BDT 2013 with the unveiling of that year's shirt – the infamous "Snot Green" number!

This is, of course, grossly unfair and we take great care each year to ensure that both teams receive a quality number. So, fear not, Bloodhounds, you have an absolute Barry Belter in store for Scottsdale!

BDT 2004

BDT 2005

BDT 2006

BDT 2007

BDT 2008

BDT 2009

BDT 2010

BDT 2011

BDT 2012

BDT 2013

BDT 2014

BDT 2015

BDT 2016

BDT 2017

BDT 2018

BDT 2019

BDT 2020

BDT 2021

BDT 2022

BDT 2023

BDT 2024

BDT 2025

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

The 25th Anniversary Tour shirts for Scottsdale.

BDT 2026 – Bloodhounds

BDT 2026 – Retrievers

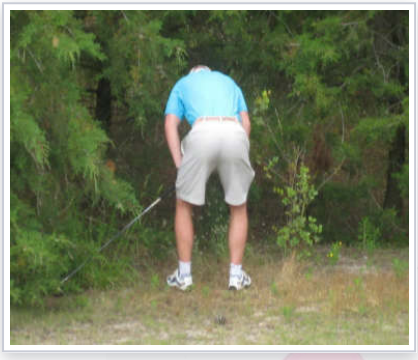
Spewing

32

Across the tours · Featuring Boysie, Charlie, Robbo, Marshy, Langers, Fred, Langers & Bean

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Perhaps unsurprisingly we have had our fair share of spewing moments on the tour and these are only the ones that people have admitted to (or been caught in the act)!



Marshy!

Langers!

Fred's Afters!

Bean's Afters!

Boysie	BDT 2003	Spewing on La Manga North Course (see story below!)
Charlie	BDT 2003	Spewing at La Manga (again see story below!)
Robbo	BDT 2006	Spewing on 15th tee bed (Memory 23 will recount)
Picko	BDT 2007	Five minute long spew on 4th tee bed at The Emirates
Marshy	BDT 2008	Spewing in the bushes prior to first tee shot, Round III
Langers	BDT 2015	Spewing in a cab and kipping on front lawn of PGA National
Fred	BDT 2018	Sink spew after going hard during the day (evidence above)
Langers	BDT 2021	Spewing in BT's room during the OC
Bean	BDT 2025	Cheeky little street spew prior to going in Palais Jad Mahal

In the tour archives we have detailed accounts of two such spews, both from the La Manga tour, so here they are; the latter comes from Charlie but, first of all, Boysie's Up!

BOYSIE

"There have been a number of tour highlights over the years and a number of tour lowlights. For me and by way of example Robbo and I being identified as homeless tramps by a lad of about 8 when we were led on a bench outside the airport at Murcia is a lifetime low. Taking fines for being a "short" tourist at Lagos wasn't great.

Climbing the large hill in Mallorca at Son Termens only to discover that I had missed the par 3 twelfth was not good. The distances to the golf courses in Lisbon were memorable for all the wrong reasons.

Undoubtedly, however, my lowlight came in the first round at La Manga.

La Manga was a seven-day Tour in summer 2003. It was also mid-summer and bloody warm. Naturally everyone was keen for the smash and as there were a number of new faces it was important that we had a good drink in anticipation of the golf to follow.

The opening night commenced with a few "cheekies" outside the apartments before heading up to the piano bar. From there and following a good sing along by all the dogs we hit the La Manga campus nightclub where The Monkey proceeded to blow the entire kitty within 27 minutes and has never since been entrusted with it.

Many of you will know that I usually have a bit of a problem with the "get up" on the first morning of Tour; that I am horribly hung over and there is not much interest in carrying a heavy bag around a golf course in searing summer heat. Nevertheless that is what Tour entails and it is part of the fun.

I need to give this Tour tale a bit of context. I was the returning champion. I had beaten all comers in Marbella and had a title to defend. Notwithstanding my desire to retain my title I had played no golf in preparation. Error.

The first round was played on the "North Course". For those of you who have not played the North Course, or for those who can't remember, let me tell you or remind you of the first hole. It is approximately 400 yards long and straight. I think the green was the scene of Robbo's infamous fresh air putt and the start of his nine-point round. Generally the North Course is wide and open. There is very little tree coverage and it is quite a forgiving place to have a hack.

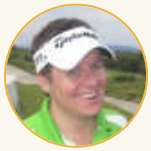
As defending champion I had the honour of taking first swipe. Fortunately I connected and the ball disappeared somewhere up the middle. We were out of the blocks.

My first swipe was not the high point or the low point of this first round. In fact I actually played quite well despite what followed. The problems started at about the time that I had a swing at the ball for the second time. I remember going slightly dizzy and feeling a bit nauseous. Better out than in I thought and so having excused myself from my playing partners I had a little tactical sickness under the trees on the right side of the first. Jolly good. Job done I believed. Wrong.

For the next 10 holes I hit a shot and had some sick; hit a shot and had some sick; hit a shot and had some sick, including one particularly memorable occasion when in a bunker on the fifth or the sixth I hit a shot, fell over in the sand and, you guessed it, had some sick.

Never in all my days have I experienced anything like it. By the tenth I had walked off. I fell asleep in some shade under a tree before I was woken by an English couple who suggested that I should probably seek urgent medical assistance. Declining their kind offer to drive me to the on-site Doctor I retreated to the bar and decided that in actual fact having had a little snooze I could probably manage a lager, which is what I did."

Remarkably, Boysie's was not the only spewing incident in La Manga. Charlie takes us through his own first experience of tour golf on what was his debut tour:



CHARLIE

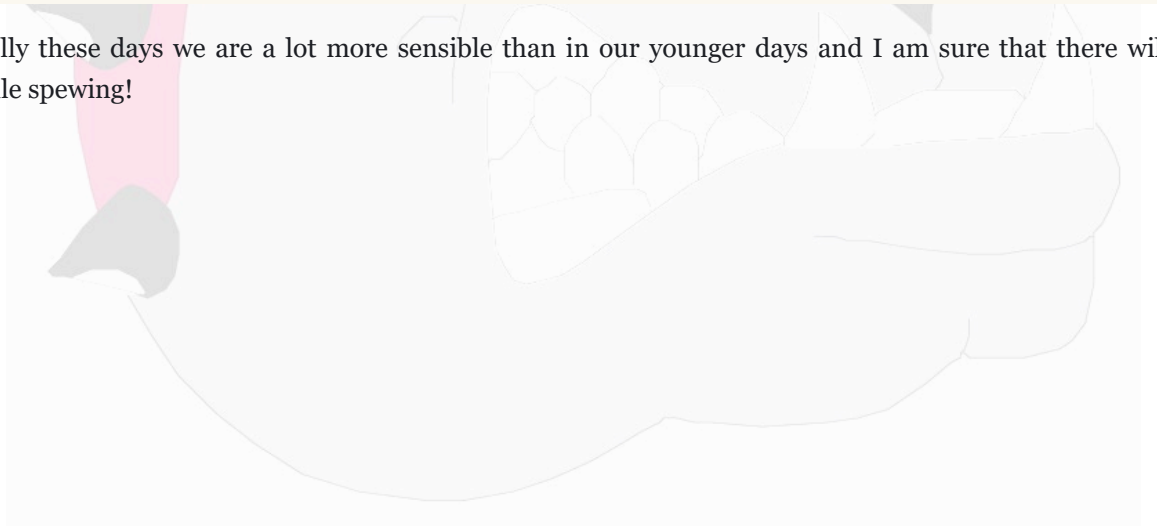
"As I try to put together which tour was which, what round was where, you soon realise how far the Big Dogs Tour has become since the early days.

Ah yes, the early days, AKA: La Manga. As this is the one tour that doesn't seem to be blurred with Lagos, Vilamoura and Mallorca memoirs, I can vividly pick out a particular low point.

The evening was the night before the third round and the introduction of the soon-to-be customary order of 12 bottles of Rose as a starter at every meal. As a new strategy of the Tour in order to find some wind, it quickly became an exercise in how quickly all bottles could be polished off before informing Stavros to raid the cellar of the seafood restaurant for 12 more.

> Roughly 90 mins later, 12 charged up dawgs were ready to reacquaint themselves with Spikes bar and the subsequent order of 12 large Vodka Red Bulls every five mins. This particular evening was an attempt to drink the bar dry to enable us to finally allow the staff to let Elton Ravo perform his anthem (as Ash describes elsewhere, it would take a few more nights and plenty of euros to do so however!).
>
> A couple of hours into the Spikes session, all was not good and a need to 'create some drinking space' became particularly apparent. Rather than be caught by an unsuspecting Retriever over trap two emptying the contents of my stomach lining, I managed to drag myself back to the golf villa and violently projectile vomit in peace and quiet, admittedly through burning nostrils and streaming eyeballs. Returning to the action, and only Rodney Dog suspecting my disappearing act, I cracked on where I left off.
>
> My next memory is waking up on a wall, a beaming flash light zorbing through my eyeballs thanks to the security guard, and about three naked arses running around the place, with another flashlight in hot pursuit. The security guard had his work cut out that night - how I ended up in my kennel I have no idea.
>
> I am relieved to say the resulting golf the next day at the North Course doesn't get a mention in the Big Dogs Tour Results as it is vivid only for the first three holes and was undoubtedly the worst round I've ever played.
>
> Playing against Robbo and Marshy (I think the playing partner was Permatan) who were all also in a world of pain, I managed to scrape a six on the 1st hole somehow. 2nd hole, the par 3, I managed to four putt and another juicy six. I must also add that this was the same round/hole where Robbo managed to pull off his infamous freshie with his putter!!
>
> Moving on, 3rd hole - sliced the drive, standard. 2nd shot, a cracking 6 iron out of the rough to the green that all dawgs followed with eager anticipation, only to realise some five seconds later having not witnessed the pin rattle, that I never hit the bloody thing and there she was staring back up at me.
>
> A serious freshie of the finest order and from which I never recovered! Some seriously p!ssed up dawgs that day and a round which I completely switched off from and was probably piggy-backed around for the rest.
>
> Can't wait to get back involved lads and let the good times roll!"

Thankfully these days we are a lot more sensible than in our younger days and I am sure that there will be no Scottsdale spewing!



Mystery Dogs

31

BDT 2012 · Marbella

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

▶ **Watch:** Mystery Dog I!

The BDT 2012 Preview DVD was A Question of Dogs, featuring the Taylor Brothers. One of the rounds was the famous “Mystery Guest” round, or in this case “Mystery Dog”.

▶ **Watch:** Mystery Dog II!

Two tourists donned a full Scooby Doo outfit and the Taylors had to make the guess at who those tourists were.

Both Taylors failed in this quest. Can you do any better?

Darasim

30

BDT 2004 · Lagos · Featuring Paddy, Ravo, Ash, Marshy, Boggy & BT

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

The name “Darasim” is legendary amongst the Big Dogs, due to the events of Thursday 9 September 2004.

Darasim!

BDT 2004 had concluded a few weeks earlier and post-tour banter had been limited as the Dogs licked their collective wounds and got their heads back in the real world. One email chain, however, does stand out. It all started on a bland Thursday morning with an email from my good self:

Me: “Chaps, if you're bored this afternoon I've just spoken to Stu and he is lumping in with his biggest bet in 6 months on a nag. I shudder to think of the amounts involved, but if you want to get stuck in it's called Darasim and is running in the 2.25 at Doncaster. Odds won't be brilliant but you should be able to get around 11/4 or 9/4. I think a lot of cash will be going in on it this morning so the sooner you get involved the better odds you will get - take the fixed price. Stu's two biggest tipsters have both said to lump in and that happens twice a year he reckons!!!"

Hursty: “Got the call when stood outside Ladbrokes in Romford. How convenient. Let’s hope that Black Thursday doesn't strike twice!”

BT: “I'm in!”

Ash: “I'm thinking £50. What do you reckon?”

Paddy: “I've just got back from Billy Hill having got £270 on the nose at 2-1 - not all mine but most of it is!”

Ravo: “£500 and counting already on from JLL, got 9/4 on the win, plus there was a 10/1 bet that Darasim would win and Dancing Bay coming second – I am a dead dog in the office if this nag doesn’t come in.”

Paddy: “Me and you both, there's a lot of very excited puppies in my office!”

Marshy: “Talking of puppies, it's a lovely sunny day outside!”

Ash: “Not happy about your odds Ravo. There's only 3 of us on board here.”

Paddy: “4 from here.”

Ravo: “13 so far from here.”

Paddy: “Chaps you can listen online here if you have a laptop.”

[Gap for race.....]

> BT: “B*llocks..he did a Paula Radcliffe!”
>
> Boggy: “Looks like a quiet one for me this weekend then.”
>
> Ravo: “I am not Mr Popular in my office!”

Suffice to say that after a bright start Darasim faded fast and did not produce the goods with a lowly 5th placed finish!

RACING POST

Search horses, jockeys and trainers ...

2:25 Doncaster — 9 Sep 2004

GNER Doncaster Cup (Group 2)
(Class 1) (3yo+) (2m1f197yds) **2m2f** Good
1st £41,500 **2nd** £41,500 **3rd** £11,500 **4th** £5,500

Result | Analysis | My Ratings | Past Winners

Pedigrees | Comments

POS.	HORSE / SP	JOCKEY / TRAINER	AGE	WGT	OR	TS	RPR	MR
1 (4)	2. Millenary › 7/1	J: T Quinn › T: John Dunlop ›	7	9-4 b	117	46	116	–
	Held up, smooth headway 4f out, stayed on to take narrow lead inside final furlong, joined post (op 6-1 tchd 15-2)							
1 (8)	dht 6. Kasthari › (IRE) 14/1	J: Johnny Murtagh › T: Howard Johnson ›	5	9-1	112	43	113	–
	Tracked leader, challenged 4f out, led over 2f out until inside final furlong, rallied to join leader on line (tchd 16-1 in places)							
3 (6)	3½ [3½] 4. Dancing Bay › 5/1	J: Kieren Fallon › T: Nicky Henderson ›	7	9-1	116	39	109	–
	Tracked leaders, smooth headway over 3f out, ridden and one pace final 2f (op 9-2 tchd 11-2 in places)							
4 (2)	2 [5½] 5. High Accolade I › 5/1	J: Martin Dwyer › T: Marcus Tregoning ›	4	9-1 tv	115	37	107	–
	Held up, headway 5f out, ridden and hung left over 3f out, one pace final 2f (op 7-2 tchd 11-2 in a place)							
5 (7)	3 [8½] 1. Darasim › (IRE) 6/4F	J: Joe Fanning › T: Mark Johnston ›	6	9-4 v	115	36	107	–
	Led, quickened 4f out, headed over 2f out, faded approaching final furlong (op 15-8 tchd 11-8)							
6 (5)	¾ [9¼] 3. Corrib Eclipse › 18/1	J: J F Egan › T: Jamie Poulton ›	5	9-1	106	33	103	–
	Held up and behind, effort over 4f out, kept on, never near leaders (op 16-1 tchd 20-1)							
7 (1)	1¼ [10½] 7. Romany Prince › 16/1	J: Richard Hughes › T: David Elsworth ›	5	9-1	108	31	101	–
	Held up in rear, headway 9f out, soon chasing leaders, lost place over 2f out							

The Final Results

43 Points

29

BDT 2013 · Marbella · Featuring Buzz, DT, Paddy & Robbo

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

The Big Man contemplates his golfing woes

Over the course of 24 tours, some truly awful golf has been played. Hursty's 4 point round needs no further introduction but there have been numerous other terrible rounds and Shitzu awards deservedly won.

But when it comes to the consideration of consistently horrendous golf over the course of a single tour, that accolade goes (perhaps surprisingly) to BDT 2004 winner, Big Buzz. In the Big Man's defence, he was struggling with back issues at the time, but those who played with Buzz on BDT 2013 will recall some pretty horrific scoring!

There was an inauspicious start in Round I as Buzz scored 15 points and lost 7&5 with Boggy against Oli G and Gav. He was looking to bounce back in the Round II fourballs at Los Flamingos, being partnered with DT against Robbo and Paddy.

In previous years the DT & Buzz partnership had been one to fear, and pre-match banter the night before was plentiful, with Buzz regularly telling all and sundry that they were going to smash the Retrievers. Sadly, the Big Man's confidence proved to be misplaced.

On the course Buzz was spraying it and I recall standing on probably the 10th tee being 3 or 4 UP with the Bloodhounds seriously on the ropes. "Come on Buzz, let's get in the game now" was DT's plea as the Big Man made his way to the tee.

Freezemaster, Smack - cue one of the biggest duck hooks I have ever witnessed (followed swiftly by a "Shot Buzz" from Robbo)! The ball sailed miles left into a vast woodland, so deeply embedded that it was not even worth a wander to search for it. Reload, Freezemaster, Smack - an overcorrection and this time the ball veered 45 degrees right into a large lake (with Robbo again following up with a "Shot Buzz"). There must have been at least 350 yards between the two balls!

DT managed to single-handedly prolong the agony until the 15th where we shook hands 5&3 and not long afterwards the Big Man looked truly brow-beaten come the end of his round after a 12 pointer. Alas, things did not improve much in Round III which was a 16 point round and poor Buzz could only muster 43 points over his three rounds, an unwanted tour record that stands to this day.

They say that all records are there to be broken and I daresay that no-one will make too much of this one for fear of cursing themselves! Thankfully, that has proven to be his nadir; Buzz has since regrouped and to his immense credit actually challenged for the Green Jacket just two tours later in Malmö, scoring 109 points only to lose to Oli D's remarkable 112 point total. It's a funny old game.

A memory of Round II of Buzz's tour comes with this video which demonstrates that the Big Man's putting game was not quite where it needed to be – the classic moment being that the distance the ball flies past the hole indicates the putt must have been a 40 footer but then Buzz appears in frame a split second later!

▶ **Watch:** The famous Buzz putt!

The Big Man talks us through the experience from his perspective:

BUZZ

"When casting my mind back over the various tours I have participated in, there are actually not that many moments I would want to forget! This is something I'm sure all of the Dogs will relate to. Upon closer scrutiny, however, it's really a toss up between four contenders as follows:

1) Being selected as the Monkey's brother in "Guess The Brothers" game;

2) 2013 - Round I;

3) 2013 - Round II; and

4) 2013 - Round III.

Only joking Hursty, clearly this is a very easy one for me and it has to be my golfing exploits in Marbella in 2013!

In preparation for tour my golf had been a little scant to say the least which was in hindsight a foolish decision particularly being the reigning Shitzu Champion (albeit in an incomplete tour)!

My confidence was, however, good which was well demonstrated by the carefully selected 'smash' attire laid out on my bed prior to packing (night one, night 2, night 3 and night 4) not realising, I needn't have bothered as my clothing would be compulsory and the same every night.

Furthermore my chat to Robbo on the plane, clearly misplaced, suggesting that my game was in good shape and there was zero chance of being back to back Shitzu.

On Round I myself & Neil took on Oli & Gav and lost 7&5. I'd love to say we were unlucky but when totting up my points that would be a hard one to explain. Total 15 points. Not ideal I thought, we have all had bad days, take the positives, it can't get any worse.

Those thoughts went straight out of the window after Round II with 12 points, good. A round that had DT giving me a bit of a lesson on the 2nd after a shank into the woods and Robbo and Paddy having a good laugh about it plus me playing the wrong ball at some point during the round wasn't conducive to good scoring.

Then to the Singles against Harbo off 4, who by all accounts had been flushing everything on Rounds I and II. This didn't bode well. Thankfully the intervention of a heavy night out in the port and some Stella Miguels on the course (for Harbo not me) and my best round that tour (which isn't saying much) amassing a humongous 16 points resulted in only a loss 4&3. Not as bad as it could have been.

Three rounds of golf I would happily forget!”

Big Buzz On The Course

1,000 Yard Stare

28

BDT 2006 · Mallorca · Featuring Hursty, Langrish, BT & Little

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Next up a story about a startled Spaniard from BDT 2006 when we hit Mallorca. I will leave it to Langrish to take you through the detail from the perspective of a direct witness!

"Grace from Big Brother", apparently!

LANGRISH

"We had already had a number of eventful nights out in Mallorca, but one moment sticks in my mind, and I'm sure, in the mind of the poor Spanish lad in the wrong place at the wrong time.

Now picture the scene. You're sharing an intimate romantic evening with your young lady dog. You're on the beach, stars above and the sound of the waves gently breaking on the shore - perfect - what possibly could ruin this moment? Well I'll tell you...

After a long night on the smash (standard), which included the celebrity spoofing of Grace from Big Brother and Hursty dog stealing a young local's scooter, the Dogs had split into two groups. One pack led by young Ash into town to throw some shapes and bad lines and the other, consisting of Little, Hursty, BT and Myself, decided to stay local.

BTrumpet

After a few more beers, shots, beer shots, shot shots and a swift half (sorry lads, it was Little's round!) we all found ourselves playing spoof with a group of rather unremarkable females. Needless to say our banter was on fire!

Well we thought it was but they all thought it was rubbish. For some reason they weren't entertained by a 30 year-old man playing a child's trumpet!

However, one of the group took a shine to one of ours (I will mention no names) and they were soon heading back to hers for coffee. Hursty, BT and I decided to escort them back. You can now all work out who was in for some Nescafe!?! Gregory...it was Little if you're struggling!

On the walk back the group split again at her apartment and Hursty, BT and I found ourselves on a lovely secluded bay, and looking out to sea the three of us all saw a large rock circa 50 metres out. The shout went out to swim for the rock. Without hesitation we were all stripped and running into the drink. After 5 mins of attempting to swim we realised that the large rock only 50 metres away was in fact a f**king massive rock 2 miles away so we gave up and on the call of the trumpet returned to shore.

Stumbling up the beach we attempted to retrieve our clothes. BT and I gathered ours but Hursty was distracted - his 1000 yard stare had spotted some movement on a sun bed close to us. I would like to say he approached with caution.

Monkeying About!

Now back to our young Romeo...I don't know if you have ever been charged at pace by a smashed, wet, 15 stone, silverback in small black pants, but to say this guy S**T himself would be the understatement of the year!

Hursty pulled up short and actually said "alright lad", but judging by the look of fear on this guy's face I think he thought this was English/monkey for "I love you long time"!! Hursty lingered for a few moments just to ensure this guy would have night terrors for the rest of his life then slipped back into the darkness.

As I said: a moment that will stick in mine and his memory for a long time."

The Monkey Scoots Away Into The Distance!

Tour Photos

27

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

BDT 2018 – Chilling On The Course!

We have amassed literally thousands of photos over the course of 24 tours and a question that springs to mind is: what is the greatest ever tour photo? This is, of course, a subjective question and everyone will have their own personal favourite. A memorable photo from each tour to date is set out below but when it comes to favourites, my two are the following:

Number One!

In second place is this photo taken on Day IV of BDT 2006 which for me encapsulates the BDT – teammates celebrating a Ryder Cup victory – and naturally a personal favourite as I had skippered the Retrievers to victory that year. It's the colours brought by the outfits that make it a great pic for me. From the Hawaiians to Robbo in the just-awarded Green Jacket to Marshy in his England footy kit. Then the finishing touches brought by the Aviators, BT's trumpet blowing and the Ryder Cup. Finally, the backdrop to Purlo's karaoke stage brings to mind a spectacular performance by Purlo!

This photo comes from BDT 2010 and is probably my all-time favourite tour photo as it raises a chuckle every time I look at it!

It was Night III and we had hit a bar for a sharpener before our evening meal. It did not go unnoticed that the barmaid was quite attractive and it's almost as if everyone had been waiting for the moment she turned to get our drinks.

Number Two!

It features no less than 10 of the 16 Dogs on that tour and the profile of us all perched at the curved bar is just perfect. Speaking of curves it's the range of expressions that makes me chuckle every time.

From the furrowed brows and sheer concentration on the faces of BT, DT, Little, Langrish and Oli G, to the almost bewilderment on Ash's face, to the faces of Charlie, Buzz and Hursty simply chuckling and raising eyebrows to the camera at the ridiculousness, and then finally to Knoxy just smiling at the overall reaction!

BDT 2002 – Boysie Wins The First Ever Individual

BDT 2003 – La Manga Bungalows

BDT 2004 – One of Only Three Photos From The Tour! The Days When A Glove Was A Compulsory Part Of Tour Attire

BDT 2005 – The Full Contingent With Little In The Greyhound!

BDT 2006 – Welcome Back On Tour Boggy!

BDT 2007 – The Nicknames At Their Pinnacle!

BDT 2008 – The Three Stages Of A Tour Evening

BDT 2009 – Pre-Planned Dress Code From The Retrievers!

BDT 2010 – A Lively Evening!

BDT 2011 – The Aftermath of Bite & Swipe!

BDT 2012 – The Washed-Out Round & Tour!

BDT 2013 – Post Round Stories!

BDT 2014 – El Cano In Hawaiians!

BDT 2015 – The Shitzu Sorts Another Round!

BDT 2016 – The 15th Anniversary Trip!

BDT 2017 – A Lively Journey Back From Alcanada!

BDT 2019 – A Lager Please Dog!

BDT 2020 – Banishing The Covid Dooms At The Belfry!

BDT 2021 – Settling In At Celtic Manor!

BDT 2022 – International Travel Is Back!

BDT 2023 – Has A Green Jacket Winner Ever Given More To The Cause?!

BDT 2024 – Some Group!

BDT 2025 – Great Setting For The OC!

BDT 2026 – Sunset in Scottsdale at Grayhawk

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

Scottsdale's contender sits alongside BDT 2025's above.

The Elton Ravo Prize

26

BDT 2003 · La Manga

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

One of the tour “trophies” is the Elton Ravo Prize, but where did it all begin? Fortunately, Ash preserved the memory of a seminal moment in tour history, writing the following Tour Tail many years ago.

ASH

“One of the great tour highlights for me was watching the dedication with which Ravo set about learning the words to what is now the official tour anthem, "Your Song". Quite where Ravo got the idea from that he could sing is a mystery but that has never stopped him performing the Elton classic at every opportunity since that famous first performance in La Manga. In my mind, the funniest moment of any tour to date and well worth a trip down memory lane.

The Dogs in the aftermath of the Elton Ravo moment!

In those days the tour was a week long, which meant six consecutive nights on it and plenty of time to fill during the day. Monkey decided to have 6 all dayers. Bald dog attempted to enter the Guinness Book of Records for the most Quick Crafties in a day, and Ravo decided to learn the words to Your Song in preparation for a grand finale in the piano bar on the final night.

The difficulty was that the only words Ravo had in his vocabulary that week were "dog", "schmoker", and "schmoker dog", none of which featured in the lyrics to Your Song. Together with the effects of 16 Stella Miguels and the kitty master antics of Monkey dog, this made life very difficult for the aspiring crooner, who for three days could only remember the lines "It's a little bit funny!" and "I hope you schmoke mine!".

By day five, no one thought it was a little bit funny as Ravo sang these lines over and over again until the dogs were begging him to go back to talking about how he had schmoked his schmoker into the schmokey schmoke in the first round.

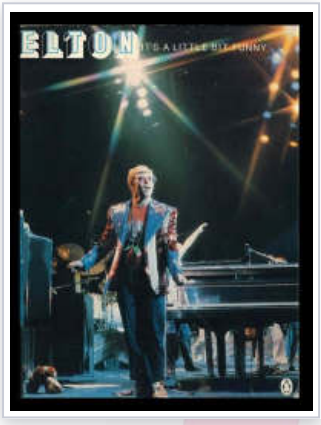
But gradually, he cracked it and delivered a beautiful rendition around the pool. Elton Ravo was all set for his big performance.

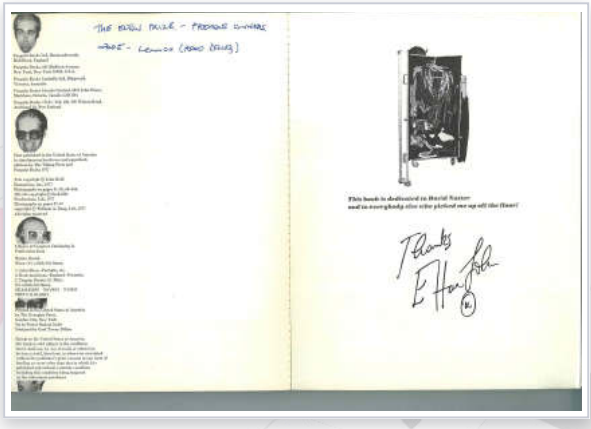
The Piano Bar, La Manga!

By about 10pm on the last night, 12 exhausted dogs wiped away their beer sweats and swept aside their end of tour demons to gather in the piano bar for one last round of vodka red bulls in anticipation of the big performance.

> Needless to say, when Ravo approached the pianist Brian and slurred something along the lines of "Do you mind if I have a go on your schmoker and schmoke a few lines of Your Song?", he wasn't overenthusiastic and neither were the group of retired golfers and families gathered around the piano for a relaxing evening. But eventually, just to shut Ravo up, Brian gave in.
>
> So excited was Ravo that no sooner had Brian knocked out the first couple of notes of the intro, he was already onto the chorus, prompting Brian to start again and warn Ravo that the next attempt would be "his last chance". Unfortunately, the other 11 dogs were crying so much with laughter by this stage that no one thought to capture the moment on camera so only those lucky enough to be there will remember just how good the next few minutes were. The Elton Ravo prize had been born."

The following year on BDT 2004, Ravo turned up on tour with an Elton book, signed by the great man himself and announced that he was creating a new trophy, the "Elton Ravo Prize", to be awarded to the Dog who provided the most memorable Karaoke performance on each tour which he, of course, successfully defended that year! The list of winners is set out below.





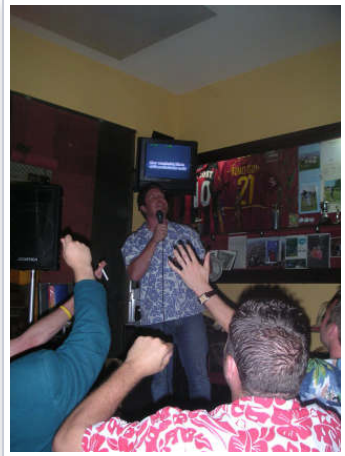
The Elton Ravo Prize

Table of the Elton Ravos!

YEAR	WINNER	SONG
2002	N/A	N/A
2003	N/A	N/A
2004	Ravo	I Hope You Schmoke Mine
2005	Little	Red Red Love
2006	Purlo	Ticket To Ride
2007	Langrish	The Littlest Hobo
2008	Boysie	Suspicious Minds
2009	Boggy	The Way To San Lorenzo
2010	Boggy	Hey Hey He's A Monkey
2011	Boggy	Ocean Drive
2012	Little	Red Red Love
2013	Boysie	Rocky Theme Tune
2014	Ollie	Redemption Song

YEAR	WINNER	SONG
2015	Rufus	Carefree
2016	BT & Rufus	Suspicious Minds
2017	BT, Adam G & Hursty	Candle In The Wind
2018	Fred	La Marseillaise
2019	BT	With Or Without You
2020	BT	Push It!
2021	Adam T	The Drugs Don't Work
2022	Kezza	You Are Always On My Mind
2023	Hulmey	Another Brick In The Wall
2024	Boysie	Na Na Na Na Na Na Na
2025	Adam T	Macho Man
2026	Charlie	Gold

Highlighted row added after BDT 2026 in Scottsdale



Some Elton Ravo Performances

What is the greatest karaoke performance in tour history? There have been many but for quality and, trust me, it pains me to say this, BT's spontaneous duet of With Or Without You in a Paphos bar on BDT 2019 did bring the house down.

For pure humour, Ravo's performance of "Your Song" on BDT 2003 and Purlo's "Ticket To Ride" on BDT 2006 take some beating, whilst it is always good value to have 24 lads belting out "Red Red Love" or "Whoooaa Sometimes I Get Gav Neilan"! On BDT 2007 nontourist Langrish singing The Littlest Hobo to the group from his commuter train home also deserves a special mention!

▶ **Watch:** Adam T – Never Mind The Drugs – The Song Doesn't Work!

As an aside, if you were wondering how on earth Adam T won the BDT 2021 prize when he didn't attend that tour to Celtic Manor, we were struggling to nominate a winner that year until Hursty spotted him putting in this performance, whilst on a site visit to Scarborough!

We look forward to seeing who will join the Elton Ravo roster in Scottsdale – Virgins, this is always one of the more straightforward trophies to win, so we expect great things!

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

Charlie comfortably won the Elton Ravo for this performance of Gold.

▶ **Watch:** Charles Hadley in Action

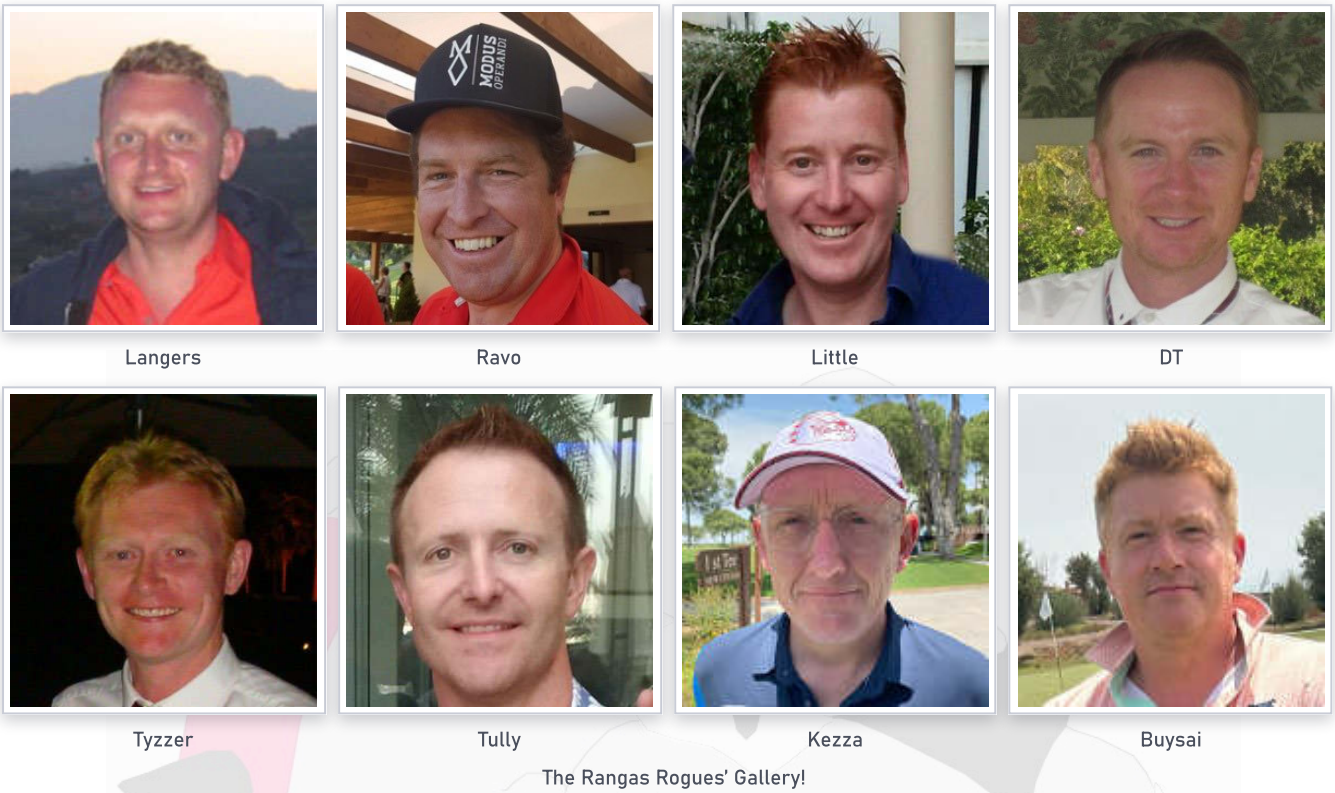
Charlie Takes The Prize

The RANGAS

25

BDT 2023 · Turkey

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale



The Rangas Rogues' Gallery!

Ranga was a term first introduced to the group by Marshy in the build-up to BDT 2023.

Noticing the sheer number of strawberry blondes on the tour, he explained the dictionary definition of "Ranga", being:

"...an abbreviation of 'orangutan'. Used mostly in Australia, the word has gradually spread across the world and has now been adopted to refer to all redheads. It's thought that it began being used as a derogatory word around the 1990s in Australia's school yards."

By pure coincidence most of our Rangas belong to the Bloodhounds, so much so that a team name change has been mooted. With the Bloodhounds struggling to raise a team year on year, if one or two more redheads should join the fray then this remains a possibility!

What is for sure is that there is a lot of "Red Red Love" on the BDT!

Bryson DeSchambles

24

BDT 2025 · Marrakech

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

This memory comes from our most recent tour to Marrakech. On Day I, after some initial confusion around where we could and could not drink within the villa grounds, Dave Bryson demonstrated great initiative by ensuring that, surreptitiously, we were kept wellwatered throughout the afternoon (although we perhaps did not fully appreciate at that stage that he was watering himself more than anyone!). He and fellow Virgin Tom settled in marvellously and a fabulous first day was had by all.

The Brown Brothers

The following morning saw us take team buses to the first golf track, Assoufid. With this being one of Marrakech's most exclusive clubs (where we were also scheduled to dine that evening), before the tour Buzz and I had been at pains to ensure that our hosts, particularly the Director of Golf Guy Maxwell, knew that we were a group of professionals. This would help to allay any concerns over such a big group of guys turning up and bringing down the tone.

As we disembarked from the buses, I noticed a few of the Bloodhounds looking more than a little concerned and all I heard from the Big Man was "Dave's not in a good way" (that turned out to be the understatement of the year!). It transpired that Dave had managed to faint, throw up (on himself and on Langers) and sh*t himself! Extraordinary scenes from Bryson and as a result he will be forever known as Bryson DeSchambles! Meanwhile the Retriever bus had had its own issues with Robbo also desperately trying not to further poo himself having encountered his own "control" issues earlier in the day!

Bryson DeSchambles

I was about to head over to the Bloodhound bus to see what was going on with Dave but before I knew it Guy (who had clearly come out to scope out our group!) had wandered over to introduce himself to me. To make the right impression I beckoned to DT to come over and meet Guy, as he had been kind enough to let DT use his tour card to play gratis and we felt that the fellow pros could talk shop to settle us in nicely.

Just as DT was echoing my words about what a great bunch of lads we were, Buysai waddled past us, escorted (and propped up) by a couple of Bloodhounds, looking truly terrible and sporting his brand-new white tour shorts in which he quite clearly soiled himself!

DT and I tried to maintain our conversation with Guy but we were all momentarily stunned and speechless. Feeling very awkward we had little choice but to make our excuses and leave him to it to go and buy Bryson a replacement pair of whites!

We like our Virgins to make an impression and it would be fair to say that Dave certainly did that and not just in his pants!

Demon Repellent

23

BDT 2006 · Mallorca · Featuring Robbo, BT, Ash & Marshy

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

It's a common source of debate on tour: should there be a penalty for playing sober, or actually is playing sober a penalty in itself?!

Some Dogs are unequivocal about their position with Robbo being particularly vocal about the issue – "Demon Repellent" is an absolutely vital weapon in his tour golf armoury. In his story below, he explains why!

Kevin Marsh

ROBBO

"Mallorca 2006 - Royal Bendinat GC - on the eve of final round.

The game sitting 4½ points to 3½ points in the Retrievers' favour, excitement was building for a great final day. The singles were drawn out over lunch and produced some classic match-ups.

In my fourball and playing for the Retrievers was my old partner in crime BT; he had drawn Purlo out of the hat and I had been fortunate enough to get a chance to get at young Ash. A fourball that was likely to produce some quality golf, great laughs and perhaps a little squabbling. Perfect, the day was set.

During the meal BT and I swapped stories about our youth, ones that you have all heard before (BT pooing on the AstroTurf steps etc) and banter was great. The usual drinking games commenced after and life was good. Not looking to end the night early, Taylor and I took the half hour taxi ride to Magaluf to relive more of our youth.

A few more beers wandering around the streets of Magaluf and we bumped into BCM, Biggest Club Mallorca. We both thought that 20 dogs a man was a tad harsh on price for 2 hours dancing. The doorman then went on to explain that it was free drinks while we were in the establishment, we were in like Flynn.

A quick scout around the dance floor produced nothing, the birds looked like they'd been cocked more times than John Wayne's shotgun, so the bar welcomed us like an old friend.

Several 'snot the lots' later I was on the rails, legs had gone and BCMs felt a mile away from home, it was, well 20 to be precise. We called an end to the proceeding at 6 and set off home, with Oli. Not sure where Big Ols came from but he was definitely there.

The only reason why I knew Big Ols was in attendance is another story.

We finally landed back in Portals Nous at 8.30 am. No time for sleep as we had the final day to play and the coach was due in two hours.

A cold shower and a glass of wine over Breakfast set us up well for a day at the course. If I remember rightly we had an early tee time due to an England football match in the afternoon, one which Marshy was particularly looking forward to.

Big Dogs Ryder Cup - Mallorca 2006				
Day III - Royal Bendinat				
Bloodhounds			Retrievers	
	Langrish	v	Paddy (c)	Won 5&4
	Charlie	v	Picko	Won 4&2
	Purlo	v	BT	Won 1UP
	Ash	v	Robbo	Won 2&1
Won 5&4	Buzz	v	Oli G	
Won 6&5	Boggy	v	Knoxy	
Won 2UP	Boysie (c)	v	Hursty	
Won 4&3	Little	v	Marshy	
Day III Score	4		4	Day III Score
Overall Score	7½		8½	Overall Score

The amazing final day

BT and I then had the longest drive comp to compete for off the first, both still battered and a starter to watch us, great! Unbelievably mine flew off down the middle and I came out the winner, happy dogs and game on.

We both started to concentrate on the game in hand and as ever I started to produce my best golf while under the influence. I was out of the blocks and flying 6 up after 9, 2 over par and Ash was on the ropes.

It was then that the night before wore off; at the turn I was close to collapsing, I don't think I finished the next 4 holes and Ash was seriously back in the game. I hit my all-time tour low when I was spewing up on the 15th tee bed; not even the image of Big Ols, from the night before with an old bird who'd seen more stiffs than Quincy could raise my spirits. I quickly scoured the horizon between spews for the refreshments man selling cans of demon repellent, but my luck was out.

By the 17th tee I was 1 up with 2 to play, my early form had deserted me and I was in a battle. Ash was grinning, his 13 diet cokes from the night before hadn't seemed to affect him that much. I knew I needed a good hole, and the par 3 17th had to be it. I can't remember what weapon I hit but it was stiff and Ash was beaten. I'd come through an unbelievable low to grab a point for the team, 34 points for myself and, unbelievably, the individual trophy.

All smiles, claps and the usual banter of better luck next time. Back into the bar to watch England and laugh at Big Ols!

The final day was amazing, see the results below.

The 24 hours had produced some great highs and some terrible lows but I'd do it all again!!! Especially with you lot."

Bloodhounds and Retrievers in Mallorca

The MDE

22

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

There are now seven Members of the Dogs Empire (MDEs), being the following tourists:

2008: Paddy

2010: Robbo

2018: Ash

2018: Boysie

2020: Buzz

2021: Hursty

2022: Charlie

Undoubtedly each of these tourists has been a worthy recipient but it feels appropriate that special attention should be paid to two tourists.

We have all faced our battles over the years, but Robbo and Charlie have taken on particularly tough ones, Robbo in cheating death following his horrific accident in 2009 and Charlie in defeating the dreaded “C”.

▶ **Watch:** Granada News on Robbo

▶ **Watch:** Charlie Rings The Bell

The MDE

Tragically we already have lost a couple of our tourists in Ollie and Picko. Time will be a theme of this tour and as the years go by we are all increasingly grateful to be able to spend this precious time with each other, not least with these two legends of the tour in Charlie and Robbo.

Watch this space for the special announcement of MDE Number 8 in Scottsdale...

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

BT became the eighth MDE in Scottsdale.

BT accepts his MDE award

Girona Gav

21

BDT 2010 · Girona · Featuring Gav, Hursty & Fred

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

BDT 2010 welcomed two Tour virgins, Fred and Gav. Both have since gone on to make significant contributions to the tour, including captaining the Retrievers, but it would be fair to say that Gav made an inauspicious start to touring life.

The OC Theatre and The Judge!

His first mistake was booking a separate flight to the group and arriving significantly later than the rest of us, a clear breach of the tour rules, which led to accusations that he was perhaps not taking the tour sufficiently seriously, particularly as he was a virgin who should be looking to impress!

During Gav's absence at the OC, this was discussed at length with the conclusion reached that we should treat this lack of respect by greeting Gav with utter disdain when he entered the OC theatre. When he burst into the room full of beans, but very late, the total silence he received completely unnerved him, particularly given he had not even met half the Dogs before! A cruel start!

Things did not improve much for Gav from there. As he took his seat, he was immediately made to stand again and to his surprise was mercilessly fined by Judge Monkey for being late, despite having stumped up €100+ for his own personal cab from the airport in his rush to join us.

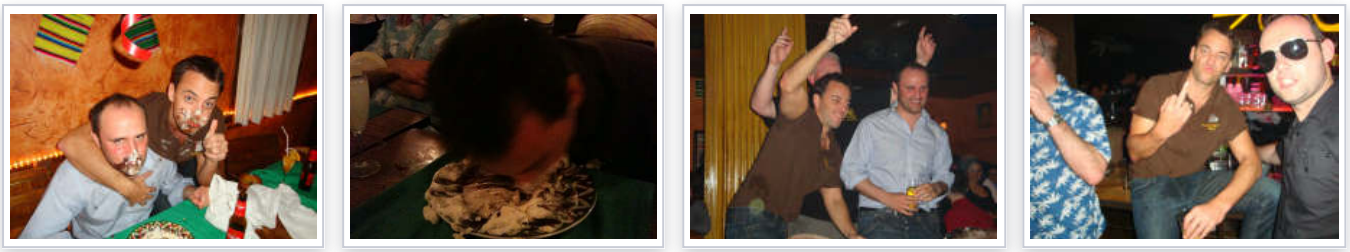
Night I

The next target was his attire. To no-one's surprise, Gav was wearing a smart and expensive shirt that first night but that soon changed when he and Fred were ordered by The Judge to replace their shirts with an 'I am a Virgin' T-shirt.

Having reluctantly donned this and still somewhat stunned by the self-generated storm that had materialised, Gav's backside had barely touched his chair again before he and Fred were back on their feet to be formally introduced to the Big Dogs and appropriately inducted by snotting a truly horrible drink.

This concoction in combination with several other drinks clearly affected Gav's golfing form, for the following day we hit the golf course and in his first ever tour round he recorded merely 19 points, the lowest of the day.

That evening, Gav appeared in the hotel lobby in another expensive new shirt but was quickly despatched back to his room to change, as we unveiled the Brown Shitzu jersey (to his absolute delight!). He was also forced into a cake-eating competition for good measure!



Night II

Sadly things had not improved for Gav after Round II, with a 20-point effort meaning that we had to inform him that he would still be wearing the Brown Jersey that evening – again he was simply delighted!

Night III

A memorable first tour for Neilan!

This was an unusual tour in that we only stayed for three nights, the shortest tour to date, and so come the tour's end Gav remarked that he had enjoyed himself hugely but was mildly disappointed not to have been able to wear any of his clothes for the entire duration of the trip! "Welcome to touring life" we responded!

Things could only get better and they must have as he's been back virtually every year since then!

The TISSI Tour

20

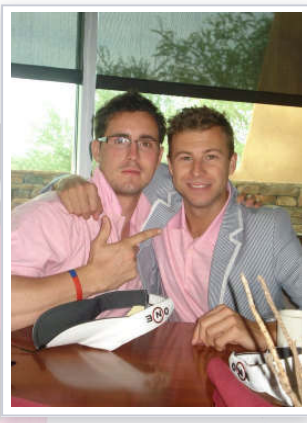
Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Forget the LIV, PGA and DP World tours, we all know that the BDT is THE most important global golf tour. Indeed the tour rules provide that attending another golf tour is a serious breach of the tour rules and several Dogs have faced severe consequences at the OC as a result.

The rule is hardly needed as, by and large, the group has stayed very loyal and few would even consider joining a rebel tour. Sadly, one of our group was persuaded to join what is known as the "TISSI" tour, TISSI apparently standing for: "Trans-Iberian Social Spoon Invitational". Whatever.

There was a time back in the day when we would all have to endure Ash's chat about TISSI-this and TISSI-that, what a set of "players" they all were, in a different league to us Dogs etc etc – YAWN!



One Tour Jacket Ash Has Worn!

Dual Towels – A DISGRACE!!

Scarcely Believable Photos!

These lads would rock up at a Chewbacca Challenge full of themselves and with nothing but disparaging comments about the BDT, calling us childish names such as the Little Puppies and The Poodles. Shocking. Valid questions were being asked of Ash as to which tour he really belonged to as the suspicion was that, behind closed doors, he was not entirely supportive of us.

It would be fair to say that most of these characters would simply not go down well at an OC! They would need taking down several pegs. So when Boggy offered us the opportunity to take them down at a Celtic Manor match-up we jumped at the chance to put aside Bloodhound vs Retriever rivalries to team together to do just that in 2010.

It was pleasing to report that not only did we demolish them on the course, but we also completely obliterated them off it. When push came to shove, compared with us tour veterans they were a bunch of amateurs, setting off at a Purling-Night-One-Of-Tour pace only to fade extremely rapidly as the evening progressed. We took them into some of Cardiff's finest hostelries and despite all the Larry-Large chat (and there was bucketloads of it!) they capitulated early doors.

That year's results are set out below and to this day the combined Retriever / Bloodhounds pairings just don't look quite right! Here is the 2010 match report from The Monkey.

The 2010 Match Report
James Hurst

HURSTY

"Following many weeks of meticulous preparation from the BDT Captain, Barry Chuckle, both teams arrived for the eagerly awaited tournament just in time for the opening ceremony at 1pm. This was where the BDT unfortunately took an early low blow as the TISSI boys were all dressed in matching blazers, shirts and trousers whilst we all looked slightly mis-matched in our tour stash. Particularly Ravo who had managed to lose his first Retriever jersey. 1-0 TISSI.

The TISSI Team

The Combined Big Dogs Team

What also became immediately apparent was that these boys had the edge in the looks and youth stats (save for the two dads who made up the numbers), which gave us the added incentive to take 'em down!

The respective captains announced the two teams and it was at this point that we all became slightly confused (similar to when Oli G announced his team in Girona) by the opposition's banter / humour! Whilst Neil announced his players by reference to previous tour nicknames, all of their players were known by their initials in the same vein as we refer to BT and DT.

It's fine having two, but bloody difficult to keep track of who's who when they are all being referred to as RB, DF, RC, PHD, CE etc etc!! This ritual continued throughout the entirety of our stay and even now I struggle to remember any of them! Rob Barry did tell me on the 4th that it was a public schoolboy thing and I probably wouldn't understand!

The format of the day was fourball better ball for the front nine and singles for the back with a total of 12 points on offer.

There were clearly a few nerves on the practice range as the Dogs started spraying to all angles of the valley but as the announcer welcomed the Tour President onto the first tee it was game on. Paddy and Ash both down the middle, TISSI in trouble off the tee, and we were under way!

The 2010 course was in immaculate condition and as we turned at the halfway hut the BDT were firmly in control winning the fourballs 3-1.

The Big Dog TISSI Trophy Celtic Manor - 2010 Front Nine - Fourball Better Ball				
	Big Dogs		TISSI	
Won 1UP	Paddy MDE & Ash	v	Graham Townsend & Terry Barry	
Won 3&1	Hursty & Buzz	v	Robert Barry & David Foreman	
	Ravo & Langrish	v	John Chambers & Robert Thompson	Won 3&2
Won 3&2	Boggy & Oli G	v	Paul Harris & Chris Evans	
Fourballs Score	3		1	Fourballs Score

Front Nine Scorecard

It was at this stage that I thought a little Heineken would go down well with my sausage sandwich. That it did, but unfortunately my next drive off the Par 5 11th managed to travel all of 2 yards leaving me with a most difficult second off the tee bed (with shorts dropped)! Thankfully Langrish followed suit not long afterwards...

Trousers Down

Despite a mighty effort from our younger, less experienced opposition to claw things back, it was just too much of a lead and the BDT ran out comfortable winners 8.5 - 3.5.

The Big Dog TISSI Trophy Celtic Manor - 2010 Back Nine - Singles				
Big Dogs			TISSI	
Won 2&1	Paddy MDE	v	Graham Townsend	
Won 4&3	Ash	v	Terry Barry	
A/S	Hursty	v	David Foreman	A/S
Won 2UP	Buzz	v	Robert Barry	
A/S	Ravo	v	John Chambers	A/S
	Langrish	v	Richard Thompson	Won 2UP
Won 4&2	Oli G	v	Paul H	
A/S	Boggy	v	Chris Evans	A/S
Singles Score	5½		2½	Singles Score
Overall Score	8½		3½	Overall Score

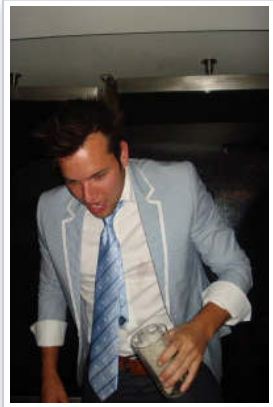
Back Nine Scorecard

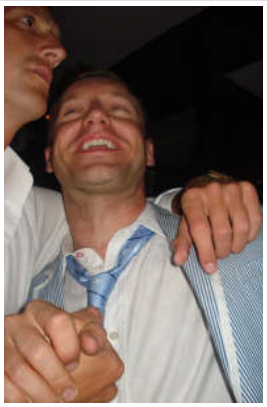
Richard Thompson was named MVP for TISSI after amassing 2 points out of 2 and scoring a virtually level par round by all accounts! Big Bad Buzz was awarded the MVD for the Big Dogs after also winning 2 points out of 2 and shooting 22 points on his front nine.

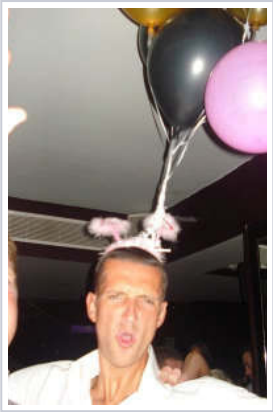
Celtic Manor Memories

All was not lost however for the TISSI boys as it was clear that they fancied their chances in the second activity of the day, the drinking. We all know that the Dogs should never be underestimated in this department!

The chosen establishment for the evening was Tiger Tiger where all 16 of us set about the evening's entertainment with pace and strength. It's fair to say that the TISSI boys showed their slight inexperience here, yet all the Dogs were most impressed with the aggressive manner in which they set about downing pints and ordering crazy drinks such as black sambuca and Jäger bombs before dinner. Approximately two hours later, three of their boys had puked and the others were well on their way!







Ruined TISSI Members

What was also very interesting about this early display of aggression was the speed in which Ash managed to drink two pints in one. Never ever has this been witnessed on a BDT and we all agreed that he was just showing off in front of his new tour buddies and proving that he would be able to live with them later in the year.

Ash Impressing His New Mates!

Having moved from the dinner table to the bar the pace became even more relentless as all forms of spirits, alcopops and other concoctions made an appearance. The sight of CE (think that's what they call him) strolling around the room with a bottle of vodka was certainly special. The bouncers obviously didn't agree and at some stage ejected the poor lad.

After throwing ourselves around the room to 'Don't Stop Believing' and 'Tonight's Gonna Be A Good Night', we turned round at 3.30am to realise that the squad of 16 had now diminished to a squad of 8. There wasn't a TISSI blazer or tie in sight yet 8 dogs remained, standing tall and ready for more. After a brief spell in another club (of the non-lapper variety), we all returned home en masse, a proud team that had just battered our opponents both on and off the course!!!

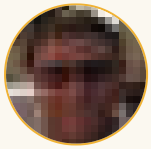
TISSI Demolished!

In the following days, as the stories started to flow from what happened to our TISSI friends, it turns out that they were all ejected from TT, some visited the Fantasy Lounge whilst others trudged around Cardiff City Centre continuing to swig neat vodka. The culmination of the evening was the TISSI captain arriving back to Celtic Manor at 5am with a police escort but without cash, phone and wallet (we've all been there!). Many thanks to Neil for organising a fantastic day and to the TISSI boys for their banter and sportsmanship.

Hursty"

The TISSI boys did not take defeat well and pestered us for a re-match, which Hursty announced would take place on Friday 21 March 2014 at Worplesdon GC per the following email.

The 2014 Re-Match
James Hurst



HURSTY

"Gentlemen,

Following Ash's house party on Saturday night (where BT, myself and Little were well outnumbered by TISSI amateurs) it was decided that 4 years on from the inaugural match, it was time for the second match to be played. It has been almost 4 years since the inaugural BDT v TISSI match took place and it's time to do battle again.

There has been plenty of chat about which tour is the best blah blah blah and this is the opportunity to score appropriate bragging rights from a golfing, drinking and general banter perspective!

The two teams are lining up as follows:

BDT	TISSI
James Hurst (Captain)	RB - Robert Barry
Fred Doyhamboure	WG - Will Grant
Brendan Taylor	DF - David Foreman
Anthony Knox	JC - John Chambers
Ashley Hurst (was a tough call but TISSI didn't want him)	DS - David Seddon
Ciaran Little	RT - Richard Thompson
Mark Clarkson	AP - Alex Partakis
Greg Boyes	CS – Chris Seddon

> We are playing at Worplesdon Golf Club in Surrey and the tee is reserved from 10.00am. The format as per the first match will be 8 v 8 with the first 9 holes being fourballs and the back nine singles for a total of 12 points.
>
> Bacon Butts will be served from 9am so I suggest you get down there around then. In terms of transport, there will be a bus leaving south west London so contact RT if you wanna get involved with this.
>
> The total cost per head is £65.00 which includes golf, bacon butts and lunch which believe me, is a bargain.
>
> We will be terrorising south west London in the evening so tell your Mrs (those who have one) that you'll see them on Saturday morning.
>
> There is no strict dress code as I have no doubt this is the only department where the Tissi boys may outshine us!
>
> These boys really do think they are a level above us in all fields both on and off the course. We proved them wrong in 2010, and we shall do so again.
>
> Looking forward to it.
>
> Hursty"

The pairings were as follows:

BT & Boysie

Hursty & Harbo

Ash & Knoxy

Little & Buzz

Worplesdon Action

Quizzical Little

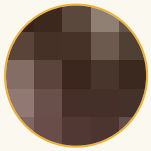
Thumbs Up Buzz

Ash with his TISSI Mates!

Once again, the Big Dogs TOOK THEM DOWN! This despite an inauspicious start from Hursty who hit one of the all-time greatest opening gambits!

▶ **Watch:** Monkey Top!

A post match email from Hursty shows that the BDT won by 8.5 points to TISSI's 3.5 points:



HURSTY

"Another resounding victory, with 2 points for Buzz and Boysie and 1.5 points for Knoxy. I am pleased to report that Neilan, Clarkson and Hurst were last to be seen in Maddox at 4am. Not a TISSI in sight. Comprehensive victory once again. The highlight so far was when our opposition found out Knoxy's handicap at 37! Also, Buzz could be dangerous on BDT 2014!"

The TISSI lads' chat can be seen in some post-match emails as below:

"TISSI / Mini (Flea Bitten) Poodles,

A superbly social evening, indeed...well done to RT for his organisational skills sorting the pub venue etc, Hursty for his warm up act as chairman, Ashley for his "super lawyer" expertise available via BlackBerry to clients throughout the evening, moreover to DS and DF (aka Kim Jong Un) for running the main part of the evening with a great fines and 21s circle - v funny.

Vague memories of.....to my left; 1 2 TISSI losers, tiny poodles, woof, ITWT, 7, 8, 9 woof, bloodhounds, 12, 13, 14, woof...then it all gets slightly blurred.... (corrections may be required).

It's fair to say if it was possible to combine the Poodles v impressive golf performances, loyal values, team spirit and (bandit territory) handicaps, with our superiority in boozing / 21s game play, overall dress code and youthful looks...Carlsberg and the world over would witness a seriously potent tour group!

Maybe sort a rematch (ie. USA trip) within 2 years, or for those keen on another mixer a little sooner - Bunga Bunga tonight: maybe see you in there! KIS*

RB *Keep It Social."

"Chaps,

Well played to the Big Dogs, good golf as always and a very sociable day all round.

Big thanks to JH for arranging Worplesdon and I certainly can't take any responsibility for the pub - JH again. Brilliant set up. Sterling job from DS sorting post meal activities.

I would certainly support a yearly match, the week before the first major might be great timing. I'd personally prefer to play the comp over two rounds and with enough notice I'm sure it could be arranged pretty efficiently.

I'll look forward to the Big Dogs match report...and RB's match report. Fairly sure one will be significantly longer than the other!

Cheers,

RT"

"Echo all of this. Great day, great night, and thanks to all.

We, again, were owned on the course, though reclaimed some credibility in the post-golf activities.

I can only assume internal disciplinary proceedings will ensue at BDT HQ; the episode in which said poodle refused to do a number of fines, before three TISSI members stepped up to consume 1x IPA (CS), 2x tumblers of red wine (JC), 1x Guinness (RB) was telling.

(Said poodle knows who he is, and I'll save further public embarrassment... I'm sure this can be dealt with in Marbella on a charge of bringing the tour into disrepute).

JC x"

"Said poodle" was Little, of course!

The Victorious Big Dogs!

Thankfully Ash's TISSI chat has largely disappeared these days and he seems to have come to his senses in realising that there really is only one tour that matters, as evidenced by this video footage from Celtic Manor. Let's hope the TISSI tourists never chance upon this....!!

▶ **Watch:** The TISSI Tour is nothing compared to this!!

Brian

19

BDT 2015 · Malmö · Featuring Boysie & Jules

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

It was Day II of BDT 2015 and the Dogs had finished Round I at PGA National of Sweden in Malmö. We had two virgins in our ranks in Rufus and Jules and were enjoying postmatch drinks and dinner in Hawaiians at the rather swanky clubhouse (where Langers had earlier disgraced himself by falling asleep on their front lawn in full view of all arrivals!). Jules had bagged himself the Shitzu Shirt after a disappointing opening round.

PGA National Clubhouse – The site of "Brian!"

The Monkey was in full flow and with a tap-tap-tap of his glass he rolled out one of his favourite "testers" for our new-joiners:

HURSTY

"Right, Virgins, you've met everyone now and had plenty of time to get to know everyone – please go around the table and tell us everyone's first name....and it's drink while you think!".

I waited with bated breath, not least because on my stag do several years earlier I had witnessed Hursty drop this game on my brother-in-law Mark, who was at least 15 years older than the rest of us and barely knew anyone on the trip! Poor Mark was in bed an hour later after being reminded by "zero-tolerance James" that "Ash" was actually "Simon" and "David" was actually "John" – and those were the lads whose names he thought he knew!

Nice balancing from Jules

Jules went first and was actually doing pretty well until he got to Boysie. At this point there was a long pause with Jules being constantly reminded by James to keep drinking whilst he was thinking! He was clearly struggling and the anticipation was growing amongst the Dogs!

Then we saw a moment of inspiration cross his face, the glass came down from his lips and he announced confidently:

JULES

"I've got it – BRIAN!" (pointing firmly at Greg for extra emphasis).

Simply priceless. The issue we now had to work out was whether to call Greg "Brian" or "Barnabus"!

There was only one thing left for Jules to do – get a round in!

Steve

18

BDT 2008 · Lisbon · Featuring Marshy & Buzz

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Whilst occasionally they are somewhat painful and a necessary evil, coach journeys on tour have also often provided us with much amusement, particularly when there is plenty of wind in our sails. One such occasion was the coach journey back from Penha Longa Atlantic, after Round II of BDT 2008.

The Buzz Driver was Bloodhound Captain and had taken his usual seat up front so we asked his fellow Captain Marshy to do likewise, with a view to announcing the draw for the Round III Singles.

Marshy had been particularly obsessed with all things "Steve" on this tour and this had seeped into the rest of the group to the point where everyone seemed to be calling each other Steve relentlessly! When it came to announcing their Singles order for Round III what followed from the Captains was hugely confusing and entertaining in equal measure as each Bloodhound found he would be "playing....."Steve"", apart from Little who, in a nod to Trigger from Only Fools & Horses, had been drawn to play "Dave".

Each time the microphone was passed back to Big Buzz we had a lively chorus of "The Wheels on the Buzz" for good measure! The footage speaks for itself!

▶ **Watch:** Will Be Playing.....!"

Of course, we have a real-life Steve joining us on tour this year which has Marshy excited beyond belief! Welcome on board to Mr Darley!

The Wheels on the Buzz continues to be a favourite tour track as evidenced by this video of Robbo and The Big Man making their way to the airport for BDT 2019 to Cyprus!

▶ **Watch:** The Wheels On The Buzz!

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

Steve made his debut in Scottsdale.

STEVE

The "Bite & Swipe" Round

17

BDT 2011 · Miami · Featuring Ravo, DT, BT & Robbo

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

When the Round II fourballs were announced on BDT 2011 one match in particular stood out for its potential aggression levels, DT & Ravo v BT & Robbo.

Bite & Swipe

Not much was seen of the group during the course of the round, but it became apparent that something out of the ordinary was happening with this fourball when the first three groups had been sitting at the bar for about 45 minutes with no sign of them on the horizon! Particularly as Buzz wasn't playing in that group!

Looking at the pictures and video below, no further commentary is required.....

"Bite and Swipe" entered the tour lexicon and after John Daly's cousin called the Dogs 'Crazy Mother Fu##ers' for their on-course antics, not least Ravo's mid-round dip (see the video!), what more could be said!

That match ended up all square and to this day there is some doubt about the veracity of the scorecard handed in at the end of the round! There is no doubt, however, that this remains the most ridiculous fourball played on any BDT!

Crazy Antics

Crazy

▶ **Watch:** The Bite & Swipe Round!

Sue Chief Spannered Barker

16

BDT 2012 · Marbella · Featuring Robbo, BT & Hursty

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Back in the days of the pre-tour Captains' Challenge we landed on an idea for the BDT 2012 pre-tour video: A Question of Dogs.

This involved the Taylor Bros as the opposing captains, Hursty as the audience and second cameraman and Robbo as the host, Sue "Chief" Barker, complete with dress, blonde wig and push-up bra. Filmed on location in BT's flat in Putney the obligatory bottle of Captain Morgan was produced. What could possibly go wrong?

As the afternoon progressed Hursty and I noticed that the Morgan was disappearing at a rate of knots, with Robbo seeming to be getting more stuck in than the Captains! It became increasingly challenging to get him to stick to the script as it came to a point where he could barely read it or speak coherently!

Things got so bad that we decided Sue needed replacing for the final scenes, so Hursty stepped into the breach. This culminated in a memorable final scene when Robbo reappeared after an extended toilet break with his truncheon on full display! Truly extraordinary scenes.

Again, one for the WhatsApp group only!

The 2012 Singles

15

BDT 2012 · Marbella · Featuring Boysie, Robbo & Buzz

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

On BDT 2012 we had our one and (fingers crossed for the future) so far only washed-out round of golf, the third round of BDT 2012. We made a start to the round but no group made it past the 9th hole before we were called in from what were appalling conditions!

We decided to hand out the individual trophies based on the Round II standings, but we decided it would not be right to conclude the Ryder Cup in the same way, with the Retrievers 5-3 in the lead but the Bloodhounds fighting hard in the Singles.

The idea began to germinate that we could replay the Singles in the UK and so, after consultation with the Committee, I wrote the following email on 1 June 2012 to set the "2012 Singles" in motion!

PADDY

"Dogs,

You will be aware that the 2012 BDT ended in a slightly unsatisfactory fashion, in that we were unable to finish the third round singles and thus confirm whose name should go on the coveted Big Dogs Ryder Cup.

I have been giving some thought to how we might resolve this and the Committee has approved a proposal; we now need your assistance to implement this.

The idea is that we have a Bloodhound v Retriever "home" based set of single matches.

Counting Gav as a Retriever, there have been 12 Retrievers and 12 Bloodhounds over the life of the Big Dogs Tour and so we would hold the following 12 matches over the remainder of this calendar year, preferably as soon as possible over the summer months.

BLOODHOUND (HANDICAP)	RETRIEVER (HANDICAP)
DT (c) (0)	BT (c) (2)
Boysie (27)	Robbo (18)
Ash (12)	Marshy (12) or AN Other Retriever
Ravo (19)	Hursty (20)
Boggy (16)	Oli Gregory (16)
Buzz (18)	Picko (23)
Langers No Wangers (13)	Paddy (24)
Langrish (28)	Knoxy (37)
Tyzzer (11)	Coxy (21)

LITTLE (8)	FRED (6)
Charlie (27)	Gav (21)
Purlo (9)	Ollie Gobat (8)

The following rules would apply:

- The score after DAY II on BDT 2012 was 5-3 to the Retrievers but, since the Bloodhounds were up in a number of the singles matches, the only fair way to proceed is to disregard the points previously earned during BDT 2012. So we are starting at 0- 0.
- If the scores are tied 6-6, then the Bloodhounds will retain the BDT Ryder Cup for 2012.
- BT and DT will still be the captains and will be encouraging you to arrange your matches asap.
- The matches have been arranged mostly on a north/south geographical basis to provide the best opportunity for them to be played.
- Tour handicaps will apply. We have also tried to be fair with the match-ups in terms of handicaps.
- Dogs who are a member of a club should not play on that course unless their opponent specifically agrees.
- Dogs are free to set up their matches as part of a fourball (and smash it up the previous evening) in order to replicate tour conditions as far as possible!
- Because the matches are not being played under full tour conditions, the individual records and stats will not be updated as a result of these matches; the matches are to be used purely for one purpose - to decide whose name goes on the BD Ryder Cup.
- As the match results roll in, each result will be announced via the website. There may be videolinks to certain match results; for instance, the Dubai face-off between Chaaarles and Gav!

If the concept is successful, we may roll out a UK-based big dog knockout comp in future years, with north and south regional champs playing each other in a home final, to keep the interest going during each year between tours.

Hopefully, the matches will be close and the overall result will come down to the last couple of games; as well as giving us a result for the 2012 BDT, this should keep the BDT alive during the course of the year, involve all 24 Dogs who have toured (with the possible exception of Marshy) and provide a great opportunity for some banter over the coming months so let's all use every effort to make this happen. So get in touch with your oppo, get the banter going and get it on!

Cheers all - have a great long weekend."

3 June 2012 - Ravo vs Hursty

Kinsale Dog Spot!

Old Head!

▶ **Watch:** Ravo vs Hursty Preview!

▶ **Watch:** Ravo vs Hursty – The Result!

RAVO

"First rearranged singles match won 3&2 at the Old Head of Kinsale. Bloodhound victory, Big Ass beat the Monkey.

Whoop whoop!!!"

Ravo In Trouble!

BT

"The shot of the day was a very interesting close call....Ravo's complete fresh air from the middle of the 8th fairway just edged Hursty's tee shot on 12 when he just made contact with the ball and hit himself on the left foot."

HURSTY

"Too much sleep and not enough beer!"

HURSTY

"Ravo is on the ropes!"

16 August 2012 - BT vs DT

The Home Of Golf!

"Chaps,

Two matches down in the Singles contest and it brings me no pleasure at all to confirm that the 2012 Bloodhound Captain, DT, beat the 2012 Retriever Captain, BT, 3&2 at the home of golf, St Andrew's, to make it 2-0 to the Bloodhounds.

10 matches to go - get your dates in the diary."

The Swilcan Bridge!

3 September 2012 - Langers vs Paddy & Little vs Fred

Goring & Streatley GC!

PADDY

"Two more BDT 2012 Singles matches took place yesterday at Goring & Streatley GC.

I am delighted to report two more match results, with me beating Langers 4&3 and Fred beating Little 2&1, meaning two Retriever points! The scores are now 2-2 overall.

Game on....."

11 November 2012 - Boggy vs Oli G & Langrish vs Knoxy

Studley Wood GC!

PADDY

"In the perfect end to any week, I am delighted to report two more RETRIEVER points, following the latest two BDT 2012 singles matches held today between:

- Oli G & Boggy (3&2 to Oli); and
- in the Clash of the Titans, Knoxy & Langrish (1UP to Knoxy)!

We are now half way through the scheduled matches and Ash and BT are facing off this coming weekend (with BT stepping in for Marshy – bit of an ask for him to fly over from Oz for it).

The overall score is 4-2 to the Retrievers, with the Retrievers needing 6.5 points to regain the Ryder Cup from the Bloodhounds.

The remaining matches are:

Boysie v Robbo

Tyzzer v Coxy

Ash v BT

Buzz v Picko

Charlie v Gav

Purlo v Ollie Gobat"

6 January 2013 - Ash vs BT

"Evening All,

Another BDT 2012 Singles Match took place today.

Ashley Hurst for the Bloodhounds v Brendan Taylor for the Retrievers.

The result can be seen in the video below...."

▶ **Watch:** Ash vs BT – The Result!

6 April 2013 - Charlie vs Gav

Greg Norman Jumeirah!

"Afternoon Dogs,

Our Dubai residents Gav and Charlie recently paired up for The Storm In The Desert as part of the ongoing BDT 2012 matches.

The match went down the 18th and Gav & Charlie announce the result in the video below."

▶ **Watch:** Charlie vs Gav – The Result!

> "Only 16 days to BDT 2013 now - further announcements to follow shortly."

DT

> "Good work that man. Bloodhounds as always showing their fighting spirit. Come on lads let get it WON!!"

24 April 2013 - Tyzzer vs Coxy

Pleasington GC!

> "Dogs,
>
> We are down to the last match!
>
> Yesterday Tyzzer beat Coxy 3&2 at Pleasington GC, making the overall score after nine matches played as 5-4 to the Retrievers. It's been a cracking effort to get nine matches out of 12 played.

Two matches are not going to be played before BDT 2013: Ollie Gobat v Purlo and Picko v Buzz.

The Committee has agreed that each of the matches will be deemed as halves, making the overall score 6-5 to the Retrievers.

This means that we are all down to the tenth, and last, match, between Robbo & Boysie.

The situation couldn't be clearer.

If Robbo wins or halves, the 2012 BDT Ryder Cup belongs to the Retrievers.

If Boysie wins, the Bloodhounds take it.

No better way to finish off last year's tour than a match between two inaugural tourists!

Rarely has so much rested on one match between Dogs and could the result have a knockon effect on morale for BDT 2013??!!

May the best Dog win...."

ASH

"Great work Tyzzer! Wouldn't want to be Robbo facing a 5ft yip to win the Ryder Cup! A very unlikely Bloodhound victory could be on the cards..."

BOYSIE

"Robbo and I looking at Sunday. Just debating whether it should be pitch and putt in Blackpool or crazy golf in Lytham."

ASH

"I'd like to see Robbo playing yip and putt in Blackpool! Can you handle this pressure Robbo?"

LANGERS

"Bring it home Boysie and then let's celebrate in front of some deflated Retrievers on Wednesday...."

HURSTY

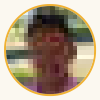
"Don't let Boysie beat u Robbo."

ASH

"It will be an incredible Bloodhounds victory if we pull this off."

PADDY

"Boysie any chance you could consider doing the right thing and offering to lose a few shots, given your ridiculous handicap?"


BOYSIE

"Lovely invitation Paddy, but that won't be happening. Roberts spent three weeks on holiday doing nothing other than golfing added onto his 6 month sabbatical where he has been on the course every day. I reckon mine should go up. Can we agree I should be off 36?

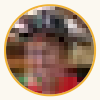
As ever the Bloodhounds go into the final match and this year's tour as huge underdogs. Some odds BT – should start at 20-1 even in a two horse race."

HURSTY

"Come on Jurgen.

Cast your mind back to 18 in Mallorca when you became the first man to retain the Green Jacket. Crowd watching and you stiffed it to 3 feet.

Caman!"


RAVO

"Nice one Tyzzer, come on Boysie.

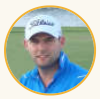
When are they playing? Please could we have a hole by hole commentary?"

HURSTY

"That is a must!"

PADDY

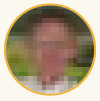
"Buzz, as you missed your match, no better man for the job?! Email updates post every hole?"


KNOXY

"Venue, date and time???

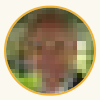
Robbo it is not often that I win a point on tour outside of playing Ash, so you can appreciate my eagerness to see you wipe the floor with Boysie!

Bring it!"


DT

"Well done Tyzzer great work buddy. Once again though I feel the very Retriever heavy committee have swayed the decision in their way as Bloodhounds were odds on favourites in the last of the 3 matches to be played. Either way I am sure Boysie will take "Double Hit Dumbo" down and we will rightfully win the Ryder Cup.

Look forward to seeing you all next week."


BT

"Good to see DT has lost not any of his 'bite'"

BT

"Cometh the hour cometh the pin ball wizard!

Without his gimmes (Inaugural Tour) surely Barney will crumble under the pressure...

Running commentary and a beer per hole please chaps"

RAVO

“….. Equally good to see BT has not lost his grasp of written English?”

28 April 2013 - Boysie vs Robbo

BUZZ

“THE DECIDER - Boysie (27) v. Robbo (18) - Wilpshire GC 16.30 (GMT)

Dogs

Tune in for live updates tomorrow from 4.30 pm! To change channel let me know ASAP.

Cheers

Buzz”

BT

“Great work big man. Come on Robbo… bring it home son”

HURSTY

“Are you intending to play as well Buzz as I'm not sure there would be enough daylight hours if you did!”

BUZZ

“Ha ha. Very original!

I’m intending on focusing on commentating!…”

BUZZ

“16.33 Welcome to a wet Wilpshire Golf Club located in the Ribble Valley for what promises to be an enthralling afternoon of golf.

The Bloodhounds 'Boysie' aka Gregory 'Barnabus' Gardner Boyes takes on the Retrievers 'Robbo' aka Nicholas 'Double Hit Dumbo' Roberts in a fitting decider between two inaugural tourists.

The match is the culmination of a 12 month long duel between competing packs from locations around the world including Ireland, Dubai and numerous locations in the UK including the home of golf St Andrews. The score is currently 6 - 5 to the Retrievers meaning that save for a half, it's winner takes all.

This 5,843 yard, par 69, course is not long by modern standards but it will prove a tough test for both competing dogs.

The combination of parkland and moorland with the threat of challenging rough, gorse and a few water hazards is expected to make this an interesting battle particularly if the opponents let their Big Dogs too far off their leash!!

Woof Woof! Let battle commence….”

Face Off!

BT

“BT Come on the Retrievers.”

ASH

"16.37 - Strapped in and ready for the ride! Hope Monty isn't co-commentating...

I can almost hear Robbo's bum squeaking from here."

BUZZ

"16.38 - Robbo wins the coin toss and elects to let Boysie tee off first.

Hole 1 - 304 yards - Par 4

The first requires only a modest drive up to the marker post. A 3 wood or long iron will leave a short iron to the green.

As the fairway turns left to right, anything too long or pulled left will likely reach the rough leaving a tough 2nd most likely being blind. Anything played to the right will likely be blocked out by the copse of fir trees.

The front bunker, usually grabs any attempt to run the ball on and anything long will be caught by the ditch!"

BUZZ

"16.43 - After a push and a pull respectively and good recoveries Boysie is on in 3 and Robbo 2."

BUZZ

"16.45 - After two 3 putts Robbo goes 1 up!"

BUZZ

"16.48 - Hole 2 - 427 yards - Par 4

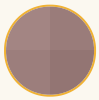
A par 4 demanding a good long drive at the marker post, anything right will drift down the slope towards the rough and trees, leaving a long second shot. The green slopes to the front, and anything above the pin is in 3 put country."

COXY

"16.57 - Good start Mr Roberts."

FRED

"17.01 - Solid. Line them up and down Robbo dog."


BUZZ

"17.04 - Very reminiscent of Marbella last year, standing water and slow play in front. Good."

BUZZ

"17.14 - Robbo topped drive and a couple of decent irons sees his ball roll back off the front of the green. Boysie on the other hand 3 wood semi shank, 3 iron Sally and another followed by a chip stiff to 2 ft."

BUZZ

"17.15 - Robbo 2 putt gives Boysie the hole.

All square."

BUZZ

"17.15 - Hole 3 – 397 yards - Par 4

A straightforward but longish par 4. There is room to open your shoulders and leave yourself a medium/short iron to a large receptive green"

Boysie searching

BUZZ

"17.17 - Boysie in trouble off the tee, Robbo down the middle."

BUZZ

"17.18 - Robbo 8 iron stiff for a par to go 1 up."

BUZZ

"17.19 - Hole 4 - 337 yards - Par 4

The marker post is your line, and a long iron or 3 wood leaves a short iron. Anything short will find the stream across the front of the green"

BUZZ

"17.32 - Robbo chipping out after a wayward rescue. Boysie down the middle."

Robbo chipping out

BUZZ

"17.38 - Boysie finds the water but scrambles a half in 5. Robbo remains 1 up"

BUZZ

"17.41 - Hole 5 - 160 yards - Par 3

The 5th hole

A tough uphill par 3 to an elevated green across the valley. OB on the left and rough ground on either side of the green will penalise the wayward tee shot. Very tough hole to accurately club with around 30/40 yards of elevation."

BUZZ

"17.43 - After several knobs and Robbo sticking it at the back on the green, hole conceded. Robbo 2 up."

FRED

“17.43 - Team effort Robbo. We all behind you. Great win that hole. Give nothing.”

BUZZ

“17.45 - Hole 6 - 308 yards - Par 4

A deceptively tough short par 4 which doglegs left to an elevated Mackenzie green surrounded by bunkers. Even a drive up the left will likely see the ball run to the right due to a steep left to right incline leaving the ball well below your feet for your 2nd”

OLI G

“17.45 - Well done Robbo, turn the screw.”

BUZZ

“17.46 - Tough with today's wind. Both just off the edge in 3.”

BUZZ

“17.49 - Robbo 3 putts and concedes. Back to 1 up”

BUZZ

“17.50 - Hole 7 - 313 yards - Par 4

A long dogleg to the left. A good drive to the right of the bunker with a touch of draw, leaves you in prime position to attack the pin.”

BUZZ

“17.50 - 2 superb drives. Robbo plays a safe lob to the back of the green, Boysie a decent 3 iron and then a fat wedge to the front. Boysie with a shot. All to play for. As they are...”

BUZZ

“17.58 - Should have been Robbo's hole but a 2 1/2 ft'r slid past means halved in 5. Robbo 1 up.”

HURSTY

“18.03 - Sounds tense!”

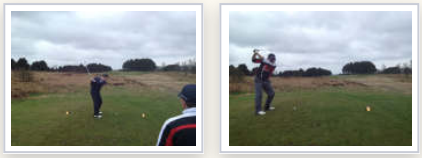
FRED

“18.03 - Robbo. It's make or break time. Hit him with all you got. Don't look back”

BUZZ

"18.05 - Hole 8 - 162 yards - Par 3

A short iron to this slightly elevated green which is heavily bunkered, demands accuracy. A miss either side will mean a tough up and down!"



The 8th

BUZZ

"18.07 - Robbo blocks his right, Boysie front edge. Robbo superb recovery to 10 ft. Boysie ladies his to 8 ft. As they lie."

BUZZ

"18.07 - Lip out by Robbo. Halved in 4."

LANGERS

"1812 - Great neutral commentating Buzz, would hate to think what underhand tactics would be in play if a Retriever was in your position...."

The boys on the 9th tee

BUZZ

"18.14 - Hole 9 - 518 yards - Par 5"

"The first par five is downhill all the way. Not too much trouble here but beware the ditch just short of the green."

BUZZ

"18.14 - Solid. Long, long hole into the wind today."

BUZZ

"18.24 - 6 for 5 for Robbo to take the hole. Robbo 2 up."

BUZZ

"18.25 - Hole 10 - 529 yards - Par 5

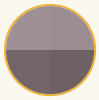
The 529 yard 10th, is a long stroke 1 hole all up hill. There is plenty of room to have a go off the tee, but it narrows down nearer the green!"

BUZZ

"18.25 - 2 solid drives."

BUZZ

"18.42 - Both 4 to the front edge. Robbo gets his belly putter out (for use with long) and leaves it 15 ft short then changes to his short putter and drains it to go 3 up. 2 putters in the bag...interesting."


PADDY

"18.43 - He can use 14 putters if he keeps producing the goods!"

BUZZ

"18.43 - Hole 11 - 194 yard - Par 3

A tricky par 3, downhill being very tough to club. The tee is sheltered and thus the wind can be deceptive."

BUZZ

"18.43 - Wind against today - rescue and a 3 wood. One left one right pin high."

COXY

"18.44 - Keep going Robbo. Nearly home."

BUZZ

"18.47 - Under pressure Boysie sticks it to 3 ft. Robbo duff. His third hits the pin and stops at 5 ft."

BUZZ

"18.48 - Robbo miss, Boysie 2 putt to win. Back to 2!"

BUZZ

"18.57 - Hole 12 - 371 yards - Par 4

A relatively straight forward par 4 proving an excellent opportunity to pick up a shot."

BUZZ

"18.57 - Boysie in play, Robbo OB. And again. 5 off the tee. Good."

HURSTY

"19.00 - Keep those wheels fastened on Robbo lad!!"

BUZZ

"19.00 - Robbo picks up following a fat and fluff. Back to 1."

BUZZ

"19.06 - Hole 13 - 256 yards - Par 4

A drivable short par 4, but a tight line and out of bounds to the left provide for a tough decision. A tricky 2 tier green make it crucial to find the correct level to avoid a 3 stab!"

BUZZ

"19.09 - 2 rescues pushed right but in play."

CHARLIE

“19.09 - Sounds like there a few twitching sphincters out there Ken...”

BUZZ

“19.12 - Boysie pin high just off, Robbo short.

Robbo chip to 6 ft and putt to 6. Down to the putter.”

BUZZ

“19.14 - Robbo slides it past. Boysie drains it. All Square...”

HURSTY

“19.15 - This is up there with Medinah!”

ASH

“19.22 - What do you mean 6 for 5 for Robbo? Robbo doesn't get any shots! You guys are clearly cheating by playing Stableford scores.”

BUZZ

“19.23 - No they weren't - my error. Typo.”

ASH

“19.25 - CAMAN BOYESIE!!!!!! This is epic. Buzz did you bring any spare wheels for Robbo?”

BUZZ

“19.26 - Hole 14 - 336 yards - Par 4

The 14th doglegs to the right and is up hill. If you try to cut the corner and don't get it right you may be best playing 3 off the tee! If you’re a puppy, take a long iron over the marker post and take an extra club or 2 to reach the green.”

BUZZ

“19.26 - Robbo tiger line needing half a wedge in, Boysie 6 to a similar position.

Long putter out for Robbo.

As they lie.”

BUZZ

“19.27 - Boysie leaves it short. Robbo for the half. Robbo changes to his short putter!!!”

BUZZ

“19.29 - And slides it by. Boysie 1 up!!”

OLI G

"19.34 - I have faith in Robbo. Stay focused."

BUZZ

"19.36 - Hole 15 - 189 yards - Par 3

On the short 15th an elevated tee over a reservoir. The water shouldn't come into play unless you knob it!"

The 15th

BUZZ

"19.36 - Quick chat with Robbo. 'I'm hungry and could do with a quench...!'

Boysie dead off the tee. Robbo just off left edge. Could be going back all square."

BUZZ

"19.42 - Boysie finds his but knobs it and Robbo knifes it through the front.

Boysie to 5 ft in 4 and Robbo to 5 ft in 3."

BUZZ

"19.44 - All Square with 3 to play."

BUZZ

"19.45 - Hole 16 - 386 yards - Par 4

At 16 you are back in the parkland. A long drive on the right of the fairway will open up the green. If your drive is short or left, play safe and keep to the short stuff."

LANGRISH

"19.46 - Come on BOYESIE!! Stay focused Roomie, you can do this."

HURSTY

"19.47 - Buzz. Can we please have some comments from the lads as they enter the final furlong?"

BUZZ

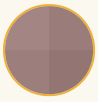
"19.48 - Both down the middle. No sign of mind games yet!!"

COXY

"19.53 - Come on Robbo"

BUZZ

“19.56 - Robbo hits yet another flag unfortunately at 90 miles an hour with direction unknown at the moment.”


BUZZ

“20.00 - In the water.

Boysie on in 4, Robbo short in 5 with penalty.”

BUZZ

“20.01 - Boysie 1 up. 2 to play. No more shots.”

OLI G

“20.03 - Email's been down - ridiculous, gonna have some serious words tomorrow!!

Come on The Retrievers, the Retrievers...”

BUZZ

“20.08 - From Boysie's phone. Change in broadcaster, due to dead phone!

Boysie 1 up, 2 to play.”

BUZZ

“20.08 - Par 3 over water. Both well right of 17th. Robbo on 2nd fairway. Game on.”

HURSTY

“20.12 - Have u reverted to playing with lump balls?”

BUZZ

“20.13 - Robbo fat, Boysie bit of a sally. Just off. Putter out for Robbo. Amazing shot to 6 ft. Boysie to 2 ft.”

BUZZ

“20.15 - Robbo has a 6 ft putt to take it down the 18th. He's giving it a good old read...”

BUZZ

“20.19 - It slides past.....

Boysie wins 2&1.”

LANGERS

“Boysie u LEGEND!!!!!”

HURSTY

“Well done Boysie. Tied match a fair result in the end. Onto the next on Thursday!”

ASH

“Shame it didn't go down the 18 but brilliant game lads and sterling stuff Ken! We've been riveted for 4 hours. Awesome come back Boysie.”

BT

“Fair play Barney. Well done. Congrats to the Bloodhounds. Good job it’s not long before we get a pop at revenge.

Bring on Marbella 2013.”

PADDY

“Great game boys! Unlucky Robbo and well done Barnabus.”

DT

“Quality Boysie you little beauty. Well done mate and hard luck Robbo.

Great come back by the Bloodhounds to claim victory.

Bring on Wednesday lads.”

COXY

“Well played Boysie.

Unlucky Robbo.

Bring on Wednesday.

Can't wait.”

LANGRISH

“ROOMIE!!!! Great win. Well played Robbo. Thanks both, and Buzz, for one of the most entertaining Sundays in a long time.

See you all in 3 days.”

BOYSIE

“He who barks last...

Well done to Robbo. A good scrap which was just edged.

Bring on BDT 2013.”

BOGGY

“Just read about 125 emails on the bounce catching up on this afternoon/evening's events. Extraordinary scenes!

Well done Boysie. Incredible comeback. Commiserations Robbo and the Retrievers. 3 in a row for the Bloodhounds now. That's the first BDT hat-trick! Caman!!!

DT, get that trophy engraved before Weds, as the Monkey will be itching to fine you if it's not done.

Roll on Marbella. After today's drama on the course, I'm more pumped up than Arnie's guns!!”

RAVO

“Arise Sir Gregory Gardner Poulter Boyes.

All is quiet from those lapdog Labradors!”

So the 2012 Singles proved dramatic with the results see-sawing one way and then the other before the Bloodhounds battled back to half the results overall and retain the Big Dogs Ryder Cup for 2012!

Big Dogs Ryder Cup – Marbella 2012 Home Round - Replacement Matches Dates & Venues Confirmed Below Retrievers Led 5-3 Ater Day II Singles Matches Held To Decide The Overall Outcome Match Tied 6-6 Bloodhounds Retain The Big Dogs Ryder Cup!				
Bloodhounds			**Retrievers**	
Won 3&2	Ravo	Old Head Kinsale v 3 June 2012	Hursty	
Won 3&2	DT(c)	St Andrews v 13 July 2012	BT(c)	
	Little	Goring & Streatley v 2 September 2012	Fred	**Won 2&1**
	Langers	Goring & Streatley v 2 September 2012	Paddy	**Won 4&3**
	Boggy	Studley Wood v 11 November 2012	Oli Gregory	**Won 3&2**
	Langrish	Studley Wood v 11 November 2012	Knoxy	**Won 1UP**
	Ash	Worplesdon v 6 January 2013	BT	**Won 2&1**
Won 1UP	Charlie	Greg Norman Jumeirah v 6 April 2013	Gav	
Won 3&2	Tyzzer	Pleasington v 24 April 2013	Coxy	
Won 2&1	Boysie	Wilpshire v 30 April 2013	Robbo	
A/S	Buzz	Did not play v Half awarded	Picko	**A/S**
A/S	Purlo	Did not play v Half awarded	Ollie Gobat	**A/S**
Match Score	**6**		**6**	**Match Score**

The Results!

Girona's First Tee

14

BDT 2010 · Girona · Featuring Hursty

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

The Dogs hit the first green on the Stadium course

In 2010 we headed to Girona and for Round II 16 steaming Dogs faced the daunting prospect of tackling the stellar golf course which had hosted the Spanish Open earlier that year and is the 2031 Ryder Cup track, the PGA Catalunya Stadium Course.

The Stadium Course

The course starter at the first tee was in a pretty grumpy mood, likely because we all still appeared to be half cut from the night before and were late for our tee time. BigBumDog was getting himself into a serious physical and mental sweat because he failed to show the starter his paper ticket and so, although we were already late, he had to traipse back to the clubhouse to get it.

After throwing the piece of paper at the starter on his return, he and we were ready to go and thought it would be best to send our best golfer up first, to get us away and prove to the starter that we belonged. Step up Knoxy, who proceeded to schmoke his drive all of 4 yards, barely dribbling off the front of the men's tee. The Big Dogs were falling about laughing and you could see the starter's fury growing.

Meanwhile, unbeknown to the rest of us, The Monkey had been up to some monkey business. As the Retrievers jumped in their buggy and drove away on the downhill path to the right of the tee, both sets of golf clubs tumbled backwards off the buggy crashing to the floor, with the straps securing them to their buggy having been mysteriously loosened! The starter was now losing the plot!

However, after the second group teed off and then their bags also went crashing to the floor as they drove off in their buggies, with the Monkey shouting out "NUMB-ER TWO!", it was very hard even for the starter to keep a cheeky wry smile off his face.

Sadly we didn't do the course much justice that day with only three of the Dogs surpassing 30 points and an average score of just 25 points!

Be Careful What You Say!

13

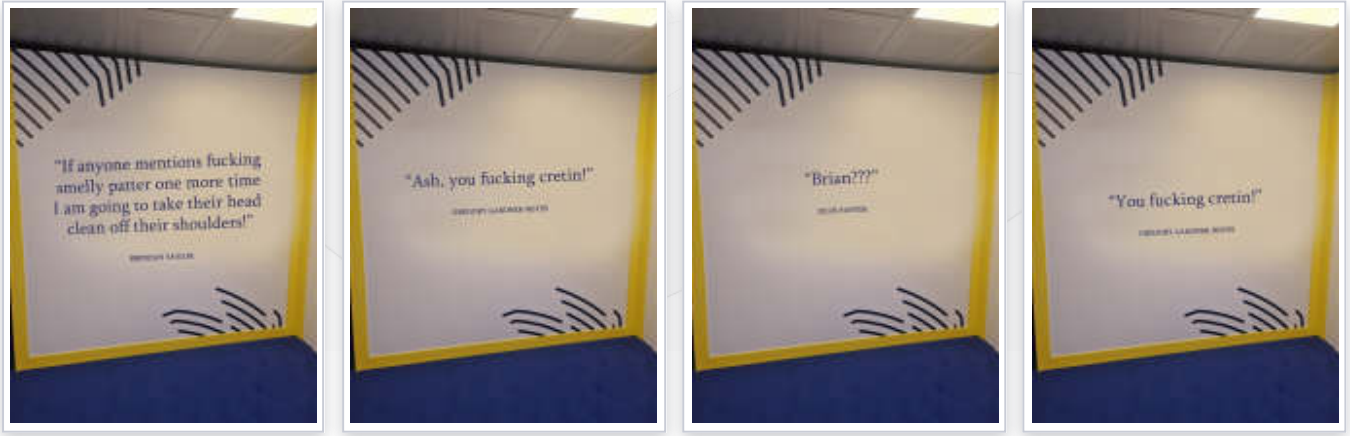
BDT 2023 · Turkey · Featuring BT

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

▶ **Watch:** Seve's Words In The European Locker Room

It was September 2023 and the "other" Ryder Cup was about to kick off in Rome. Our man on the inside, BT, was feeding us snippets to ramp up the excitement levels, including this video of the European locker room.

Seve's motivational wording inspired the tourists to come up with selected quotes of their own, some of the best of which are shown below! Be careful what you say in Scottsdale!



Watch What You Say

Captain Morgan

12

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

In the build-up to each tour between 2008 and 2013 we recorded a pre-tour DVD featuring the Captains alongside a third captain, good old Captain Morgan!

On each of these occasions the Captains were taken well and truly to the cleaners, in a couple of cases to quite alarming levels where hospitalisation was a serious consideration! As a result we decided to draw a line under this tradition, but it undoubtedly produced some amusing moments for our enjoyment.

Here are a few highlights!

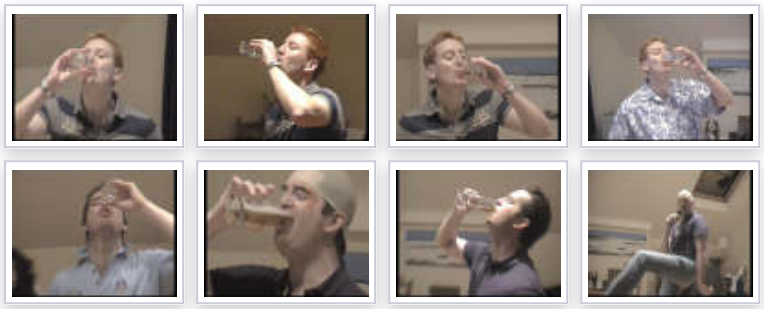
BDT 2009 - Ravo vs Picko

Copious down in ones led to an altercation between Boysie and Knowles Arms landlord Vinny, whilst Picko could not stop giggling for around two hours! Footage will be shared in Memory 10.

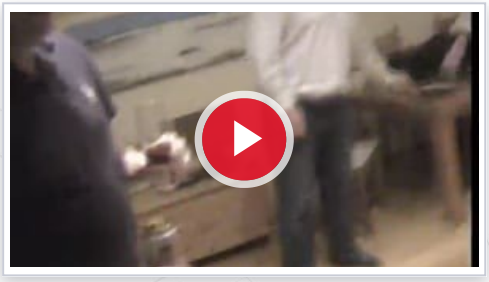
BDT 2009 Preview DVD!

BDT 2010 - The Rex Factor - Little vs Oli G

We have already seen Little's impression of Ravo and, alongside Oli G, they produced some very amusing moments, not least when Little realised the time and that he was several hours late, not to mention battered, for the dinner party he was heading to that evening!



BDT 2010 Preview DVD!



▶ **Watch:** Little Trying to Escape!

BDT 2011 - Who Wants To Be A Millionaire - Langrish vs Hursty

Langrish took down Hursty in the main event but subsequently suffered enormously to the point where we were advising a TC or hospital!

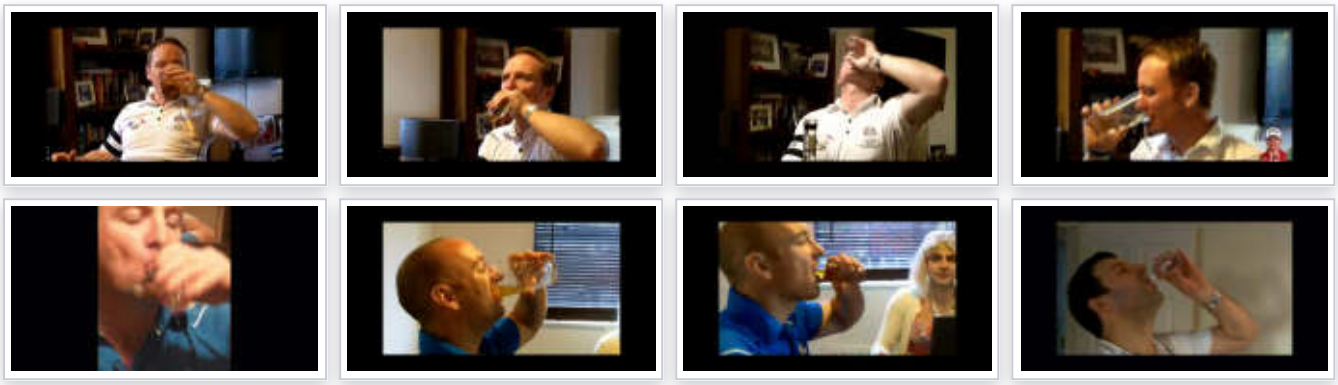
2011 Video Snaps

▶ **Watch:** First Question Wrong!

Both players made a terrible start by getting the simplest question wrong!

BDT 2012 - A Question of Dogs - DT vs BT

The only video where the tour organiser ended up way more smashed than the Captains! See Memory 16 for Sue Chief Barker's starring role.



2012 Video Snaps

BDT 2013 - SuperDogs - Langers vs Fred

Fred took down Langers during the day's events such that Langers was barely comprehensible in the evening and was ejected from a pub at 4pm! Outside said pub we then played the final game of the day – egg spoof!!

2013 Video Snaps

▶ **Watch:** BDT 2013 Preview DVD – SuperDogs!

Captain Morgan undoubtedly has a lot to answer for. Will he make an appearance in Scottsdale? Only time will tell!!

The Seve & Olly

11

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Hushed expectations descend on our group at three specific times every tour, namely those moments when the Captains come to announce their pairings for the following day's golf. The Round I pairings are perhaps the most anticipated as they come at the end of the OC when everyone is truly revved up to the max for the first day's golf; they are also the moment when the Captains first show their strategic hand.

Over the years we have seen differing reactions to the Round I pairings, ranging from some Dogs being fast asleep to others being overly excited – the excitement perhaps never better demonstrated than in this clip of the final pairings in advance of Round I of BDT 2019!

The Seve & Olly Award!

There have been some aggressive fourballs over time, maybe none more so than the "Bite & Swipe" crew of BT, DT, Hursty and Ravo who drank their bodyweight around the Great White course in Miami. Yet the fourball of Marshy, Hursty, Ravo and Langers on BDT 2022 would likely have given them a good run for their money!

▶ **Watch:** BDT 2019 Day I Pairings!

When it comes to Round II, the Captains have an element of form to go off which makes those pairings intriguing as everyone knows by this stage which Dogs it would be best to avoid. It is also the time when the Captains decide whether or not to roll the dice on a particular pairing and maybe even stick with a Round I pairing.

In fact, the same pairing has only gone out in Rounds I and II on relatively rare occasions and this statistic is somewhat skewed by Round II of BDT 2005. Here Captain Robbo of the Retrievers decided to roll out exactly the same four pairings he had used for Round I, simply reversing the order, flummoxing and irritating the Bloodhounds in equal measure which ultimately led to an 11-5 victory!

▶ **Watch:** The Drinking Fourball!

The Retrievers tried the same trick again on BDT 2008 but this time the Bloodhounds were better prepared and secured a convincing 10-6 victory.

Other repeat pairings on the same tour have been Paddy & Picko, who went out together in Rounds I and II of BDT 2004, whilst for the Bloodhounds DT & Buzz and Charlie & Boggy both paired together twice on BDT 2007.

On BDT 2008 there were several repeat pairings on both sides, with the Bloodhounds twice rolling out their pairs of DT & Buzz and Little & Langrish and the Retrievers putting out twice their combinations of Marshy & Knoxy and Robbo & Picko.

Most recently, just last year DT & Boysie went out first together for the Bloodhounds twice on BDT 2025, losing on both occasions.

Over the years a few "Hail Mary" pairings have been thrown out on the course and after securing a valuable half in Round I Knoxy & Adam T were paired twice on BDT 2017, only to lose in Round II. In a couple of the ultimate "Hail Mary" pairings, Rufus and Knoxy secured a half against Ash & Charlie, whilst Rufus & Adam T won 5&4 vs Charlie & Glenn on BDT 2024. Just last year another "Hail Mary" pairing in Adam T and Bean secured an absolutely crucial point for the Retrievers in the final match of Round II!

Some pairings have simply rolled off the tongue, such as "Coxy and Knoxy" on BDTs 2011 and 2012, or the "Two Ollie Gs" who played together on BDT 2012. With other pairings it has just seemed that they were simply destined to be together, like Brian & Ken.

Of course, the Bloodhounds have fielded numerous RANGA pairings together with varying degrees of success and, who knows, we may see some more RANGAs hitting the course together with a bucketload of sunscreen in their buggy to repel the Scottsdale heat.

The pair who has played the most times for the Bloodhounds is Ash & Charlie who have played together 10 times, securing 5.5 points, closely followed by Buzz & DT who have played eight and won four points.

For the Retrievers, Marshy & Knoxy have 2.5 points from their nine matches together, followed by Hursty & Oli G with 4.5 points from 8 matches.

Maybe the most anticipated pairing in tour history has been BT and Oli G, who led out the Retrievers for Round II of BDT 2013, but to everyone's surprise they succumbed to a 3&2 humbling at the hands of Charlie & Ravo, the only Bloodhounds to win a point for their team that day!

Pairings we may not see in Scottsdale are Boysie & Little for the Bloodhounds, who have secured precisely 0 points from their six matches together, whilst for the Retrievers only a brave captain would pair Paddy & Hursty who have 0 points from their four matches.

▶ **Watch:** BDT 2020 – The Chuckle Brothers Are Paired!

Only once have a pair of brothers been paired together, namely the Chuckle Brothers at The Belfry on BDT 2020 – see the footage below.

Clearly the Captains' selection of their fourballs is a crucial factor in their team's performance and so to honour and recognise the importance of a fourball performance, we introduced a new trophy on BDT 2019, the Seve & Olly, in honour of the greatest pairing in Ryder Cup history – 12 points from 15 matches is simply ridiculous!!!

Here are the winners of the Seve & Olly since its inception and each Captain will be hoping one of his pairings is added to the roster for BDT 2026.

BDT 2019 – Buzz & Langrish Beat Paddy & Robbo 1UP in Round I

BDT 2020 – Paddy & Robbo Beat Adam T & Buzz 6&5 in Round II

BDT 2021 – BT & Gav Beat Ash & Langers 3UP in Round II

BDT 2022 – Charlie & Ash Beat BT & Gav 4&3 in Round I

BDT 2023 – Knoxy & Rufus Halved With Ash & Charlie in Round I

BDT 2024 – Adam T & Rufus Beat Charlie & Glenn 5&4 in Round I

BDT 2025 – Adam T & Bean Beat Langers & Tom 2&1 in Round II

The main focus of this memory has been the Fourball pairings, but the Captains' order for the Singles is also a crucial factor. It has become something of an unwritten rule in recent years that the Taylor brothers, both playing off scratch, go out in Match I; but note that this is not a formal tour rule and so anything could happen in Scottsdale...

Captain Boyes on BDT 2015 and Captain Robbo on BDT 2005

History shows that the Singles draw is incredibly important in determining the final outcome of any tour; the same number of points is on offer for Round III as the combined points available over Rounds I and II and thus anything can happen if the draw falls correctly for your side.

Coming back to BDT 2026, we are already looking forward with much anticipation to the moment when Boysie and Robbo take to their feet to announce their Round I pairings at the end of the Opening Ceremony!!!

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

In the end Boysie had to withdraw before the tour, so Ash and Robbo captained in Scottsdale. Bean & Harbo won the 2026 Seve & Olly.

Bean & Harbo – The 2026 Seve & Olly Champs

Bouncing Barnabus

10

BDT 2009 · Vale do Lobo · Featuring Boysie, Ravo, Picko & Robbo

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

The pre-tour video for BDT 2009 starred the Captains, Ravo and Picko, may he Rest In Peace, with a guest appearance from Robbo. Actually Picko had to subsequently withdraw from that tour to be replaced as captain by Knoxy, but the video he left behind for us was pure gold. The theme was "Don't Cheat!" and featured a number of pieces of advice from Picko and Ravo on how to stay on the correct side of the BDT Rules.

Boysie's Up!

The Knowles Arms

Boysie was also a key member of the cast as he had taken on the Chief Barker responsibilities, meaning that for once he had no sitting duck to target with his acerbic emails regarding matters such as the APR accruing on tour cash whilst in the Dogs Trust account. After the stick he handed out to Ash before the Turkey / Lisbon debacle he also no doubt felt he had a point to prove on how to organise a proper BDT.

Footage was filmed on location at various venues around Blackburn, including Feniscowles GC, The Millstone in Mellor and, finally, the Knowles Arms. It was at the latter location where things got a little messy!

Over the course of the evening, all of us saw off numerous pints, particularly Brian, and at one stage Boysie had had to retire to the gents for a little bit of sick after necking a cold, fizzy lager. A little later on, it was Boysie's round and he headed to the bar. The rest of us didn't quite clock what was going on but subsequently it became apparent that some form of altercation had taken place with a lad queueing at the bar in a striped shirt…

Filming continued and we became increasingly raucous. The Knowles landlord, Vinny, who had already been somewhat disconcerted by the sight of a camcorder continuously rolling inside his manor, came over to us to try to settle things down and more particularly to ask Boysie if he wouldn't mind paying for the four pints he had just brought over to us. The footage is comical as a clearly bemused Vinny is polite enough to wait for Boysie to down one of said pints in front of him!

Initially there was some confusion, but when things all settled down Brian came out with the truly fantastic line – one of the all-time greats:

BOYSIE

"Vinny, if you could make that lad in the striped shirt bounce on his way out, I'd be enormously grateful"!

This was possibly Boysie's finest hour. Magic.

▶ **Watch:** Bouncing Barnabus!

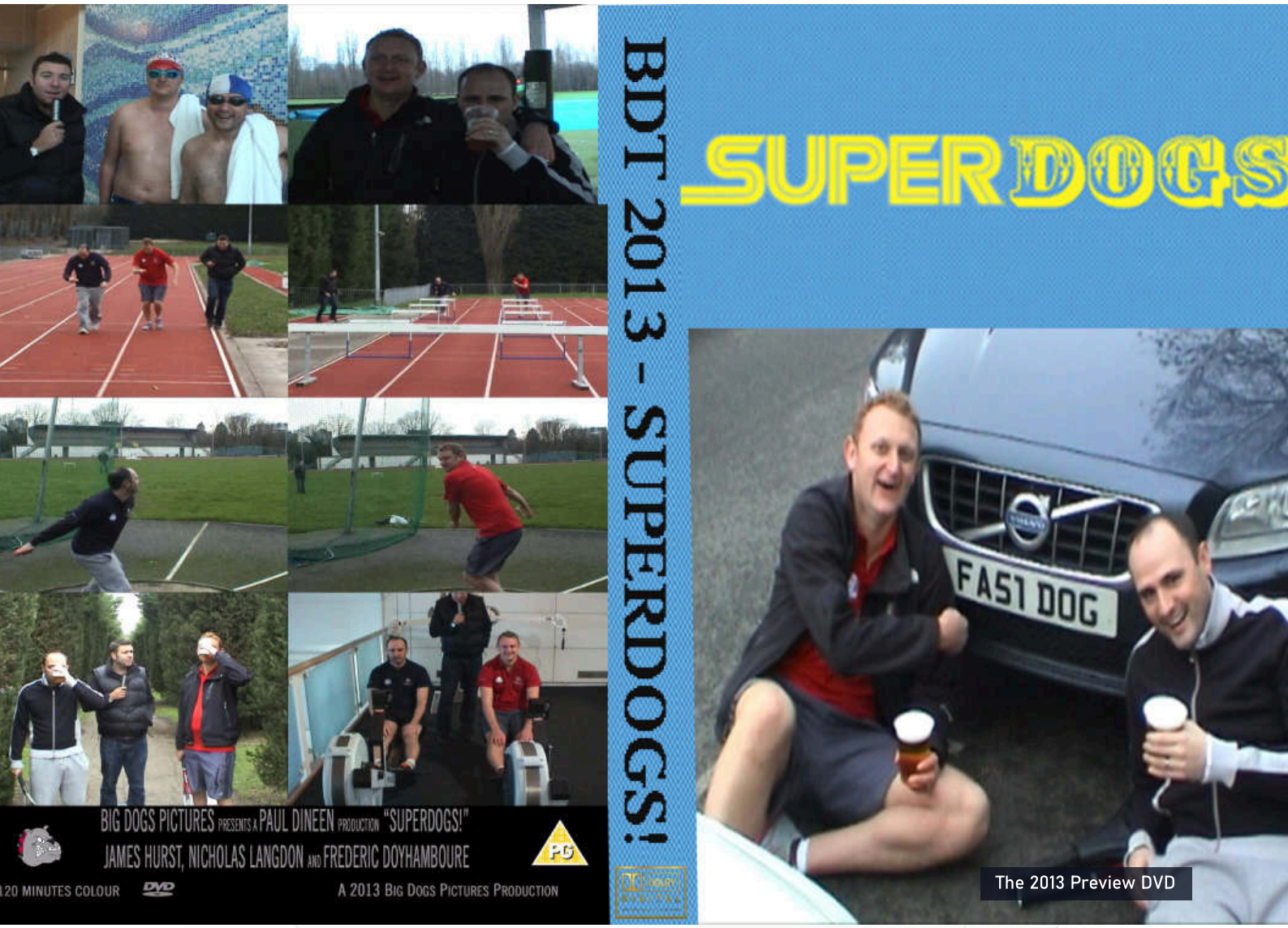
Boysie Bangs Them Back

Penalty Shoot-out

9

BDT 2013 · Marbella · Featuring Fred, Langers, Hursty & Tully

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale



The Captains Challenge before BDT 2013 was "Superdogs", pitting Bloodhound Captain Langers against Retriever Captain Fred in a sporting extravaganza which involved the Captains competing against each other at swimming, volleyball, long jump, climbing, egg and spoon race, hurdles, discus, rowing, tennis and finally a visit to the driving range.

The venues were mostly around Wimbledon and we had a guest spectator in Tully who would subsequently make his tour debut four years later!

Most memorable of all, however, was the "football" challenge, held at Plough Lane. By this stage of proceedings, both Dogs were pretty well oiled having seen off numerous beers in one plus most of the obligatory bottle of Captain Morgan!

Enthusiastic commentary and encouragement was provided by Hursty as the Dogs took on the challenge and the video speaks for itself!

▶ **Watch:** Superdogs – The Penalty Shoot-Out!

For those wanting to watch the whole video, try the link below. It makes for amusing viewing. Come 6pm that Saturday evening, Ash was not best pleased when we packed off Langers in a cab back to his flat unable to speak!

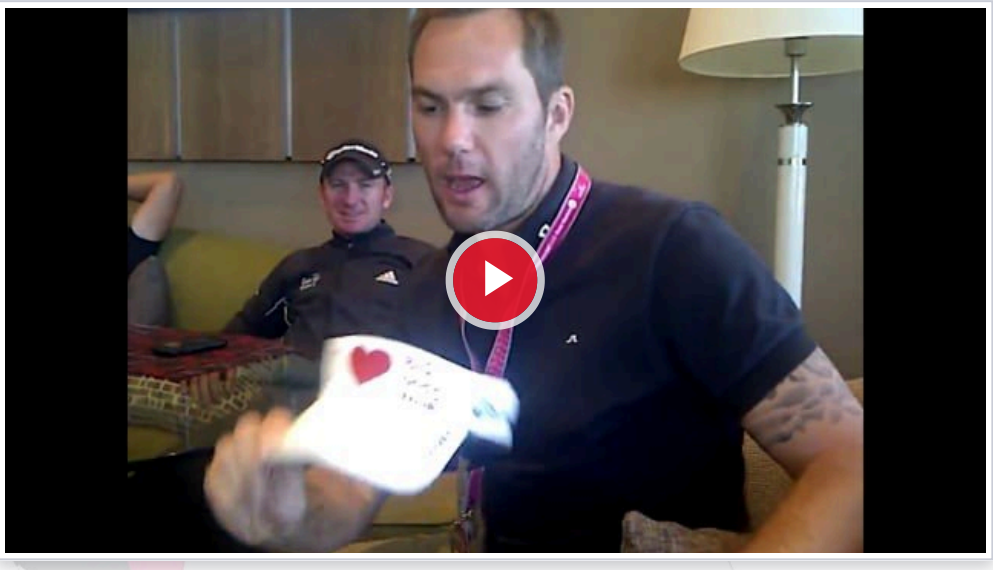
▶ **Watch:** Superdogs – The Full Video

Good Luck Lads

8

Across the tours · Featuring Ash

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale



▶ **Watch:** Celebs

As tour looms large, we are all looking for omens and best wishes for the trip to come. In fact, over the years we have received a number of good luck messages from Celebs, mainly via the Taylor Bros. Here's a selection of messages starring, amongst others, Donald Trump! Others to look out for include three Ryder Cup captains and some major winners along with a couple of extraordinary Jamie Donaldson ones!

Perhaps the most memorable message received, however, came in the aftermath of Ash's close shave on BDT 2022 from Jim Nantz.

The commentary speaks for itself!

▶ **Watch:** Jim Nantz!

Little's One-Armed Press-Up

7

BDT 2010 · Girona · Featuring Little & Ravo

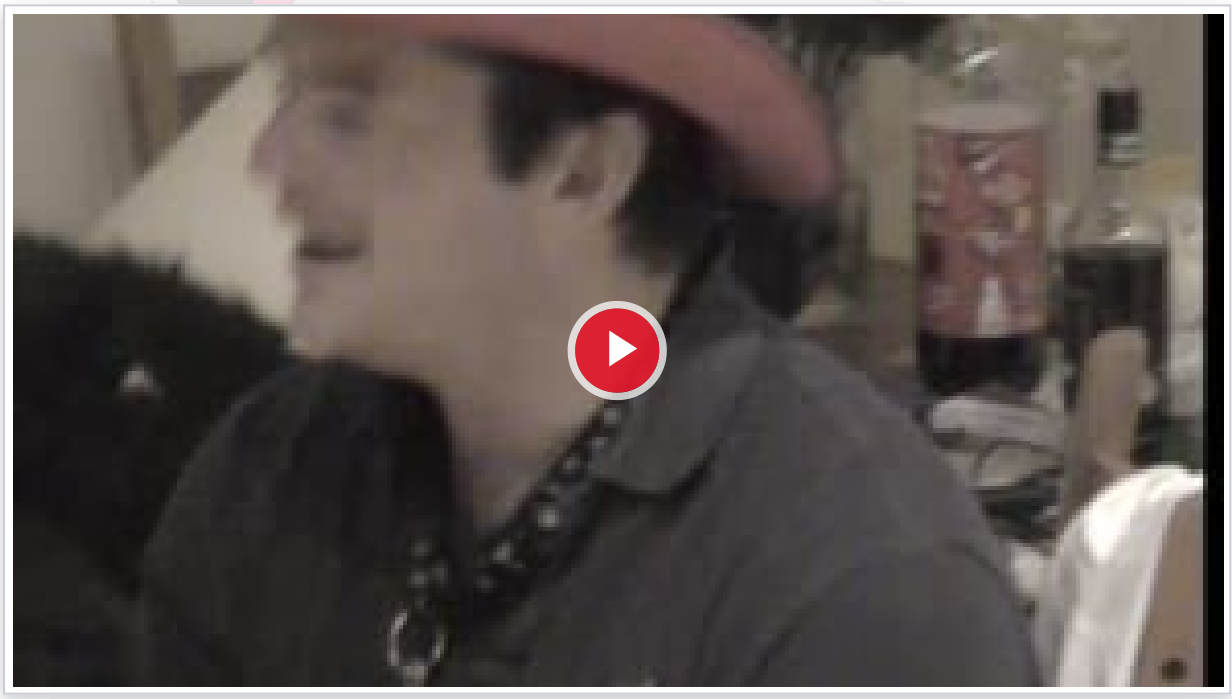
Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

The preview video for BDT 2010 was memorable for several reasons but perhaps the best moment came towards the end of the day's filming. To rewind a little, before filming commenced Ciaran had been keen to emphasise early on that he had a dinner party to attend that evening and was under strict orders not to turn up late or smashed. Sadly he failed miserably on both counts!

As the day progressed Little's aggression and confidence levels steadily rose in inverse proportion to the level of Captain Morgan left in the bottle. This resulted in the Ginger one attempting to demonstrate his manliness by volunteering for unnecessary aerobic exercises and constantly challenging Oli G to arm wrestles.

Later in the afternoon, as the reality of his impending dinner party began to loom large, Little began to refuse any more alcoholic fines from Ravo who therefore suggested that he should do 10 naked press-ups as a forfeit. Perhaps inspired by BT's regular party trick, Little confidently suggested that he should do them one-handed instead of two-handed and Ravo was not going to object to this offer!

Little hit the floor to prove his might; cue one of the greatest moments of any tour video!



▶ **Watch:** The One-Armed Press-Up!

The Ladies Tee

6

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

One of the tour's oldest traditions is that trousers must go down should you not make it beyond the Ladies' tee with your tee shot.

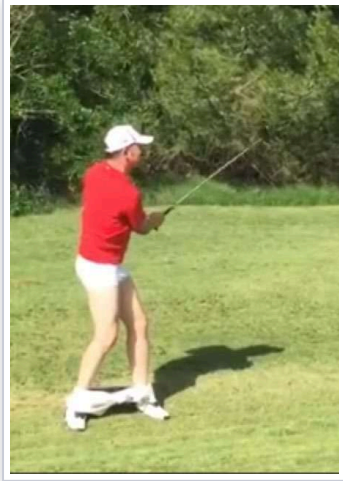
Although there would surely have been multiple examples to choose from in the early days of tour, when our golf was collectively poorer than it is these days, such footage has sadly not been captured. Nonetheless we still have numerous examples of this tradition in action and nothing quite matches Ravo's effort in going the extra mile during the Round II fourball at Son Muntaner on BDT 2017. The video itself could well end up on the dark web if published, so it will be shared over WhatsApp instead!

In the meantime enjoy just a sample of trousers-down moments, including another, safer but still amusing, video of Ravo in action, and long may these moments continue!

BDT 2006 – Langrish

BDT 2016 – Adam T

BDT 2016 – Adam T



BDT 2016 – Boysie

BDT 2018 – Boysie

BDT 2019 – Ash

BDT 2019 – Ravo

BDT 2019 – Robbo

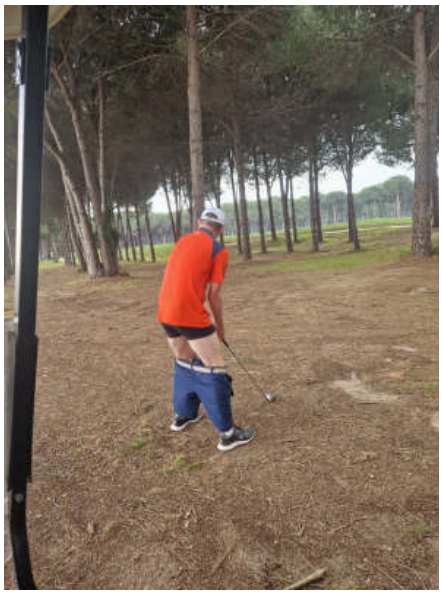
BDT 2020 – Boysie

BDT 2020 – Ravo

BDT 2022 – Kezza

BDT 2023 – Adam G

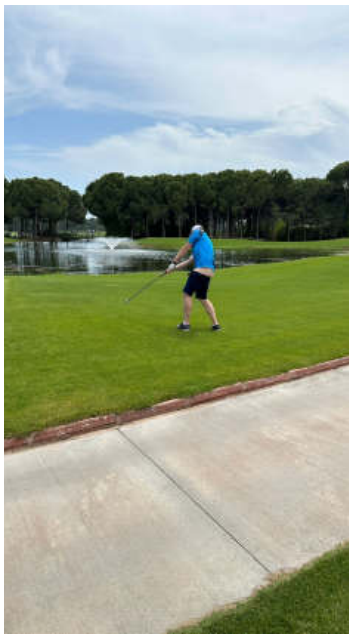
BDT 2023 – Bean



BDT 2023 – Boysie

BDT 2023 – Boysie

BDT 2023 – Langrish



BDT 2023 – Tully

BDT 2023 – Rufus

BDT 2024 – Bean

BDT 2024 – Boysie

BDT 2024 – Gav

BDT 2024 – Paddy

BDT 2025 – Bean

▶ **Watch:** BDT 2018 – Ravo

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

The tradition continued in Scottsdale.

BDT 2026 – Buzz

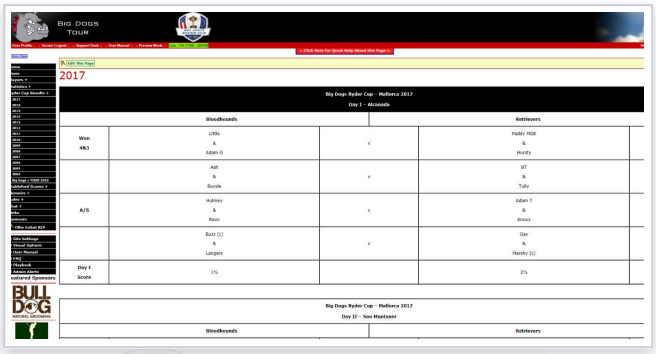
The Stats

5

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

After a few tours had been and gone we began to recognise that we should keep a full record of each tour's stats in order to develop a meaningful history for the tour. At the Opening Ceremony of BDT 2007 in Dubai I was awarded the "privilege" of being the Guard- Dog for the tour's stats and so I set about pulling together the records for the first few tours and setting a benchmark for future tours in terms of record-keeping.



Screenshot of www.bdt.com #1!

Remarkably, I found that we had or could compile from memory a record of stats for most of the tours except for the stableford scores from the first few tours up to BDT 2005. Over the years since then the stats have come into their own and updating them each year has become something of a logistical exercise – one that Ken has kindly offered to try to streamline using AI so watch this space on that front... I also took the decision that the stats and photos should be shared on our own website...

The first Big Dogs website was opened in 2007 when I enjoyed sending a link around the group www.bigdogstour.com and seeing the reaction! Looking back at a screenshot of that site, it did the job but was relatively basic!

In 2020 I ported everything across to the current website and in 2022 the Big Dogs Tour app was launched with the assistance of some random chaps from Sri Lanka! For me a key aspect of the new website was having Ollie's silhouette on the landing page – see the screenshot that follows below.

The website contains many tour records and we have accumulated some brilliant stats over the years which are being shared in the 50 day stat countdown, but I thought it would be fun to come up with a personal stat for each Dog, per the table below.

A stat apiece!

DOG	STAT
Adam G	Highest Shitzu percentage winner with a 50% strike rate
Adam T	Lowest average finish without ever winning a Shitzu
Ash MDE	Only Dog to attend every minute of every tour
Bean	Worst weighted average placing of 15th Place over three tours
Boggy	One of three Dogs to win the Shitzu the year after the Green Jacket
Boysie MDE	Joint highest all time Stableford three round score of 112 points
BT	One of only three Dogs to shoot an under par round on tour (done it three times)
Buysai	Joint second highest ever Stableford points from a debutant (106 points)
Buzz	Most Shitzus with four

DOG	STAT
Charlie	Biggest loss by one brother to another (8&6 to Rob on BDT 2024)
Coxy	Biggest gap in points between two consecutive rounds – from 17 to 42
DT	Best ever tour round of 3 under gross
Fred	Three top four finishes in four tours
Gav	Zero point return for the oppo when playing as the tour's second ever Mongrel
Glenn	Joint second highest ever Stableford points from a debutant (106 points)
Harbo	One of only three Dogs to shoot an under par round on tour
Hulmey	Lost five consecutive Presidency bids
Hursty	Lowest ever Stableford round of four points
Jules	One of two debutant Goblat winners
Kenners	42nd Virgin and second oldest debutant
Kezza	Joint-most Mongrel appearances with two
Knoxy	Biggest ever singles victory with 8&7 win over Buzz
Langers	Second most tours taken to win a Green Jacket (14) (Ravo first with 16)
Langrish	First Dog to win a trophy despite not being on tour (Elton Ravo)
Little	All time worst fourball record with six losses from six with Boysie
Lordy	First (and hopefully last!) hospitalisation on tour
Marcus	Second lowest BD Ryder Cup points tally with 0.5 points
Marshy	Most Quick Crafties on a single tour (BDT 2003)
Oli D	Joint highest all time Stableford three round score of 112 points
Oli Gregory	Only Dog to have won the Poodle and Rottweiler on the same tour
Ollie Gobat	First and second placed finishes on his only two tours
Paddy	Highest ever Stableford round of 48 points
Picko	Leaves a 100% record in fourballs with Oli G with two points from two matches
Purlo	Longest gap between tours of 9 tours (BDT 2006 to BDT 2016)
Ravo	Second and third highest ever Stableford rounds of 45 and 44 points
Rick	One of two debutant Goblat winners
Rob	Biggest ever fourballs victory at 9&8 with BT over Boysie & Langers
Robbo MDE	Only tourist to win back to back Green Jackets
Rufus	Best fourballs pairing with Paddy with four wins from four matches
Steve	43rd Virgin and oldest debutant
Tom	Joint second highest ever Stableford points from a debutant (106 points)
Tully	Joint-most Mongrel appearances with two
Tyzzer	Only Dog not to have any BD Ryder Cup points next to his name

A few other statistical points of interest:

- Over 24 years we have visited four continents and held the tour in ten countries (Spain, Portugal, the UAE, the USA, Sweden, Cyprus, England, Wales, Turkey and Morocco).
- One suspects the tourist who has travelled the most miles to join us on tours over the years must be one of Marshy, Charlie, Knoxy or Rob!
- We have had 24 tussles for the Green Jacket and competed in 22 Big Dogs Ryder Cups, with 18 different winners of the former and the teams going into Scottsdale 11-11 for the latter.
- There have been two 3x winners of the Green Jacket (Paddy and Robbo), two 2x winners (BT and Boysie) and 14 other winners.
- Six of the seven Inaugural Tourists have won a Green Jacket with only Ash (despite being the only tourist to have attended every minute of every tour) missing one…
- There have been 41 tourists to date and this number will rise to 43 when Kenners and Steve join the fray.
- Only five of the 41 have not returned for a second tour – Tyzzer, Marcus, Rick, Lordy and Tom.
- We have 14 individual trophies (with a 15th to be added to the mix in Scottsdale…!) and the race is on to see which Dog will become the first to hold a complete set of trophies….

For the Bloodhounds Buzz is closest, having secured 10 of the 14 trophies available and needing a third place, a Poodle, a Rottweiler and an Elton Ravo to complete the set.

For the Retrievers, BT is closest, needing just a Shitzu (unlikely!) and a St Bernard (more likely!) to complete the set, whilst Hursty needs just three for a full set, being the Poodle, the Xolo Bandit and the Seve & Olly.

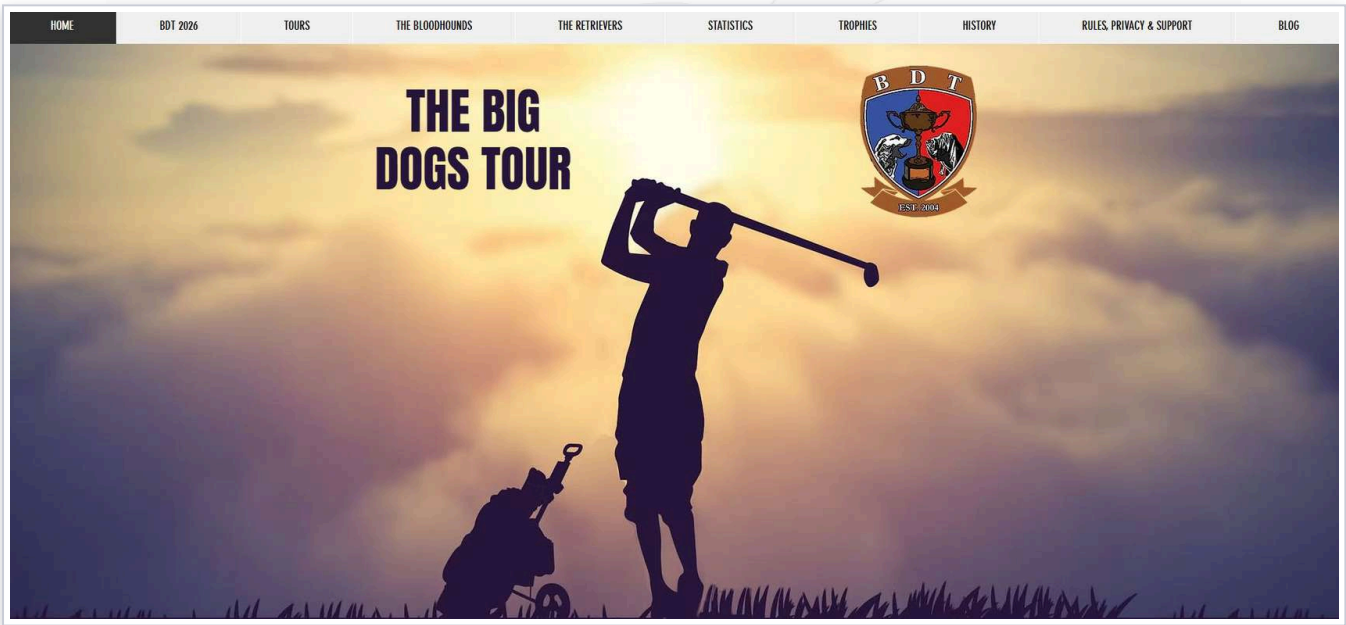
- Tom is the only tourist not to have a trophy to his name.
- We have never had a hole in one on the tour despite approximately 4,256 attempts, but only once have we not fulfilled the St Bernard competition on any one day on tour - with not a single Dog hitting the green on the par three, 150 yard 10th hole of the Twenty Ten Course at Celtic Manor on BDT 2021.
- We have played 70 rounds of golf over the 24 tours – three per tour save for the Inaugural Tour on which only two rounds were played and BDT 2012 where we had to abandon Round III due to inclement weather.
- Each Dog's best and worst Stableford round is shown in the table that follows – the discrepancies demonstrate perfectly the ups and downs of touring golf!

No doubt the competition will be as fierce as ever in the USA and we look forward to adding another set of memories to the www.bigdogstour.com following BDT 2026!

Each Dog's best and worst rounds!

DOG	BEST	WORST	DOG	BEST	WORST
Adam G	33	18	Langers	40	19
Adam T	34	18	Langrish	40	16
Ash MDE	42	19	Little	41	20
Bean	39	19	Lordy	34	25
Boggy	37	17	Marcus	32	24
Boysie MDE	41	13	Marshy	42	16
BT	40	15	Oli D	39	32
Buysai	38	33	Oli Gregory	43	20
Buzz	41	12	Ollie Gobat	33	28

DOG	BEST	WORST	DOG	BEST	WORST
Charlie	42	20	Paddy	48	14
Coxy	42	17	Picko	34	20
DT	39	19	Purlo	35	25
Fred	39	17	Ravo	45	8
Gav	43	12	Rick	30	21
Glenn	38	30	Rob	40	22
Harbo	39	23	Robbo MDE	41	9
Hulmey	36	20	Rufus	37	11
Hursty	38	4	Steve	N/A	N/A
Jules	40	21	Tom	42	29
Kenners	N/A	N/A	Tully	41	17
Kezza	37	23	Tyzzer	30	22
Knoxy	41	10			



Screenshot of www.bdt.com #2 – featuring Ollie's swing!

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

Scottsdale took the tour to 25 tours, 73 rounds and 43 tourists, with Kenners and Steve both making their debuts. Paddy won a record fourth Green Jacket, the 15th trophy – the Duncan Goodhew – went to Kenners, and the Ryder Cup now stands 12–11 to the Retrievers. Claude has since taken www.bigdogstour.com to an entirely different level!

Hursty's Four Pointer

4

BDT 2008 · Lisbon · Featuring Hursty

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

The Monkey prior to the Four-Pointer!

This story is one that every tourist is familiar with. Even now, some Dogs breathe a small sigh of relief when they pass the four-point mark on any BDT round. I can do no better than let James explain his experience in his own words:

HURSTY

"Whilst the previous 7 tours that I have had the great pleasure of attending have provided so many cherished and humorous highlights, unfortunately they have also contained a number of lowlights.

When considering which was to be the lowest moment, a number of occasions sprang to mind including:

- changing the spikes on my golf shoes in Marbella on BDT 2002;
- losing third place to Boysie having missed a two foot putt on the last in La Manga;
- losing 5 & 4 to Langrish in 2005; and
- any one of seven vicious demon attacks at the end of each of the said tours.

However, one occasion stands head and shoulders above all others as my darkest hour/s on tour and it took place on Friday 16 May 2008 which would prove to be the day when I set a tour record that is likely to never be broken.

Arriving at Penha Longa Golf Club for Round II of the 2008 BDT I was already pretty schmokered after a few quick 'Hairs of The Dog' with Ravo at the gritty hotel Jack had booked us into. After announcing the 'Steve' pairings for the round on the bus, I thought it was a good idea to seek out another few light ales prior to embarking upon the round.

I had only managed 20 points the day before (my worst round on tour to that point) so thought I couldn't do much worse and a few Stella Miguels might help to settle a few nerves - I was wrong! As per usual, all the Bloodhounds refused a pre-match pint and I was left to finish off the lagers with Robbo and BT before making my way to the first tee with my head spinning in all directions! Note from the picture above that I also polished off the full one!

After successfully defeating our Bloodhound opponents the previous day, I was relieved that once again I would be partnered by Oli G as we took on The Little Dog and Langrish in the third match out.

On the tee - ChewHACKER! I thought that this tour nickname had been slightly harsh, but on this day it would prove to haunt me!!

Things didn't start too disastrously as I somehow managed to get one airborne off the first and ended up taking a scrambled double bogey 6 for 1 point.

Second tee - 4 iron, straight right, lost ball. Blob (this was to be repeated a number of times over the course of the next 4 hours).

After reaching the 6th hole with a mere one point to my name and struggling to see never mind hit the ball, I started to feel something or someone coming up behind me....yes the Demons had arrived and it was at this point that they started whispering in my ear (rather apt really) that the worst ever round on the BDT was Robbo's 9 pointer in 2003 and that I was in grave danger of beating it unless I pulled myself together. Come on Hursty, you're better than this!!!!

To my sheer relief I managed to connect with one off the 7th tee and scraped a bogey 5 for 2 points.

No need to panic, I was off and running now - wrong..... blobs at the 8th and 9th meant I reached the turn with a grand total of 3 points - GOOD! Safe to say that my opponents couldn't control their laughter whilst my partner's patience was starting to run thin as he single-handedly was keeping us in the match where we were remarkably still all square.

It was at this point as I dragged myself up the hill to the halfway hut that I started to regret the decision NOT to get a buggy and instead carry my bag around the 18 holes. As Little zoomed past me up the hill, the Demons were indescribable and I thought there was only one thing to do in an attempt to somehow battle my way to that magical 9 point figure which was my first and only target!!!

'2 Large beers please Barman'. It was simply the only way to banish the voices in my head and battle my way through the remaining 9 holes of torture. ERROR.

Filled with a new-found confidence I decided to kick off the back nine with my Big Dog which had only appeared twice previously in the round to disastrous effect. Thankfully, I made a good connection but unfortunately the ball veered slightly left into a clump of trees. After looking for my ball for c 15 minutes during which I nearly collapsed, I gave up and walked onto the 11th tee. Big Dog again, just about missed the out of bounds and scrambled my way to a double bogey 6 for my first point of the back nine.

Blobs at the 12th and 13th followed and it was at this point that the reality of the situation suddenly started to kick in and with that realisation the demons returned. I had 5 holes to play and needed to score 6 points to surpass Robbo's remarkable all time worst score!

Surely, surely, surely, I couldn't...could I?

On the 14th tee Little whispered to me 'Lad, if I were you I'd keep the Big Dog in the bag!' but I was determined to persevere and thought that by the law of averages, I just had to smoke one! Wrong - First ball, whack, snap hook, trees... second off the tee, nice slice onto Estoril Racetrack! Blob, move on.

A combination of my awful golf, the heat and my lack of buggy was seriously affecting my energy levels and I was starting to suffer. The Bloodhounds could see my strife and kindly offered me their buggy for the hole. To make matters worse I managed to get the buggy stuck on a steep incline and very nearly rolled the thing!

Onto the 15th - par 3 - Blob.

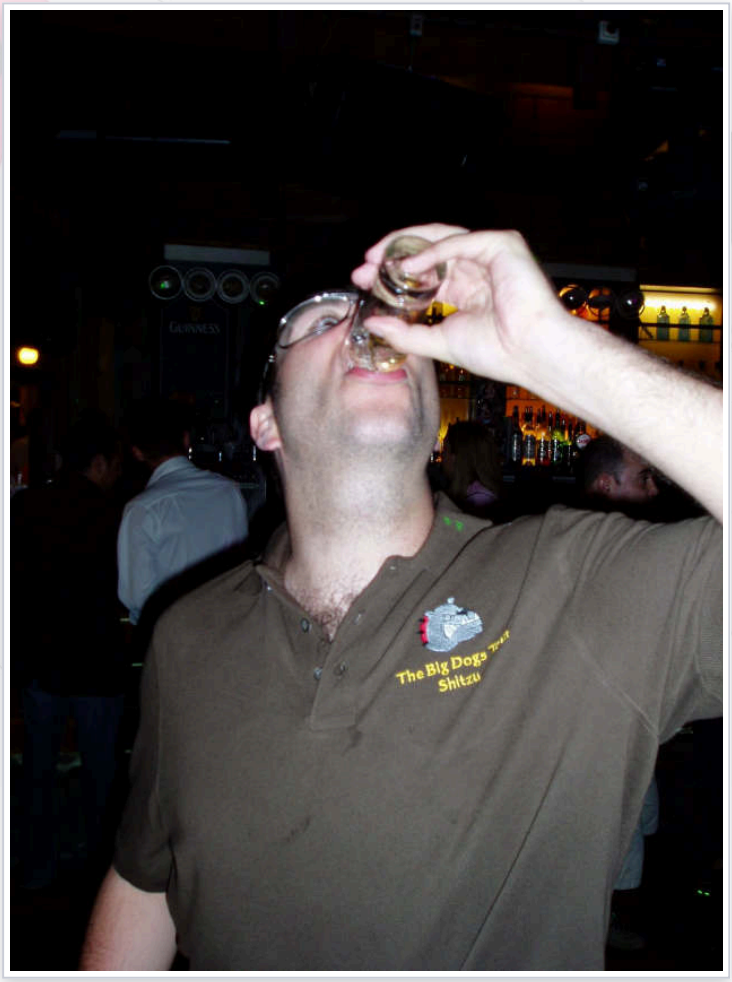
I now needed 6 points in 3 holes and couldn't figure out how the hell I was going to get them. 16th - Par 4 over trees...B*llocks, 2 lost balls off the tee, pick up and onto the next. At this point I had pretty much thrown in the towel, I hadn't scored a point since the 11th and hadn't putted since the 12th! All I wanted was for the round to end!

A nice easy 7 iron off the 17th tee ended up shanked into the trees and I very nearly walked into the clubhouse....but there was a serious match still to be played as we went down the last incredibly All Square.

It was on the 18th tee that Big Ols said to me 'Come on Hursty, it's not been your best round (what a f***ing understatement that was!) but one last effort and we could actually win this one'. 2 iron off the tee, connected and I was in play, CUMON!!! Unfortunately my next 6 shots weren't so good as I picked up before the green leaving Big Ols to sink the winning putt as he had done tirelessly all afternoon.

I shook hands with my playing companions and walked off the final green head in hand having registered a historic worst ever BDT round of 4 points, a highly embarrassing score that was by far the worst golfing experience of my 20 year career. For the record, I blobbed 15 of the 18 holes, only putted on 12 and managed 1 point on the last 11. Quite remarkable stats!

It was unquestionably my darkest and most disastrous day on tour and after having to wear the Shitzu shirt for the second consecutive night, there was only one thing to do!!"



Hursty drowns his sorrows

Robbo retains the Green Jacket

3

BDT 2006 & 2007 · Featuring Robbo

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Robbo came into BDT 2007 as the reigning tour champion having won comfortably in Mallorca on BDT 2006. His mighty 106-point tally (at that point a tour record) was 8 shots clear of second-placed Ash (so near, yet so far for Young Ash).

Robbo winning back to back Green Jackets!

Back in those days, your "reward" for winning the tour was an automatic three-shot docking of your handicap so Robbo came down from 18 to 15 but, given the margin of his victory the previous year, he was still very much considered a contender.

Despite a 35-point round in his first match at The Montgomerie, he suffered a 5&4 hammering at the hands of Boggy & Charlie (one suspects his playing partner Hursty's 21 points had something to do with this!).

▶ **Watch:** Double Hit Dumbo On The Tee!

In Round II, playing The Emirates (Majlis), he was partnered with his old mucker BT, against none other than…. Boggy & Charlie! To say Robbo was keen for revenge would be the understatement of the year! He and BT took down the oppo 6&5 and his 33 point effort was the joint highest of the day on a tough track.

After two rounds Robbo found himself in pole position in the Individual, with 68 points overall, three ahead of nearest challenger Buzz, with Picko and Charlie a further shot back.

Playing Al Badia last up, a course that will live long in the memory and which sadly no longer exists, Robbo managed 31 points, the third best round of the day to secure a second consecutive Green Jacket, halving his match with Little in a titanic Singles contest in the process.

▶ **Watch:** DT's Commentary on Robbo!

This was some achievement, as demonstrated by the fact that this remains to date the only time we have had a back-to-back tour champ.

A search for footage of some of Robbo's stellar golf uncovered one great drive, but also revealed the chip shot at the link below, which certainly amused DT!

Anyway, back to 2026 and "no pressure" Marshy in trying to match Robbo's fantastic achievement!

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

Marshy's defence ended in Scottsdale, where Paddy took the Green Jacket – Robbo's back-to-back is still unmatched.

The Goblat

2

BDT 2015 · Malmö · Featuring Ollie

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

BDT 2018 – Hursty takes the Goblat

In Memory 48 we spent some time remembering Picko, RIP. Tragically we have one other departed friend, Ollie Gobat, RIP.

The sheer brutality of Ollie's death hit us hard and BDT 2014, which took place just days after his passing, will always be remembered as a tour when everyone rallied together in a manner of which Ollie would have been so proud.

The Goblat!

Ollie first toured on BDT 2011, as a replacement for my good self as it happens as my eldest Patrick was due not long after that tour. Based in St Lucia at the time, he joined the group despite only knowing a handful of the Dogs but with a reputation as an excellent sportsman and a single figure handicapper.

Accordingly, there was much anticipation when Ollie's turn came on the first tee in Round I, a par 4 on the Jim McLean Signature Course. Eyebrows were raised when Ollie casually chucked his ball onto the tee bed and sauntered up to play his shot – no tee required for a three iron off the deck! Such confidence had never before been seen on a BDT and certainly not for an opening gambit!

Soon everyone was having a good old Barry Chuckle as Ollie proceeded to smash not one, but two Pro V1s into the water left!

Despite those inauspicious beginnings, Ollie actually went on to win his debut tour, although I have to say that this did not come as much of a surprise to me knowing just how competitive he was. He also took home the Great Dane. We spoke after the tour and he was effusive about what a great set of lads were on the trip and how much he enjoyed himself.

Ollie rejoined us on BDT 2012 and was lying in second place after Round II; privately, he was adamant he would have chased down the Monkey in Round III had it not been rained off! He missed BDT 2013 due to attending brother Adam's 40th birthday, but was all set to join us in Villa el Canine for BDT 2014 when tragedy struck.

I met Ollie at Leeds University when we started there together in 1995 and he undoubtedly changed my life, having a profound effect on me and many others in all sorts of ways. These were the words I wrote at the time of his death:

PADDY

"Ollie had an unparalleled sense of humour, a razor-sharp wit (I am sure Purlo will attest to this, as he was often on the receiving end!) and an entertaining irreverence for life. Despite the jovial-never-take-life-seriously outward appearance he portrayed, he was a deep thinker with a philosophy degree. He loved music, particularly with a Caribbean flavour and especially Byron Lee & The Dragonaires.

A huge Chelsea fan, he was a natural sportsman at everything he turned his hand to, as evidenced by the fact that approaching his 40th birthday he was in contention to play squash for St Lucia in the Commonwealth Games. He was an incredibly strong individual in mind and body, never better demonstrated than by his determined recovery from childhood leukaemia, while most of his contemporaries unfortunately succumbed to the illness.

He was a very successful businessman. He was just a hugely impressive man, never more so than when you introduced him to others, who would immediately feel at ease in his company. To be writing about Ollie in the past tense simply doesn't feel right at all and it will take us all some considerable time to come to terms with his death and particularly the manner of it."

12 years later it still doesn't feel right to be talking about Ollie in the past tense and it never will.

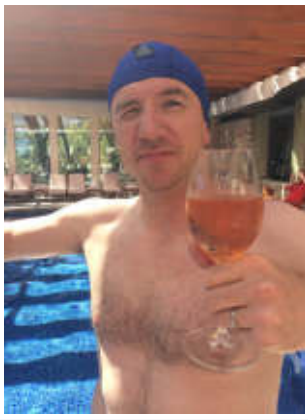
The year after Ollie's passing, in Malmö on BDT 2015, we introduced the Goblat trophy as a permanent reminder of his presence. The Goblat is awarded in Ollie's memory by a majority vote on the final day of the tour and it goes to the person who has shown the greatest all round form and best represented the BDT spirit.

We would all like to win the Individual and, even more so, Big Dogs Ryder Cup and the latter provides the focal point for the trip so it will always be top of the tour memory list. But I feel we all know that the Goblat is the most important trophy on the BDT, for it encapsulates the very essence of the tour: friendship.

We first presented the Goblat on BDT 2015 in Malmö, the year after Ollie's untimely passing. We were delighted to welcome Rufus on that trip and subsequently Adam for his first tour on BDT 2017 to Mallorca and long may they both continue to join us on future tours.

There have been 11 winners of the trophy since then, as shown below:

BDT 2015 – Jules


BDT 2016 – Rick

BDT 2017 – Marshy

BDT 2019 – Tully

BDT 2020 – BT

BDT 2021 – Langers

BDT 2022 – Ash

BDT 2023 – Hulmey

BDT 2024 – Little

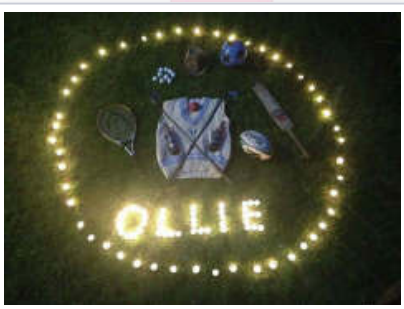
BDT 2025 – Buzz

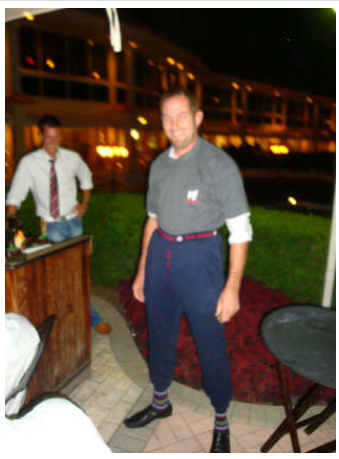
As always, we will hold a minute's silence for Ollie and for Picko on the first tee of Round I and, as defending Goblat-holder, Big Buzz will have the great privilege of hitting the Ollie ball as the first shot of the tour.

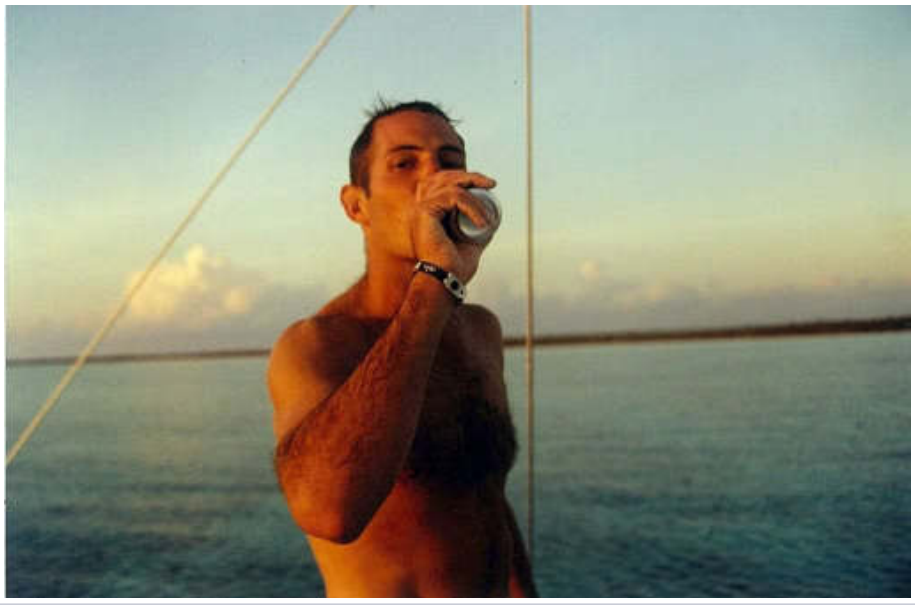
A short story that surely best sums up Ollie comes from BT, who recalls the time in Thailand at his wedding bash when Ollie said he was pretty good on the guitar. Hursty and Ravo smelt BS and called him out on it, grabbing a guitar and putting him on the spot. By all accounts he then belted out Imagine perfectly!

I'm certain that on this, the 25th anniversary trip, the Goblat will be more fiercely contested than ever before and come the end of the tour may the most deserving Dog take it home.

A few photos of Ollie are below along with a slideshow from his memorial. May he Rest In Peace.







▶ **Watch:** A tribute to Ollie

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

Paddy won the Goblat in Scottsdale, its 12th winner.

The Big Dogs Ryder Cup

1

BDT 2004 · Lagos · Featuring Hursty & Boggy

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Where to end 101 Tour Memories? Gut instinct says that there can be no better place than by going right back to where it all began – nearly – with the advent of the Big Dogs Ryder Cup.

The Big Dogs Ryder Cup!

Although the first two tours were tremendous occasions and realised the beginnings of the Green Jacket, undoubtedly it was on the Lagos trip of BDT 2004 that the tour really stepped up a notch with the introduction of the Big Dogs Ryder Cup.

This was the brainchild of Boggy and Hursty, but how were the first ever Retriever and Bloodhound teams selected? Were they drawn out of a hat, completely random or was there a mechanical method to it?

Having investigated with Boggy and Hursty, the answer is a mixture of all three, consisting of two Dogs selected for each team out of three Pools based on golfing ability:

Pool A: Marshy, Boggy, Hursty & Ash
Pool B: Ravo, Robbo, Picko & Buzz
Pool C: Paddy, Charlie, Langrish & Knoxy

The first ever teams selected on tour were:

BLOODHOUNDS	RETRIEVERS
Boggy (c)	Hursty (c)
Ash	Marshy
Ravo	Robbo
Buzz	Picko
Charlie	Paddy
Langrish	Knoxy

Back then who would have thought that all these Dogs would still represent the teams they first started on 22 Ryder Cups earlier?!

Boysie, BT & Little also came on the 2004 Lagos tour but as short tourists who did not compete in the Ryder Cup, a decision that we know they regret to this day!

Knoxy was our tour Phodographer in Lagos and he took tons of snaps but sadly his laptop was stolen and with it went virtually all the tour photos from that year, so we have no visual record of the beginnings of the Ryder Cup. Recollections are that on the first evening the Trophy and teams were unveiled by Boggy and Hursty, as the first tour Captains, over a beer or two.

We do have a gallery of subsequent Ryder Cup handover moments from most of the tours that have followed and I have added this below.

Remarkably after 22 Ryder Cup competitions we head to Scottsdale for the latest leg of the journey along the long and winding BDT road all square with 11 victories apiece; the script could not have been written any more perfectly.

Long may our journey continue over the years to come and we wish our two Captains, Ash and Robbo, the very best of luck in leading their troops into action.

May the best Dogs bring home from the USA the 23rd Ryder Cup after our 25th adventure!

RYDER CUP MOMENTS OVER THE YEARS!

BDT 2005: Vilamoura

BDT 2006: Mallorca

BDT 2007: Dubai

BDT 2008: Lisbon

BDT 2009: Vale do Lobes

BDT 2010: Girona

BDT 2011: Miami

BDT 2012: Marbella

BDT 2013: Marbella

BDT 2017: Mallorca

BDT 2018: Valencia

BDT 2019: Cyprus

BDT 2020: The Belfry

BDT 2021: Celtic Manor

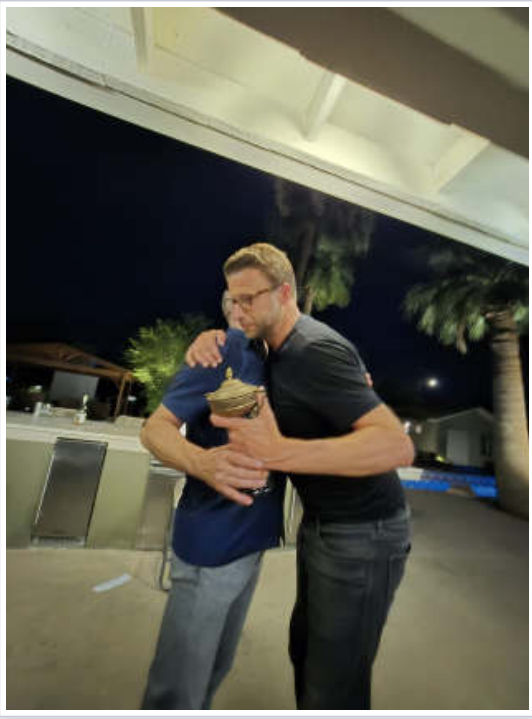
BDT 2023: Turkey

BDT 2024: Turkey

BDT 2025: Marrakech

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

The Retrievers won the 23rd Big Dogs Ryder Cup 12.5–11.5 in Scottsdale, so after 23 contests the Retrievers lead 12–11.



BDT 2026: Ash Hands Robbo The Big Dogs Ryder Cup

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